

DeskPRO Admin Manual

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DeskPRO Admin Manual	1
1. Introducing DeskPRO	6
1.1. DeskPRO features and benefits	7
1.2. DeskPRO basic concepts	8
1.3. Account types	9
User accounts	9
Agent accounts	9
Admin accounts	9
1.4. DeskPRO interfaces	10
2. Creating Your Helpdesk	13
2.1. Helpdesk domains	14
2.2. Cloud sign-up	15
2.3. Installing DeskPRO Download	16
Requirements	16
Installation process	16
3. Configuring Your New Helpdesk	18
3.1. Configuring a custom domain with Cloud	19
3.2. Next steps to setting up your helpdesk	20
4. Agents	21
4.1. Creating agents	22
4.2. Agent permissions	24
Permission groups	24
Permission overrides	26
Agent zones	27
Agent ticket permissions	27
Agent department permissions	28
Agent people permissions	29
Agent chat permissions	29
Agent publish permissions	30
Agent profile permissions	30
Agent notifications	30
Agent file attachments	30
4.3. Logging in as an agent	32
4.4. Monitoring agents	33
4.5. Managing agent passwords	34
4.6. Admin access log	35
4.7. Agent teams	36
Creating and editing teams	36
5. Departments	37

5.1. Creating and editing ticket departments	38
Department properties	38
5.2. Department permissions	40
Agent department permissions	40
User department permissions	40
5.3. Ticket form layouts	44
5.4. Using departments	48
6. Email Accounts	49
6.1. Adding ticket email accounts	50
DeskPRO Cloud email configuration	50
Sending email using DeskPRO Cloud email servers	52
DeskPRO Download email configuration	53
6.2. Email account New Ticket triggers	56
6.3. Linking a department to an email account	57
Linking email accounts to departments	57
Linking non-email tickets to email accounts	57
6.4. Running an email-only helpdesk	59
6.5. Email handling options	60
Adding agents as followers with cc:	60
Ticket forwarding: inbound	60
Ticket forwarding: outbound	61
7. Ticket Fields	63
7.1. Categories	64
7.2. Priorities	66
7.3. Workflows	67
7.4. Products	68
7.5. Custom fields	69
Custom field types	69
7.6. Field data validation	72
Text validation with regular expressions	72
Date validation options	73
8. Automating the Helpdesk	74
8.1. Ticket triggers	75
Simple triggers	75
Advanced triggers	76
Trigger order	78
Triggers example: assigning out-of-hours tickets to a special team	79
Triggers example: filtering bounce messages	80
Triggers example: tickets from organization managers are more urgent	81
Triggers example: automatically assign a ticket to agents who reply by email	82
Triggers example: emailing users when their ticket is assigned	83
Triggers example: sending a different auto-reply to new users	85
Triggers for built-in processes	88
8.2. Ticket escalations	90
Creating an escalation	90
8.3. SLAs	92
Creating an SLA	92

8.4. Macros	94
Creating a macro	94
8.5. Using urgency to prioritize tickets	95
8.6. Displaying IDs for items	96
8.7. Actions guide	97
Ticket Assignment	97
Ticket Properties	97
Ticket SLAs	97
Ticket Actions	98
Trigger Control	98
Custom Ticket Fields	98
Custom Person (user) Fields	98
9. CRM	99
9.1. User permissions	100
Everyone usergroup	100
Registered usergroup	100
Portal access and usergroups	100
User permission details	101
User file attachments	102
9.2. User registration and authentication	103
User registration settings	103
Restricting access to part of the portal	103
CAPTCHAs	104
Authentication apps	104
9.3. Managing user passwords	105
10. Portal	106
10.1. Basic portal customization	107
10.2. Portal branding	108
10.3. Changing portal design and content with templates	109
10.4. Customizing portal content	110
Rearranging portal sections	110
Hiding and displaying portal sections	110
Ticket deflection	110
Portal contact form layout	111
Showing your Twitter account on the portal	111
Custom portal sidebars	111
Custom ticket form	112
10.5. Website integration	113
Embedding the Feedback & Support tab	113
Embedding the chat widget	114
Using a custom button with the chat widget	114
Embedding a contact form	115
Embedding the whole portal	115
10.6. Ticket ref codes	117
11. Editing Templates	119
11.1. Introducing templates	120
11.2. Twig syntax basics	122

Variables	122
Tags	122
Comments	122
11.3. Customizing the email templates	124
Templates example: custom email auto-response by department	124
11.4. Customizing the portal templates	127
11.5. Useful template variables	128
12. Localization	131
12.1. Date & time settings	132
12.2. Languages	134
Installing new languages	134
Translating names of custom values	134
Editing user interface phrases	135
Changing default language	136
Agent interface language setting	136
Crowdsourced translation	136
13. Extending DeskPRO	137
13.1. Installing the ready-made apps	138
Gravatar	138
Share Widget	138
Google Analytics	138
Highrise	139
HipChat	139
Microsoft Translator	140
JIRA Integration	140
Salesforce	141
Authentication apps	141
13.2. Using web hook actions	143
13.3. Managing DeskPRO API keys	144
13.4. Creating your own widgets and apps	145
14. Satisfaction Survey	146
15. Chat	147
15.1. Chat departments	148
16. Labels	149
Editing labels	149
Merging labels	149
17. Agent Interface Options	151
17.1. Automatic ticket locking	152
17.2. Setting ticket defaults for agents	153
17.3. Time log & billing	154
17.4. Custom filters	155
17.5. Ticket archiving	156
17.6. Ticket purging	157
18. Importing User Data	158
18.1. Importing user data in CSV format	159
Importing into custom fields	160
Importing contact data	160

18.2. Importing data from legacy systems	162
Importing data from Zendesk	162
Importing data with the DeskPRO API	162
19. Managing DeskPRO Download	163
19.1. Securing DeskPRO	164
19.2. Resetting passwords from the command line	165
19.3. DeskPRO Download performance tuning	166
19.4. Proxy servers and load-balancing	167
19.5. Updating DeskPRO	168
Command-line updater	168
Manually installing updates	168
Updating multiple servers	169
19.6. Backing up or moving a DeskPRO server	170
19.7. Storing binary data	171
Switching to filesystem storage	171
Filesystem storage with multiple web servers	171
Switching to Amazon S3 storage	171
S3 security and reliability	173
Server configuration and file size	173
20. DeskPRO Terminology	174

1. Introducing DeskPRO

Welcome to DeskPRO, the helpdesk software platform.

This manual explains the details of installing, configuring and managing a DeskPRO helpdesk as an administrator.

There are separate manuals for two advanced topics:

- the [Reports Manual](#) covers DeskPRO's Reports interface, which can generate detailed custom reports about the helpdesk
- the [Apps Developer Manual](#) explains how to modify and extend the functionality of DeskPRO by developing apps and widgets.

1.1. DeskPRO features and benefits

We've worked hard to make DeskPRO **powerful yet simple**. We understand that to be accepted by your agents, our software has to be intuitive and pleasant to use, but powerful enough that it enhances their productivity rather than holding them back.

We've carried the principle of "powerful yet simple" to the administration of the platform, as well. It's easy to set up a working helpdesk in minutes, you can then configure it to match your business processes instead of changing the way you work.

Here are some of the key benefits of DeskPRO:

Flexible configuration: You can organize your helpdesk using teams and departments to reflect how your business processes work. You can add extra information to tickets to make sure all the information you need is captured, and use fine-grained access permissions to control what agents and users can see.

Scalability: Major corporations have used DeskPRO to handle millions of tickets in a single helpdesk.

Multiple channels: DeskPRO enables users to contact you via email, real-time chat, through a web portal or your own site. All the information about an issue is combined into a single ticket, so you can see the whole history of the user's communication with the helpdesk at a glance.

Integrated publishing: Your web portal contains a knowledgebase which allows your agents to create and manage articles offering solutions to common problems. The knowledgebase can be used to deflect tickets before they're submitted, by showing relevant help content as the user describes their problem. The portal can also host file downloads and news posts, all created and managed from within DeskPRO.

Automation: DeskPRO supports powerful automatic actions, which you can set up with a simple web interface. This means that you can automate repetitive or routine tasks, freeing up your agents to be more productive. You can customize the default automatic behavior of the helpdesk using the same system. Agents can speed up their own workflow using time-saving features like macros, custom filters and snippets.

Monitoring and reporting: You can ensure that tickets don't spend too long unanswered or unresolved using automatic Service Level Agreements and escalations. You can get detailed information about agent performance using the powerful Reports interface and built-in user satisfaction survey.

Branding: You can fully customize the web portal and embed it into your website, or integrate DeskPRO features like live chat and ticket submission forms into your website.

Extensibility: We refer to DeskPRO as a platform because it can be extended using DeskPRO apps. We offer pre-made apps to integrate your helpdesk with third-party services, and to enable single sign-on. You can customize the agent interface by writing simple widgets using just HTML and Javascript, or write your own full apps. DeskPRO has a full REST API to enable you to access helpdesk data and actions.

Truly multi-lingual: We've designed DeskPRO with international usage in mind. You can quickly install new language packs to offer a translated user experience for most major languages. If you need a language that we don't yet offer, we have a crowdsourcing translation system so you can provide or commission a new language pack.

Simple pricing structure: We don't lock useful features until you upgrade to a more expensive pricing plan. You just pay a simple per-agent fee and get access to all the power of the DeskPRO platform.

1.2. DeskPRO basic concepts

Here are a few key terms and concepts we'll be using throughout this manual.

Tickets: every issue (like a complaint or question) becomes a ticket in DeskPRO; a ticket gives you a unified view of all the communication about an issue.

Users: people who need help and support from your helpdesk, whether that is external customers or others within your enterprise (for example if you're running an IT helpdesk). Every ticket belongs to a user.

Agent: someone within your enterprise who uses DeskPRO to help users, such as an IT support worker or customer service agent.

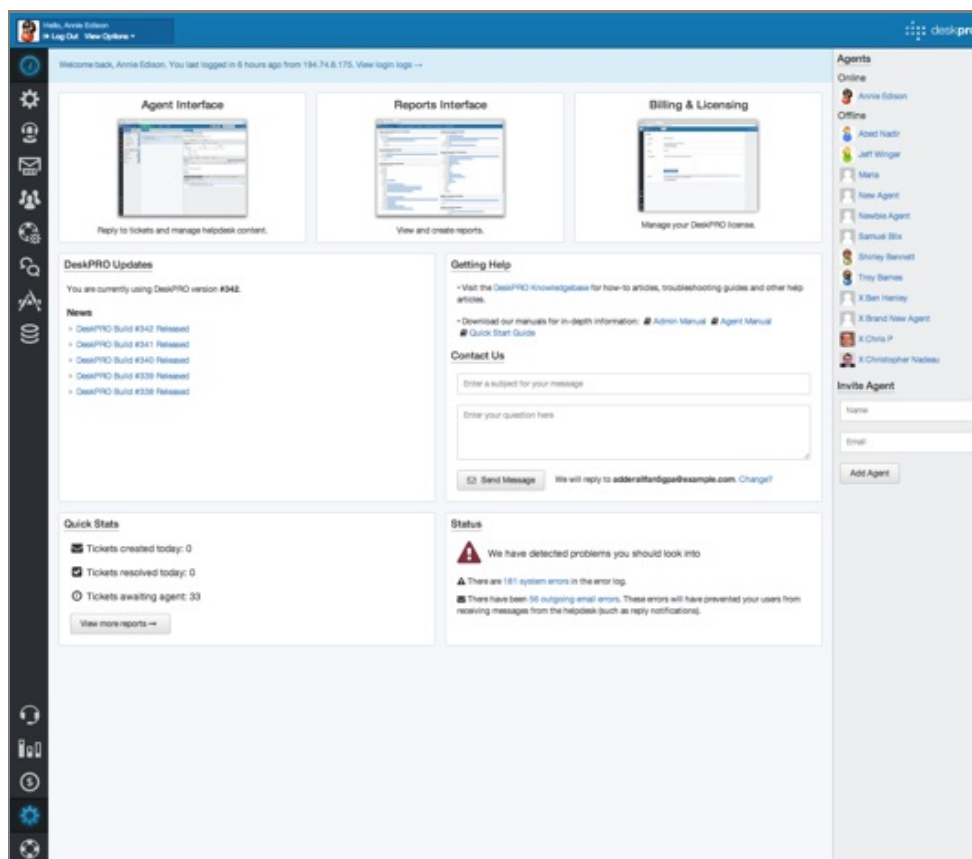
Admin: an admin is an agent who can configure the helpdesk by accessing the DeskPRO admin interface.

Department: departments are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access. They are typically used to reflect the internal organization of your enterprise e.g. you could have Sales, Support and Research departments. Every ticket always has a department.

Web portal this is an optional way to allow users to interact with the helpdesk through the web; depending on how you choose to configure it, users can view their tickets, submit feedback, see knowledgebase articles, etc. If enabled, it will be accessible to users at http://YOUR_HELPDESK/.

Agent interface: the DeskPRO interface that **agents** use to respond to tickets. When you have set up your helpdesk, it will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK/agent.

Admin interface: the DeskPRO interface that you will use to configure and maintain the helpdesk. It will be at http://YOUR_HELPDESK/admin:



The actual web address that's represented above by `YOUR_HELPDESK` will depend on your configuration.

1.3. Account types

There are three different account types in DeskPRO: user accounts, agent accounts and admin accounts.

User accounts

User accounts govern how your users interact with the helpdesk.

By default, an account is created as soon as a user emails the helpdesk or submits a ticket. You can change the requirements for creating a user account with by changing your helpdesk [registration](#) settings.

What a user can do on the helpdesk depends on their [usergroup permissions](#). Examples of user actions include:

- Creating a ticket via the web portal.
- Creating a ticket by sending an email.
- Rating web portal content and leaving comments.
- Initiating live chat with agents.

You can configure your helpdesk to control which of these functions are available to users who aren't logged in (guest users).

See the [User permissions](#) section for more details.

Agent accounts

Agent accounts are user accounts, with the additional permission to log in to the agent interface. They are designed for people within your organization who will be using the helpdesk to help users, but don't need to change helpdesk settings.

Individual agents have permissions settings which determine what they can do from the agent interface. You can also assign permissions to multiple agents at a time using **agent permissions groups**.

Agents may or may not have permission to access the **reports** interface to generate detailed, custom tables and graphs about helpdesk activity (see the [DeskPRO Reports Manual](#) for details).

See the [Agent permissions](#) section for more details.

Admin accounts

Admin accounts are agent accounts, with the additional permission to log in to the admin interface.

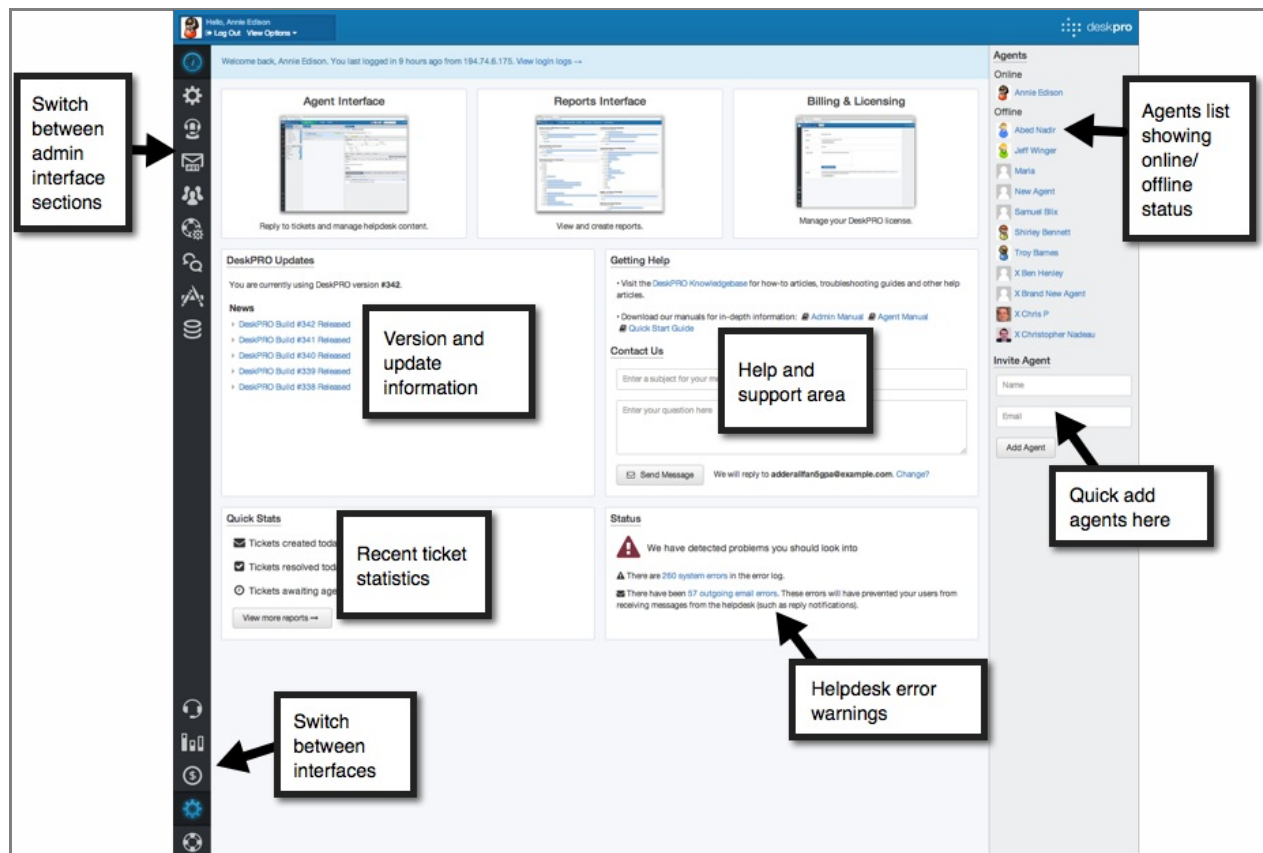
Admins can change all the helpdesk settings, and edit the permissions of all agent and admin accounts, including converting an agent to or from an admin.

Note that all admin accounts have the same abilities; DeskPRO has no 'master' admin account, and there is no difference between the initial admin account you use to create the helpdesk and any subsequent admins you create.

1.4. DeskPRO interfaces

Once your helpdesk has been created, you will be able to log in to the **admin** interface.

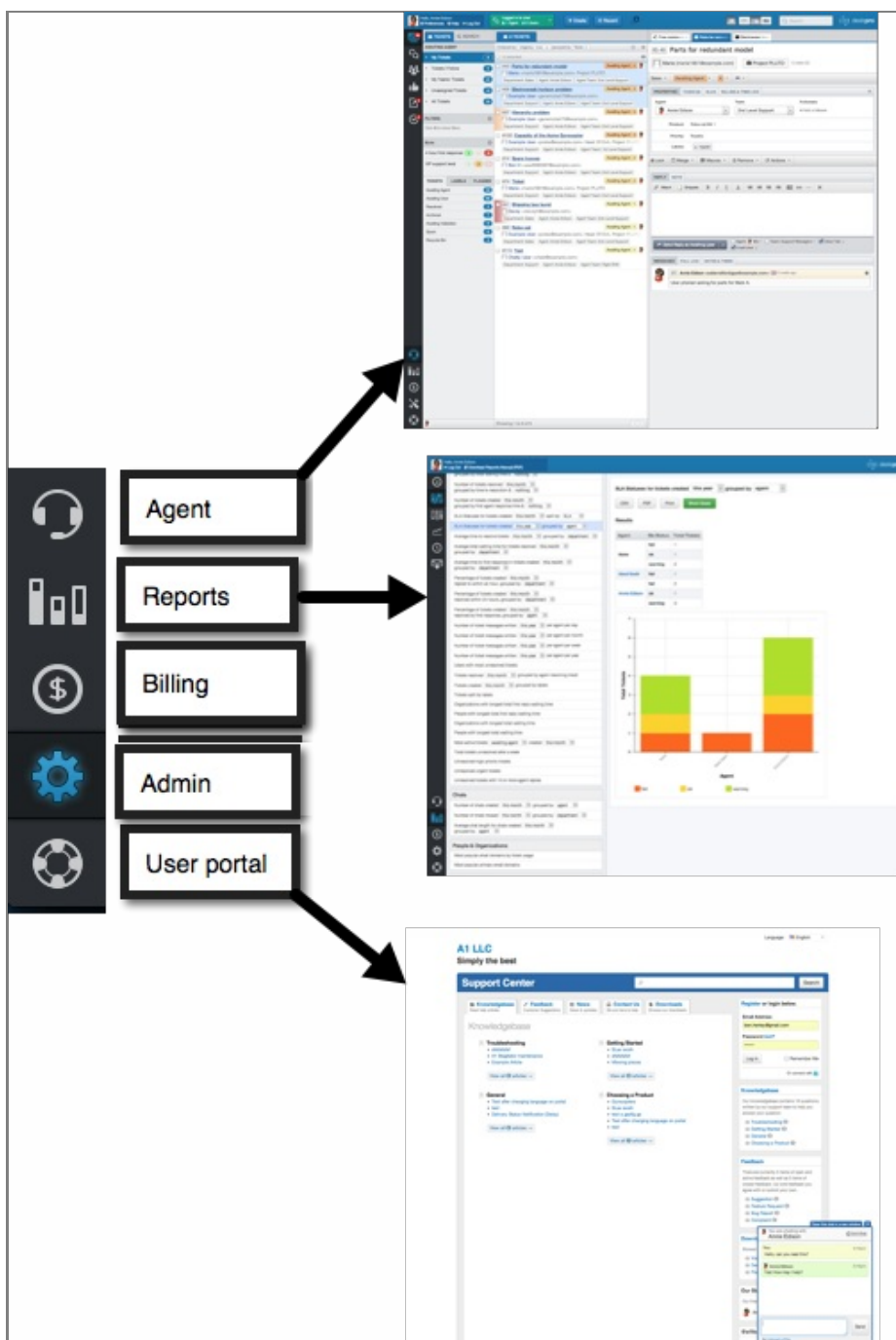
The admin home page gives you an overview of the status of your DeskPRO installation.



You can access different sections of the admin interface using the upper icons in the bar at far left.

	Setup	Basic configuration, languages
	Agents	Manage agents, teams, agent permissions and view audit log
	Tickets	Configure tickets, departments, email accounts, automation...
	CRM	User-related settings: registration, usergroups...
	Portal	Configure portal, embedding, and Publish content settings
	Chat	Chat settings, embed widget
	Apps	Manage apps to extend & integrate DeskPRO, API keys
	Server	Server settings (DeskPRO Download only)

You can switch between interfaces (including the web portal for users) with the icons at the lower left.



- The **agent** interface is where your agents will reply to tickets, chat with users, create portal content etc.. See the [Agent Manual](#) for details.
- The **reports** interface enables you to generate detailed tables and graphs about your helpdesk.
- The **billing** interface is where you pay for and manage your license to use DeskPRO.
- The **user portal** is where users can browse Knowledgebase articles and other content managed in the agent Publish app, submit tickets and chat with agents.

Note that you don't need to switch account to use any of these interfaces: you can log in to the agent interface and portal with your admin account.

2. Creating Your Helpdesk

When you set up your helpdesk, you have two deployment options:

- **DeskPRO Cloud:** where the software runs on our servers, and we manage the technical details of hardware, upgrades, off-site backups, network and bandwidth. This is the quickest and easiest method, and it's what we recommend for most customers. See [Cloud sign-up](#) for the simple procedure to get a Cloud helpdesk.
- **DeskPRO Download:** where you download and install DeskPRO on your own servers. This option gives you more control over hosting and access: for example, you can run an internal helpdesk that is only accessible from your intranet. You will have full access to the DeskPRO source code. You will need the technical skills to be able to configure and maintain a webserver and database, and you will have to arrange hosting and bandwidth yourself. See [Installing DeskPRO Download](#) for setup details.

Note that you can *always* migrate between these two options: you can evaluate DeskPRO using Cloud, then move your helpdesk to your own servers; if you decide that you no longer want to self-host, you can move your helpdesk into Cloud.

2.1. Helpdesk domains

When you first set up a Cloud helpdesk, it is hosted on a sub-domain like `yourcompany.deskpro.com` ; agents log in at `yourcompany.deskpro.com/agent/` and the admin interface is at `http://yourcompany.deskpro.com/admin/`

You can configure a Cloud helpdesk so it's accessible through your own custom sub-domain such as `help.yourcompany.com` or `support.yourcompany.com` , where `yourcompany.com` is your company's domain.

You could even use a dedicated domain just for your helpdesk e.g. `yourcompanyhelp.com` .

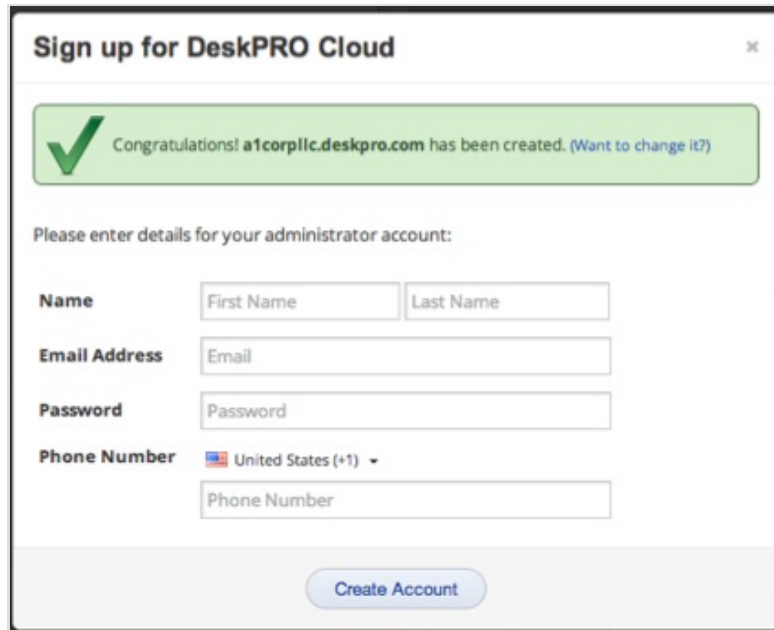
See the section [Configuring a custom domain with Cloud](#) for details.

If you're using DeskPRO Download, you configure the domain or IP address where your helpdesk is hosted.

2.2. Cloud sign-up

Signing up for a Cloud helpdesk is easy:

- 1 Go to <https://www.deskpro.com/>, go to the Cloud sign-up area and enter a name for your helpdesk, then click **Create My Free Helpdesk**
- 2 The **Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud** pop-up opens. Choose the details for your admin account.



The screenshot shows a pop-up window titled "Sign up for DeskPRO Cloud" with a close button (X) in the top right corner. Inside the window, there is a green success message: "Congratulations! a1corp1lc.deskpro.com has been created. (Want to change it?)" with a green checkmark icon. Below this, the text "Please enter details for your administrator account:" is displayed. The form contains several input fields: "Name" (split into "First Name" and "Last Name"), "Email Address" (labeled "Email"), "Password", "Phone Number" (with a dropdown menu showing "United States (+1)" and a "Phone Number" input field), and a "Create Account" button at the bottom.

- 3 You can now log in with the email address and password you provided.

2.3. Installing DeskPRO Download

DeskPRO is web-based software written in the PHP language. It is designed to be independent of the underlying operating system and web server you use. Setting up a DeskPRO Download helpdesk is fairly simple, but does require server and database administration skills on your platform of choice.

The installation instructions we have provided in this manual are written to give a general outline of the process, applicable to all platforms.

You may be able to find more detailed installation advice for your platform in our knowledgebase at <https://support.deskpro.com/kb>. We also offer an [installation service](#) for an additional fee.

Requirements

DeskPRO will run on any recent version of Windows, Linux or Mac OS X.

Installing DeskPRO requires the following:

A webserver: any webserver that works well with PHP should be able to run DeskPRO, such as a recent version of Apache, nginx/PHP-FPM or Microsoft IIS.

PHP: minimum supported version is v5.3.2, but we recommend always using the latest version.

DeskPRO will also need access to the command line version of PHP (often called php or php-cli on Linux or php-win.exe on Windows). This is generally installed by default as part of the PHP installation process.

PHP extensions that you need enabled are:

- PDO with the MySQL driver installed
- mbstring or iconv
- json
- session
- ctype
- dom
- tokenizer
- GD or Imagick or Gmagick
- OpenSSL (recommended)

It is recommended, but not required, that you install an **opcode cache** such as [Alternative PHP Cache](#) or [Windows Cache Extension](#), which can dramatically increase performance.

mySQL database: The minimum supported version is 5.0; we recommend always using the latest 5.x.x. version.

cron (on a Unix-based OS) or **Scheduled Tasks** (on Windows) to run regular processes such as sending email

An email server: DeskPRO can send email via an SMTP server, using the PHP mail() function or via a Gmail/Google Apps account. It can receive email from a POP3, IMAP or Exchange server or a Gmail/Google Apps account.

Hardware: DeskPRO runs well on modest hardware, and can easily run from a standard virtual machine or even virtual hosting account. If you are expecting a very busy helpdesk, the limiting factor for speed is generally the database, which can be helped by increasing the amount of RAM and using fast disks for storage. You can run all the required software on one machine; however, you may wish to separate the web server from the database server.

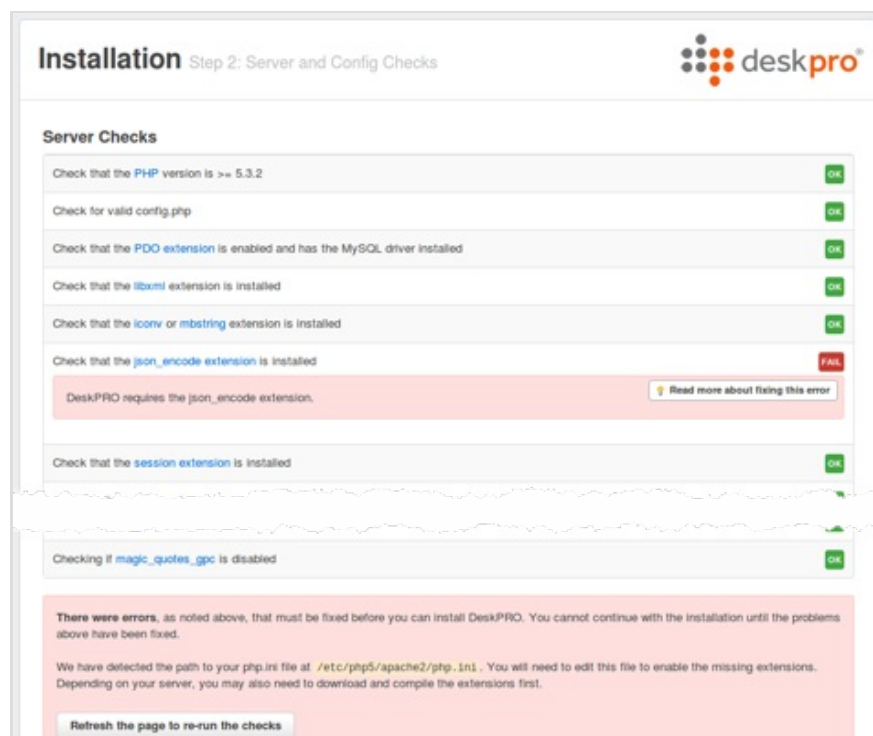
Installation process

We can't provide a step-by-step installation guide for every possible combination of operating system, version and configuration.

However, once you get past the initial steps, DeskPRO includes an installation wizard to guide you.

The installation process generally runs like this:

- 1 Install a web server and enable PHP support and URL rewriting.
- 2 Install PHP, with the required PHP extensions listed in [Requirements](#).
- 3 Install MySQL, and create a 'deskpro' user account.
- 4 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>
 - remove the default page (e.g. `index.html`) from your web server's base directory, and unzip `deskpro.zip` into it
 - copy the resulting `config.new.php` file as `config.php`
 - set a cron job or Scheduled Task to run `cron.php` once per minute
 - edit `config.php` to add your email address and MySQL database credentials
- 5 Ensure the web server is running and go to the URL (or IP address) where it is serving DeskPRO.
- 6 Provided you have the basic PHP/MySQL environment working, the wizard will take you through the steps required to complete installation. It can advise you on how to fix common configuration problems.



- 7 Once installation is complete, you can log on with the account details you gave during installation.

There are articles about specific installation problems on the [DeskPRO Knowledgebase](#).

3. Configuring Your New Helpdesk

The first step when configuring your new helpdesk is to enter the details of your organization. Go to the **Setup** section by clicking the gear icon in the black bar at upper left.



Enter the details requested under **Your Helpdesk** and **Your Website**.

Settings

Your Helpdesk

Helpdesk Name

This is the name of your helpdesk. The name is displayed to users in their browser window title, and is also

Helpdesk URL

The primary URL for your helpdesk. This URL is used whenever the system needs to link to your helpdesk.

Your Website

Website Name

Enter the name of your company or company website.

Website URL

Enter the URL to your company website.

For DeskPRO Download, you will see a **Helpdesk URL** entry; this should be the web/intranet address where users can access your web portal.

While you're on this page, check that the **Default Timezone** at the top of the **Dates and Times** section is set correctly.

3.1. Configuring a custom domain with Cloud

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, your helpdesk will initially be hosted at the default URL you selected when you created it: e.g. <http://yourcompany@deskpro.com>.

You can use your own domain for the helpdesk, e.g. <http://support.yourcompany.com> or <http://yourcompanyhelp.com>.

To set this up:

- 1 Go to **Setup > Domain / URL Setup**
- 2 Click **Use a custom URL**. Enter the domain name you want to use.
- 3 Edit the DNS settings for your domain to create a CNAME record mapping `yourcompany.deskpro.com` to your custom domain:

NAME	TYPE	VALUE

support.yourcompany.com.	CNAME	yourcompany.deskpro.com.

Note that the admin interface will always be accessible through the original <http://yourcompany.deskpro.com/admin/> address. This is useful if you run into problems with your custom domain (e.g. it expires).

You can also select whether to enable HTTPS security. Note that using HTTPS with a custom domain requires manual setup by one of our agents. Contact support@deskpro.com to arrange this.

3.2. Next steps to setting up your helpdesk

The steps you need to take now will depend on how you want to use DeskPRO.

Here are some common setup tasks that most helpdesks will need:

- 1 | Configure [departments](#) to divide up the helpdesk.
- 2 | Add more [agents](#) - create an agent account for everyone who will work on the helpdesk.
- 3 | Set up ticket [email accounts](#).
- 4 | Customize the [portal](#) or [integrate it with your website](#) using embeds.
- 5 | Customize [ticket fields](#) to store extra information about tickets.

Not all of these steps will apply to all helpdesks.

For example, you may prefer to disable the portal and interact with users by email only. See the section [Running an email-only helpdesk](#) for details on how to do this.

4. Agents

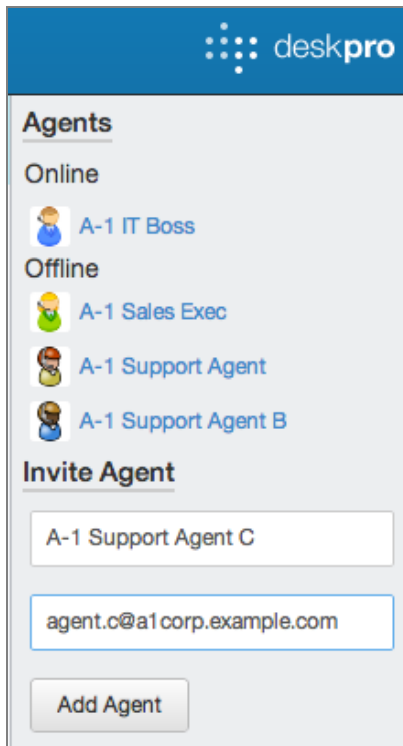
As an admin, you can create and manage all agent accounts.

Use [agent permissions](#) to control what each agent is allowed to do within your helpdesk. There are many fine-grained settings, so to simplify management, you can add agents to predefined permission group.

You can organize agents into [teams](#), which allow tickets to be assigned to groups of agents.

4.1. Creating agents

You can see the list of agents in the system at the top right of the home page.



Initially, you will only see your account.

You can quickly add your colleagues as new agents using **Invite Agent**, just by entering the new agent's name and email, then clicking **Add Agent**.

The person will get an email notification about their new agent account, with the [Agent Quick Start Guide](#) (a brief overview of how the agent interface works) attached.

You can manage agents in more detail from the **Agents** section.

Properties | Permissions | Departments | Ticket Notifications | Other Notifications

Name

Newbie Agent

☐ Display a different name to end-users

Email Address

new.agent@a1 corp.example.com

Zones

☐ Admin Interface

☐ Reports Interface

Teams

☒ 1st Level Support

☐ 2nd Level Support

☐ Support Managers

Permission Groups

☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions

☐ All Permissions

☐ Interns

Switch to the

Permissions

 tab to manage permission overrides.

Save

Delete

4. Agents

23

4.2. Agent permissions

Agent permission settings control what an agent is allowed to see and do on the helpdesk. You can use this to limit agent accounts so they can only carry out the actions that are required by their role.

For example, you could limit a trainee's account so that they couldn't reply to tickets, but could still read them and assign them to other agents. If you are dealing with sensitive information, you could set it so that most of your agents are only able to see tickets they were assigned.

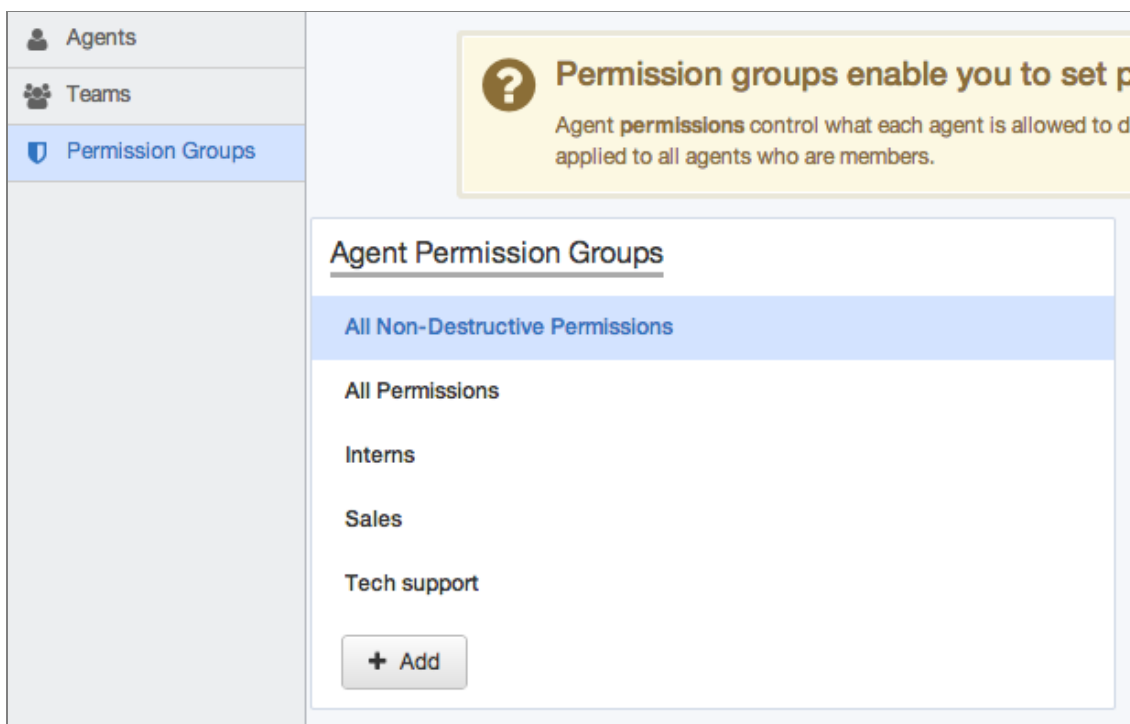
To set individual permissions for an agent, go to **Agents** and click on the agent's name, then the **Permissions** tab.

The screenshot displays the 'Agents' management interface. On the left, a list of agents is shown, with 'A-1 Support Agent' selected. The right panel shows the 'Permissions' tab for this agent. It includes a section for selecting permission groups (All Non-Destructive Permissions, All Permissions, Interns, Sales, Tech support) and a section for managing permission overrides. Below these are tabs for 'Tickets', 'People', 'Chat', 'Publish', and 'Profile'. The 'Tickets' tab is active, showing a list of permissions with toggle switches: 'Can use the ticket system' (on), 'Can create new tickets' (on), 'Can mass-reply to tickets' (off), 'Can unarchive tickets' (off), 'Can reply to owned and team tickets' (on), 'Can modify owned and team tickets' (on), and 'Can edit and delete messages in owned and team tickets' (off).

You can use the toggle controls at right to enable and disable the agent's ability to carry out a wide variety of actions. Click the **People**, **Chat**, **Publish** or **Profile** tabs to set permissions for other parts of the helpdesk.

Permission groups

Instead of making decisions about each of the dozens of possible actions for every one of your agents, you can use permission groups to store sets of permissions which you can quickly apply to multiple agents. These are managed from **Agents > Permission Groups**



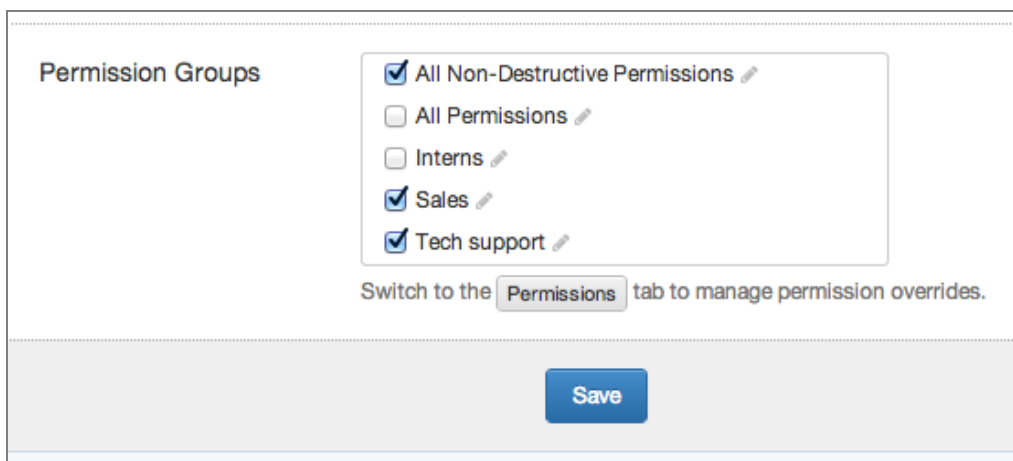
The default groups when you first create your helpdesk are "All Permissions" and "All Non-Destructive Permissions". The latter allows the agent to use most DeskPRO features, except ones which could cause you to lose information or otherwise be harmful (like sending mass replies).

To create a new permission group, click the **Add** button.

In the **Properties** tab, enter a **Group Name**. Then click on the **Permissions** tab and set permissions as for an individual agent. You can also set [department permissions](#) for the group.

Agents can belong to more than one permission group. If an action is allowed by *any* of an agent's groups, the agent can do it.

You can select permission groups for an agent from their **Properties** tab:



or add agents to a permission group from the group's **Properties**:

Properties

Permissions

Departments

Group Name

All Non-Destructive Permissions

Members

☒  A-1 IT Boss 

☒  A-1 Sales Exec 

☐  A-1 Support Agent 

☒  A-1 Support Agent B 

☐  New Agent 

☐  Newbie Agent 

Save

Permission overrides

You can combine individual permission settings and permission groups.

For example, this agent is a member of "All Non-Destructive Permissions".

Properties

Permissions

Departments

Ticket Notifications

Other Notifications

Permission groups are pre-defined sets of permissions you can easily apply to multiple agents.

Select the permission groups to apply to this agent:

☒ All Non-Destructive Permissions

☐ All Permissions

☐ Interns

☐ Sales

☐ Tech support

Tickets

People

Chat

Publish

Profile

Can use the ticket system

Can create new tickets

Can mass-reply to tickets

Can unarchive tickets

Can reply to owned and team tickets





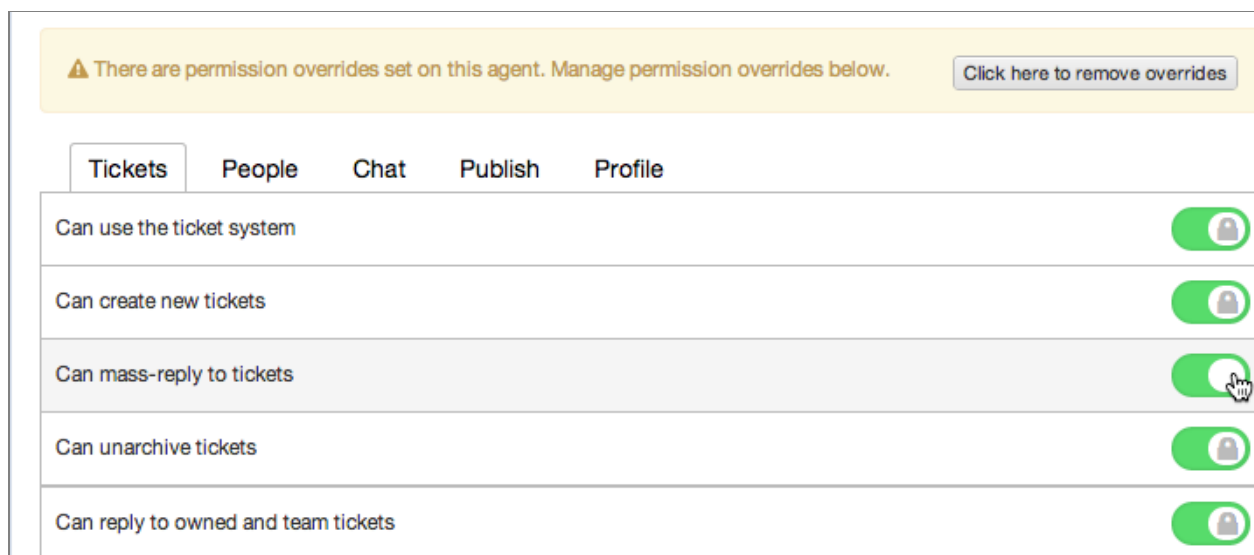




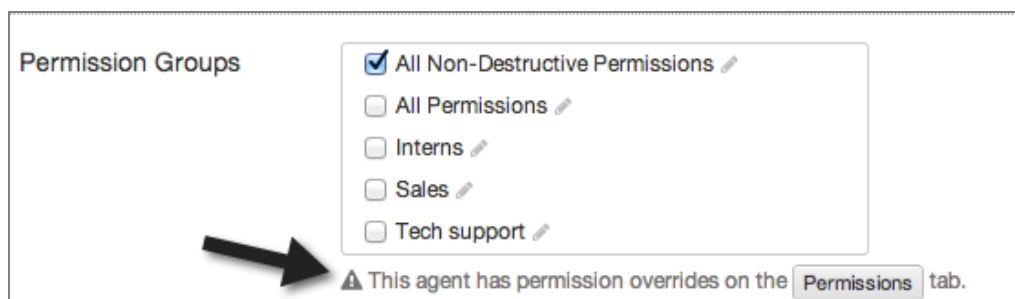


Suppose you need to grant the agent permission to mass-reply to tickets.

You can just click the **Can mass-reply to tickets** toggle to add that permission.



A permission that's not granted through a permission group is considered an **override**. To make it easier to work out which agents have which permissions, DeskPRO alerts you if there are overrides, both in the agent's **Permissions** tab as you can see above, and in the agent **Properties** tab:



Note that you can't *remove* permissions which are granted by a permission group; this is indicated by the lock symbols on the other toggle controls.

Agent permissions are always additive - an agent only needs to be granted a permission by a single group or an override to be able to use it, even if none of their other groups include that permission.

Agent zones

In the **Properties** tab, you can also select what **zones** the agent can use.

Granting **admin** zone access means the agent is an admin and can use the admin interface. Note that there is no way to customize admin permissions; admin access is all or nothing.

Granting **report** zone access enables the agent to use the Reports interface to view statistics and charts about your helpdesk's tickets, agents' performance, billing, etc.

Agent permissions for tickets and chats are also limited by departments: see the section on [Department Permissions](#) for details.

Agent ticket permissions

You can limit agents' access to tickets based on their relationship to each ticket.

For example, you could disable the **view unassigned tickets** and **view tickets assigned to others** permissions, so that the agent could only see tickets that had already been assigned to them.

Note that agents can always view tickets which are assigned to them *or* that they are following. So, for example, if an agent has **can view unassigned tickets** disabled, but is added to an unassigned ticket as a follower, they will still be able to see the ticket.

There are no separate settings for team tickets; if a ticket is assigned to one of an agent's teams, that grants the same permission as if it was assigned to the agent directly.

These are the ticket settings available for each agent:

Tickets	People	Chat	Publish	Profile
Can use the ticket system				
Can create new tickets				
Can mass-reply to tickets				
Can unarchive tickets				
Can reply to owned and team tickets				
Can modify owned and team tickets expand ▾				
Can edit and delete messages in owned and team tickets				
Can delete owned and team tickets				
Can reply to followed tickets				
Can modify followed tickets expand ▾				
Can edit and delete messages in followed tickets				
Can delete followed tickets				
Can view unassigned tickets				
Can reply to unassigned tickets				
Can modify unassigned tickets expand ▾				
Can edit and delete messages in unassigned tickets				
Can delete followed tickets				
Can view tickets assigned to others				
Can reply to tickets assigned to others				
Can modify tickets assigned to others expand ▾				
Can edit and delete messages in tickets assigned to others				
Can delete tickets assigned to others				

An agent's 'owned' tickets are tickets that are assigned to that agent.

Agent department permissions

For each department, an agents can have either **Full**, **Assign** or no access.

Note that the ticket permission settings interact with the ticket department permissions: to do something to a ticket, an agent must have permission for the relevant action *and* the required level of access to the relevant department. For example, if an agent was allowed to view unassigned tickets, but only had **Assign** access to the Sales department, they would still not be able to view unassigned Sales tickets.

See the section on [department permissions](#) for details.

Agent people permissions

These control what agents can do with users and organizations.

Tickets	People	Chat	Publish	Profile
Can use the CRM system				
Can create new user profiles				
Can edit user profiles				
Can validate users and user email addresses				
Can edit users email addresses				
Can reset user passwords				
Can add notes to user profiles				
Can completely delete users				
Can disable users				
Can log in as users				
Can merge users				
Can create organizations				
Can edit organizations				
Can add notes to organizations				
Can delete organizations				

Agent chat permissions

These control what agents can do with the user chat system.

Tickets	People	Chat	Publish	Profile
Can use chat				
Can view old chat transcripts				
Can view unassigned chats				
Can view chats assigned to others				
Can delete chat transcripts				

These settings apply only to the user-facing chat system. Agent IM is always enabled for all agents; agents are logged in to IM whenever they are logged in to the agent interface.

Note that the chat department permission settings interact with these permissions: if an agent has permission to use chat, but

Agent publish permissions

These control what the agent can do in the agent interface Publish app which is used to publish content on the portal.

Tickets	People	Chat	Publish	Profile
Can create content				
Can delete content				
Can edit content				
Can validate content and comments (including own)				

Agent profile permissions

These control whether the agent is allowed to set their own profile picture (displayed in the agent interface and on the portal) and signature (appended to messages to users).

Agent notifications

You can set the details of the notifications each agent receives. These are the same options the agent can set for themselves via the agent interface.

[Properties](#) |
 [Permissions](#) |
 [Departments](#) |
 [Ticket Notifications](#) |
 [Other Notifications](#)

Email Notifications

Browser Alerts

	New Ticket	Assignment	User Message	Agent Message	Agent Note	Property Change
My Tickets	☒	☒ ☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
My Team's Tickets	☒	☒ ☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
Tickets I Follow	☒	☒ ☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
Unassigned Tickets	☒	☒ ☐	☒	☒	☒	☒
All Tickets	☒		☒	☒	☒	☒

Agent file attachments

Under **Settings** > **Setup** you can specify the file types your agents are allowed to use. This applies to message attachments (from email or the agent interface), files sent via Chat and Publish content.

You can either allow all files, specify a list of allowed file extensions, or specify a list of banned file extensions.

If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can also set the maximum file size an agent can upload. You will also see the maximum possible file size DeskPRO can handle, and you will receive a warning if you try to allow agents to upload files bigger than that.

Agent Attachments

☐ Allow all files

☐ Only allow specific file extensions

☒ Just disallow specific file extensions

Max file size an agent can upload.

Warning

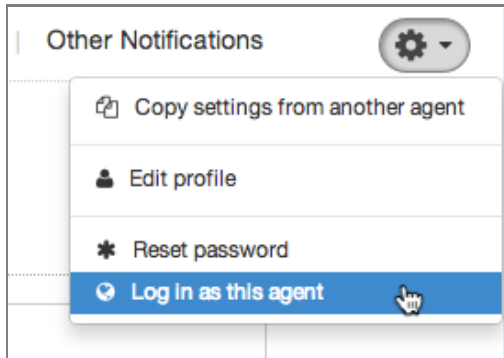
 The max file size supported by your server is 42.67 MB. [Learn more.](#)

You may be able to change your Download configuration to allow bigger files. See the section [Storing binary data](#) for details.

4.3. Logging in as an agent

As an admin, you can log in to the agent interface as any agent (including other admins). This can be useful for troubleshooting purposes.

- 1 | Navigate to the **Agents** settings page, then select the agent you want to log in as.
- 2 | Click **Log in as this agent**



Note that when you are logged in as an agent, it's exactly as if you have signed in with their account and password. For example, if the agent doesn't have permission to alter their own notifications, you won't be able to alter them either. If you send a response to a user, it will appear to come from the agent who's account you're using.

4.4. Monitoring agents

To help monitor how your agents are using the helpdesk, you can view a **Login log** below the **Agents** list.

For more detailed information about agent activity, you can use the **Reports** interface, accessible from the chart icon at the lower left.

4.5. Managing agent passwords

Go to **CRM > Password Settings** to set the requirements for creating account passwords. You can set separate requirements for agents and users.

Agent Password Policy

☐ Standard Password Policy

☒ Custom Password Policy

Specify custom password requirements.

Password Policy

Minimum password length: characters

The minimum number of characters the password has to be.

Maximum password age: days

How many days a password can remain unchanged until DeskPRO requires the agent to change it.

☐ Forbid password reuse

When enabled, agents will not be able to change their password to a password they have used in the past.

Require this many lower-case characters:

Define the minimum number of lower-case (a-z) characters that must be used in the password.

Require this many upper-case characters:

Define the minimum number of upper-case (A-Z) characters that must be used in the password.

Require this many numbers:

Define the minimum number of numbers (0-9) that must be used in the password.

Require this many symbols:

Define the minimum number of symbols (!, @, \$, % etc) that must be used in the password.

You can reset agent passwords from the admin interface. Go to **Agents**, select the agent you want to reset, then select **Reset password** from the gear menu at top right.

You choose whether to randomly generate a new password, or choose one yourself. The new password will be emailed to the agent.

4.6. Admin access log

Admins have the power to lock out or delete other users, and make major changes to your helpdesk data that can't be undone.

You can view a log of all admin interactions with the helpdesk under **Agents > Audit Log**. This can be useful if you are trying to investigate an unexpected change to your helpdesk, or if you suspect that an admin account has been abused.

Agents	140	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	is_agent_group:	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:14:50
Teams	139	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	is_agent_group: 1	UPDATE usergroups#1	2014-05-12 17:12:00
Permission Groups	138	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: REMOVE: Full for people#2 -- A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-12 16:44:35
Audit Log	137	Christopher Nadeau <chris.nadeau@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#1 -- Everyone	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-12 16:43:07
	136		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 16:42:36	UPDATE people#1	2014-05-12 16:42:36
	135	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#12	2014-05-12 15:26:53
	134	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:26:29
	133		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 15:18:06	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 15:10:06
	132	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#11	2014-05-12 15:05:41
	131	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	first_name: A1 last_name: Admin name: A1 Admin	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 13:58:39
	130		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:42:22	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:42:22
	129		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 12:31:17	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 12:31:17
	128		date_last_login: 2014-05-12 08:25:27	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-12 08:25:27
	127	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#10	2014-05-09 16:32:05
	126		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 15:31:02	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 15:31:02
	125		date_last_login: 2014-05-09 11:55:33	UPDATE people#2	2014-05-09 11:55:33
	124	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:18:51
	123	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#9	2014-05-09 11:18:40
	122	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#8	2014-05-09 11:17:41
	121	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	title: Sales team	UPDATE usergroups#6	2014-05-09 11:16:15
	120	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		DELETE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:50:01
	119	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	permissions: ADD: Full for usergroups#7 -- YSP	UPDATE departments#1	2014-05-09 10:24:49
	118	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>		CREATE usergroups#7	2014-05-09 10:23:52
	117	A1 Admin <ben.henley@deskpro.com>	parent: null	UPDATE departments#2	2014-05-09 10:06:05

4.7. Agent teams

Agent **teams** are a way to allow group ticket assignment. Assigning a ticket to a team brings it to the attention of all the members of that team: it will show up in the **My Teams' Tickets** filter in the agent interface.

Teams usually consist of agents who work closely together and tend to all handle the same kind of ticket. An agent can belong to more than one team.

For the permissions system, assigning a ticket to a team to which an agent belongs is equivalent to assigning it to the agent directly.

Teams are useful if you want to divide your agents up within a department, or across departments.

For example, if the agents who handle tickets in your Support department are divided into first-tier, second-tier and third-tier support, you could arrange them into three teams.

You can also use teams to assign tickets to groups of agents who usually work in different departments. For example, you could have a team to handle complex issues consisting of senior staff from across the business.

Creating and editing teams

You can create and edit teams under **Agents > Teams**. Teams only have two properties: a name and a list of agents.

Click **Add** to create a new team, enter its name, and select which agents are members using the checkboxes.

Team Name	2nd Level Support
Members	☐ A-1 IT Boss ☒ A-1 Sales Exec ☒ A-1 Support Agent ☒ A-1 Support Agent B ☐ Newbie Agent

Click on a team to edit it.

5. Departments

Departments are an important concept within DeskPRO. They are a way to divide up the helpdesk and control access.

Departments are often used to reflect different parts of an organization: for example, you might have "Support", "Delivery" and "Sales" departments, or "US", "France" and "UK" departments.

There are **ticket departments** and **chat departments**. The two types of department are not linked; you configure departments separately for tickets and chats.

The focus of this chapter is on ticket departments, since they are more frequently used and more powerful than chat departments. These are some important properties of ticket departments:

- A ticket must always have a department.
- Each ticket email account must be linked to a department (by a [trigger](#)). For example, if `jobs@yourcompany.com` is linked to your HR department, tickets created from emails sent to that address will be assigned to that department.
- Each department is linked to an email account by a trigger. For example, if the HR department is linked to the `jobs@yourcompany.com` account, an HR department ticket created from the web portal will have related emails sent from the `jobs@` account.
- Access to departments can be limited by agent and user permissions, so if you want to let people access certain tickets but not others, you can implement this with departments.
- The form to create a ticket through the portal or agent interface, and the fields that require values, can be different depending on the department.
- You can give each department a user-facing name; e.g. a department called "Terms of Service Violations" could be shown to users as "Support".

5.1. Creating and editing ticket departments

To manage ticket departments, go to **Tickets > Departments**. At left, you'll see the list of departments currently in your helpdesk. The defaults for a new helpdesk are "Support" and "Sales", but you are free to edit these.

You can change the order of departments by dragging them with the handles at left. This changes the order in which they're displayed to users and agents.

You can have an unlimited number of departments. Most enterprises will have fewer than ten departments, but you can structure your departments as you feel suitable.

If your helpdesk is very small, you may decide that you do not need to use departments. You need to keep one department in your helpdesk, but if you only have a single department, users are not shown the department field on the ticket submission forms.

Department properties

To make a new department, you need to enter information in the **Properties** tab.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of a department configuration form. At the top, there are four tabs: 'Properties' (selected), 'Permissions', 'Layout', and 'Website Embed'. The form is divided into several sections:

- Title ***: A text input field containing 'Delivery'. Below it, a note states: 'This is the title as it will appear throughout the agent and user interfaces.' There is a globe icon to the right of the input field. Below the note is a checkbox labeled 'Show a different title to end-users'.
- Parent**: A dropdown menu currently set to 'No Parent'. Below it, a note states: 'By setting a parent department, this department becomes a child. This is just an organizational feature that helps you create department structures that are easier to use.'
- New Ticket Trigger**: A section with a header 'When a new ticket is submitted through the portal in this department:'. It contains two checkboxes: 'Set Email Account' (checked) with a dropdown showing 'helpdeska766@gmail.com', and 'Send User Email' (unchecked). Below these is a green 'Action' button.
- Ticket Changed Trigger**: A section with a header 'When a ticket department is changed to this department:'. It contains two checkboxes: 'Set Email Account' (checked) with a dropdown showing 'helpdeska766@gmail.com', and 'Send User Email' (unchecked). Below these is a green 'Action' button.

At the bottom of the form, there are three buttons: 'Save' (blue), 'Reset' (grey), and 'Delete' (red).

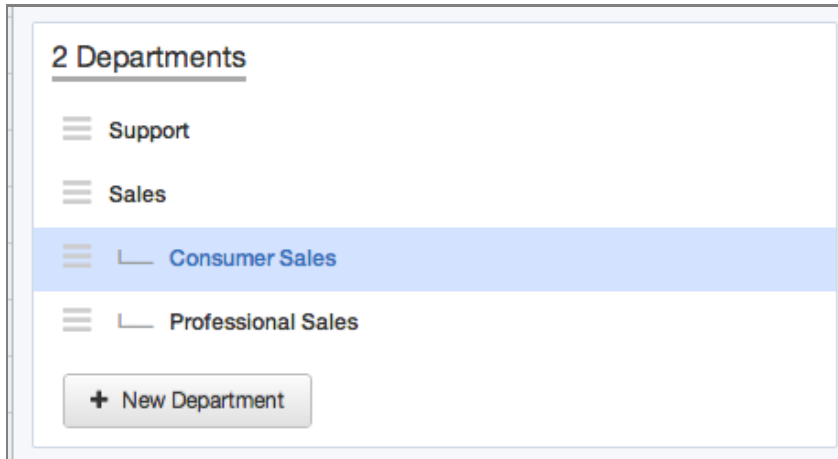
Edit the **Title** field to change the department's name. Click the globe icon to enter translations for each language you have enabled.

You can choose to **Show a different title to end-users** if you want to enter an alternative department name to be displayed to users in the web portal.

To create a sub-department, create a new department and then select a **Parent** department. For example, you could create a **Consumer Sales** department, then make its parent **Sales**.

Note that if a department is a *parent* (i.e. has sub-departments), you can only assign tickets to its sub-departments. If you make a department with its own tickets into a parent, its tickets are moved to the sub-category.

As a result, there is little point having only a single sub-department within a department - in the example above, you would want to create a **Professional Sales** sub-department as well.



You can only have sub-departments one layer deep: for example, you can have **Sales > Consumer Sales** and **Sales > Professional Sales** sub-departments, but not **Sales > Consumer Sales > Budget Range**

5.2. Department permissions

Click the **Permissions** tab for a ticket or chat department to edit the related permissions.

Agent department permissions

In the **Agent Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [agent permission groups](#) and individual agents have access to that department.

Agent / Agent Group	Assign	Full Access
 All Non-Destructive Permissions		
 All Permissions		
 Interns		
 Sales		
 Tech support		
A-1 IT Boss		
A-1 Sales Exec		

There are two levels of agent permission for departments:

- **Assign** means that the agent can assign tickets to the department.
- **Full access** means that the agent can view and work with tickets in the department as normal.

An agent who only has **assign** permission can assign a ticket to a department, but will not be able to view it afterwards.

Note that department permissions are overridden by ticket assignment and following. If a ticket is assigned to an agent or one of the agent's teams, or the agent is added as a follower, the agent can view and work with it regardless of department.

You can also manage these settings from **Agents > Agent Permission Groups**

In the screenshot above, you will see that many of the permissions are on and *locked* - you can't remove the permission. This happens for one of two reasons:

- Granting **full access** includes **assign**, so if the agent/group has been granted **full access**, **assign** is locked on.
- If an agent is a member of a group which already grants them a permission, it will be locked on.

Chat department permissions for agents work like those for ticket departments, except they control which chats agents can accept. Unlike the two permission levels of **assign/full access** for ticket departments, chat department access is either on or off.

User department permissions

In the **User Group Permissions** section of a department's **Permissions** tab, you can select which [usergroups](#) have permission to create tickets in that department. This enables you to limit access to certain departments to particular usergroups: for example, you might want to limit Support department access to paying customers only, but allow Sales department access to everyone.

User Group Permissions

User Group permissions control which of your end-users can select a department when submitting or editing their tickets from the web portal.

Note that it is still possible for agents to change the department to one that a user would not normally have access to. Triggers can also be used to assign any department regardless of user permissions. User group permissions are therefore very much about what the user can select themselves.

User Group	Use
Everyone	☐
Registered	☒
VIP	☒

Note that this permission setting only affects *creating* tickets. If a ticket is assigned to the user, they will be able to see it on the portal, get replies etc, regardless of department permissions; and similarly, if the user is CC'd into the ticket, they will receive ticket messages.

If the user only has permission to use one department, the department field is not shown at all on contact forms etc.

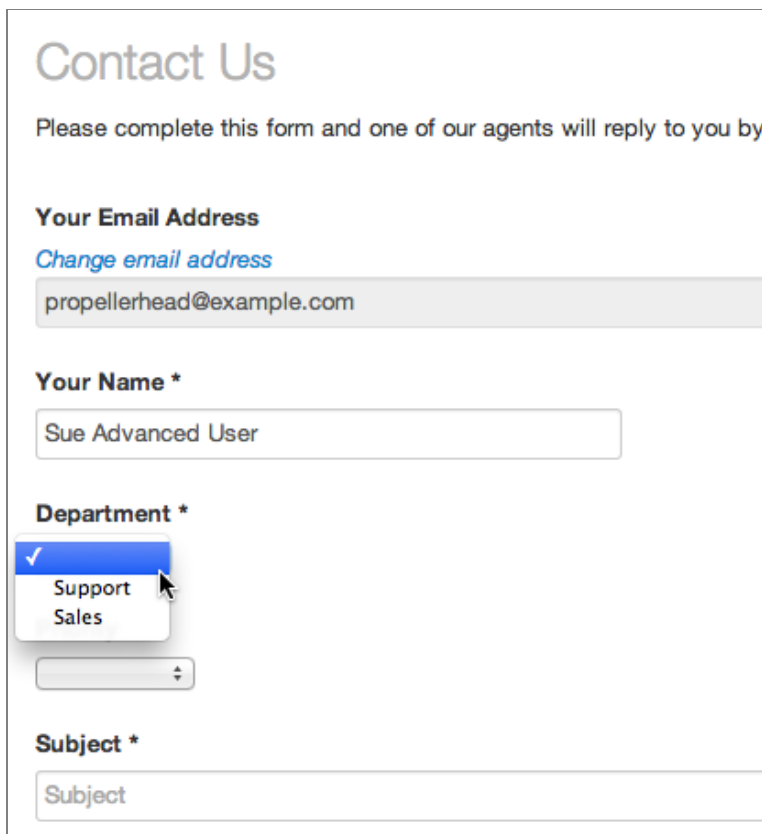
For example, suppose you have two departments, "Support" and "Sales".

You set the permissions for the groups like this:

User Group		Use
Everyone	Sales	☒
Registered		☒

User Group		Use
Everyone	Support	☐
Registered		☒

On your portal contact form, a user who is logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will reply to you by

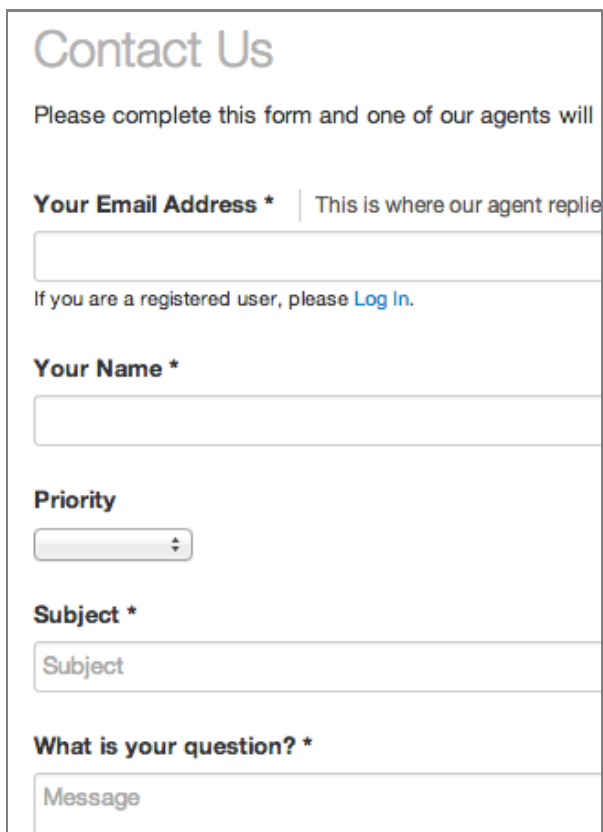
Your Email Address
[Change email address](#)
propellerhead@example.com

Your Name *
Sue Advanced User

Department *
Support
Sales

Subject *
Subject

whereas a user who isn't logged in will see this:



Contact Us

Please complete this form and one of our agents will

Your Email Address * | This is where our agent replies

If you are a registered user, please [Log In](#).

Your Name *

Priority

Subject *
Subject

What is your question? *
Message

The user registration settings under **CRM > Registration** can override department permissions; for example, if the **Everyone** usergroup has permission to create tickets in a department, but registration is required, guest users who aren't logged in will not see the contact form at all.

Chat department permissions for users work as for ticket departments, except that they control which departments users can select when they initiate a chat.

are here to help

Open this chat in a new window

 Start a Chat with an Agent

Your Name
Sue Advanced User

Your Email Address
propellerhead@example.com ([Log Out](#))

Choose department

- ✓ Troubleshooting
- Sales
- Billing**
- Setting up products

5.3. Ticket form layouts

You can configure the fields which appear in the forms used to submit and edit tickets:

- For users, the Contact Us form in the web portal, and any embedded ticket forms.

The left screenshot shows the 'Support Center' interface. It includes a navigation bar with links to Knowledgebase, Downloads, Feedback, Contact Us, and News. Below this is a 'Contact Us' form with fields for 'Your Name', 'Your Email Address', 'Department', 'Subject', and 'What is your question?'. There is also an 'Attachments' section with a file upload button. The right screenshot shows a 'Welcome to A1 Corp' message with a form for submitting a question. It includes a 'Subject' field, a 'What is your question?' text area, a 'Priority' dropdown menu, and a 'Submit' button.

- For agents, the ticket form in the agent interface.

The screenshot shows the 'New Ticket' form in the agent interface. It has a top navigation bar with links to 'Hello, A1 Admin', 'Preferences', 'Help', and 'Log Out'. Below this is a 'New Ticket' form with tabs for 'USER' and 'CC'S'. The 'USER' tab is active, showing a dropdown menu for 'Choose a person to create this ticket for' and a 'Create a new person' button. The 'PROPERTIES' tab is also visible, showing a 'Department' dropdown. The 'TICKET' section includes an 'Agent' dropdown menu, a 'Subject' field, and a rich text editor with various formatting options. At the bottom, there are buttons for 'Send Reply as Awaiting User', 'Email User', and 'Open Tab'.

You can have different layouts depending on the ticket department, and for agents and users within each department.

You set the defaults and validation Default values and data validation are properties of the field, not the form, but you can have different validation rules for users and agents.

To edit a form layout, go to **Tickets > Departments** and click on the **Layout** tab.

By default, all your forms use the same default layout. The buttons at the top of the **Layout** tab enable you to switch between editing the default, or just editing the form for the current department.

The screenshot shows the DeskPRO form editor interface. At the top, there are two tabs: "Use Default Form Layout" and "Use Custom Form Layout for 'Support'". A callout box points to the "Support" tab with the text: "Select whether to edit all departments or just this one". Below the tabs, a blue banner contains the text: "All of your departments are using this layout. If you make changes to this layout, all departments too." A callout box points to this banner with the text: "Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs". Below the banner, there are two tabs: "User Form" and "Agent Form". A callout box points to the "Agent Form" tab with the text: "Select whether to edit the user or agent form using tabs". The main area displays a list of fields currently in the form, each with a menu icon on the left and a settings icon on the right. The fields are: Department, Subject, Message, User Email, Priority, Workflow, Category, CC, Product, CAPTCHA, Attachments, and User confirms T&Cs. A callout box points to the list of fields with the text: "Fields currently in the form". To the right of the main list, there are two panels: "Ticket Fields · Manage Fields" and "User Fields · Manage Fields". The "Ticket Fields" panel contains a blue button labeled "User confirms T&Cs". The "User Fields" panel contains four blue buttons labeled "Name", "Timezone", "Language", and "Level". A callout box points to the "User Fields" panel with the text: "Unused fields". Below the "User Fields" panel, there is a callout box labeled "Remove field from form" pointing to the settings icon of the "Product" field. Below the "Product" field, there is a callout box labeled "Custom field" pointing to the "Attachments" field. Below the "Attachments" field, there is a callout box labeled "Edit field details" pointing to the settings icon of the "Attachments" field.

On the left is the list of fields currently in the form; the blue tabs at right are fields which are available for adding to the form (including custom fields for both tickets and users).

Drag and drop the blue fields you want onto the form. You can also set the order by dragging the fields on the form up and down.

Note that you can add both **ticket** fields and **user** fields. This enables you to have the user submit their identifying data, such as their account number, from the ticket form - see our Knowledgebase article [Adding custom user fields to ticket forms](#) for details.

For all but the compulsory fields, you can click the small gear icon to set the details of how the field should behave:

Options

☒ Show this field during ticket creation

☒ Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket

☒ Only show when there is a value

☒ Allow agents to edit the field

☐ Only show this field based on custom criteria

Done

The options for a field are:

- Show this field during ticket creation
- Let the user view this field after the ticket is created/Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket
 - Only show when there is a value - if enabled, when a user views an existing ticket, they will not see the field if it's empty
- Let the user edit this field after the ticket is created/Allow agents to edit the field
- Only show this field based on custom criteria

So you can, for example, have users set a priority for a ticket when they initially submit it, which they can't then change; or have a field that users can see but only agents can edit.

☒ Only show this field based on custom criteria

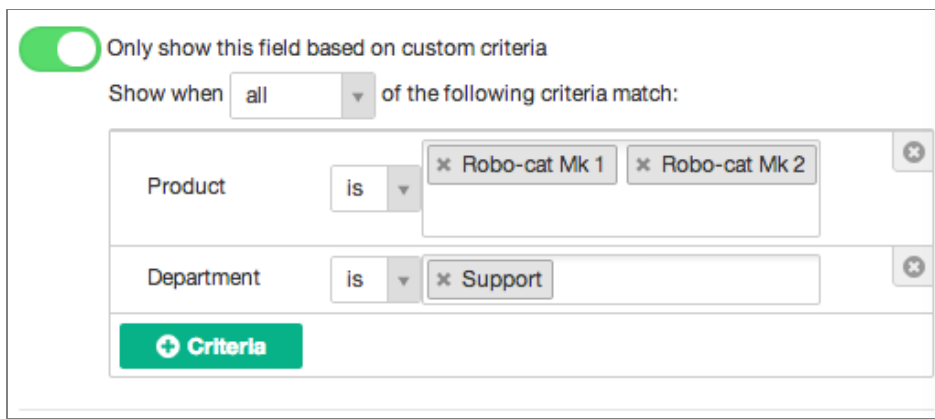
Show when all of the following criteria match:

- Department
- Product
- Category
- Priority
- Workflow**

Only show this field based on custom criteria lets you show a field selectively if it matches **all** or **any** of your specified:

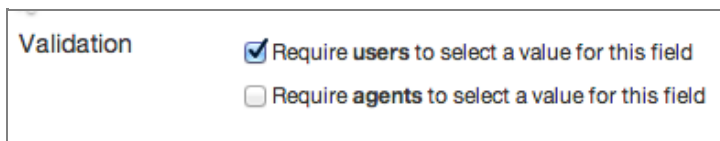
- Department
- Product
- Category
- Priority
- Workflow

For example, suppose your company's "Robo-cat" hardware products have a unique serial number which is useful for debugging, but your other products don't. You want to have the user form ask for a serial number for Robo-cat products only, and only for tickets to the Support department (since users submitting Sales tickets don't have the product yet).



The screenshot shows a configuration panel for a field. At the top, there is a green toggle switch labeled 'Only show this field based on custom criteria'. Below it, the text 'Show when' is followed by a dropdown menu set to 'all' and the text 'of the following criteria match:'. There are two criteria listed: 'Product is' followed by a box containing 'Robo-cat Mk 1' and 'Robo-cat Mk 2', and 'Department is' followed by a box containing 'Support'. Each criterion has a small 'x' icon to its right. At the bottom of the criteria list is a green button with a plus icon and the text 'Criteria'.

You can also set **validation** rules about the field values that the user/agent is allowed/required to enter. You can do this using the individual field settings in **Tickets > Fields**.



The screenshot shows a 'Validation' section with two checkboxes. The first checkbox is checked and labeled 'Require users to select a value for this field'. The second checkbox is unchecked and labeled 'Require agents to select a value for this field'.

The validation rules you set only apply if the field is being displayed.

See the section on [Field data validation](#) for more details.

5.4. Using departments

Departments usually reflect different divisions of your enterprise with different requirements. Here are some common scenarios where you would need to use departments:

- You want to have separate contact forms for support requests and media requests, with different custom fields. You would create Support and Media departments, create custom [ticket form layouts](#) for each department, then [embed the forms in your website](#).
- You want to configure your helpdesk so that your manufacturing staff only see manufacturing tickets, and your retail staff only see retail tickets, while your research staff can see everything. You would create Manufacturing, Retail and Research departments, then control access with [agent permissions](#).
- You want any user to be able to contact your sales department, but for only your premium subscribers to be allowed to create support tickets. You could remove access to the Support department from the Everyone usergroup, then create a usergroup with full access to Support and make sure premium subscribers are added to it.

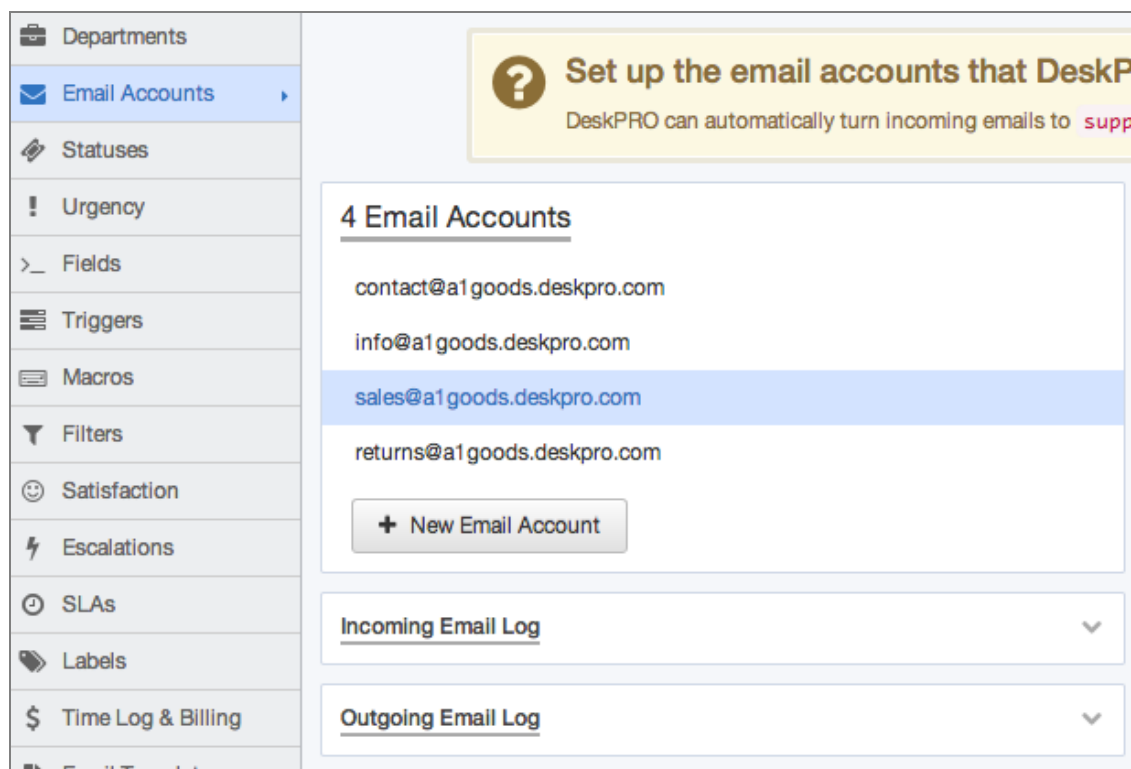
6. Email Accounts

DeskPRO can take incoming user messages to a ticket email account, and convert them to tickets.

Replies from agents (either through the agent interface, or email replies to a notification) are automatically converted into emails to the user.

6.1. Adding ticket email accounts

Under **Tickets > Email Accounts**, you can configure the email accounts that will accept tickets.



Any new message to one of these accounts is automatically converted to a ticket within your helpdesk. If the message is part of an ongoing conversation (i.e. it is in response to a message about an existing ticket), it will be shown as a reply in the agent interface.

Note that a ticket email account can't also be the email address of a DeskPRO user/agent/admin account. This is necessary to prevent email loops, where DeskPRO could end up replying to its own emails endlessly. It's best to add agents using their personal email accounts (e.g. `john.smith@yourcompany.com` or `agent1@yourcompany.com`), rather than with generic addresses like `support@`.

While most helpdesks use email to accept tickets, it's not essential; you could choose to have users submit all tickets through the web portal.

Email account configuration differs slightly between the Cloud and Download products.

DeskPRO Cloud email configuration

DeskPRO Cloud offers cloud-hosted email accounts with addresses ending `@yourcompany.deskpro.com`. By default, you will have a `contact@` account linked to the Support department; you can edit this or add more accounts.

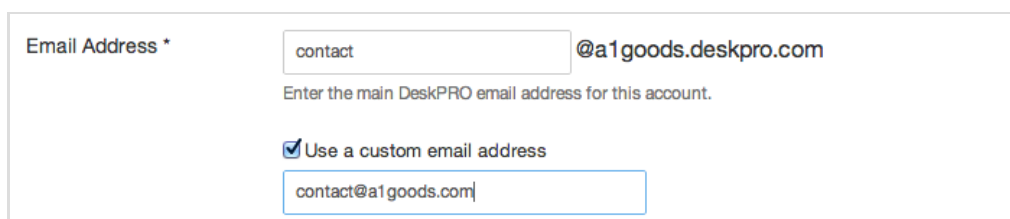
The screenshot shows the '1 Email Account' configuration page in DeskPRO. On the left, there's a sidebar with '1 Email Account' (selected), 'Incoming Email Log', and 'Outgoing Email Log'. The main area is for configuring the email account 'contact@a1goods.deskpro.com'. It includes a 'New Email Account' button, a 'Email Address *' field with the address 'contact@a1goods.deskpro.com', and instructions to 'Enter the main DeskPRO email address for this account.' There are checkboxes for 'Use a custom email address' and 'Add custom email aliases'. Below this is the 'New Ticket Trigger' section, which has a dropdown for 'When a user submits a new ticket by emailing this address:' with options 'Set Department' (selected, set to 'Support') and 'Send User Email'. An 'Action' button is at the bottom of this section. At the very bottom of the form are 'Save', 'Reset', and 'Delete' buttons.

You could ask users to submit tickets to these `deskpro.com` accounts, but you would probably prefer to use addresses with your own domain, like `help@yourcompany.com`.

You can configure DeskPRO to use an address like this (a custom email address). Users will only see the custom email address you set up: e.g. they would send email to `help@yourcompany.com`, and receive email from `help@yourcompany.com`, without ever seeing the `@yourcompany.deskpro.com` address.

To set up a custom email address:

- 1 In **Tickets > Email Accounts** select the cloud account you want to use and check **Use a custom email address**. Enter the custom address you want to use.



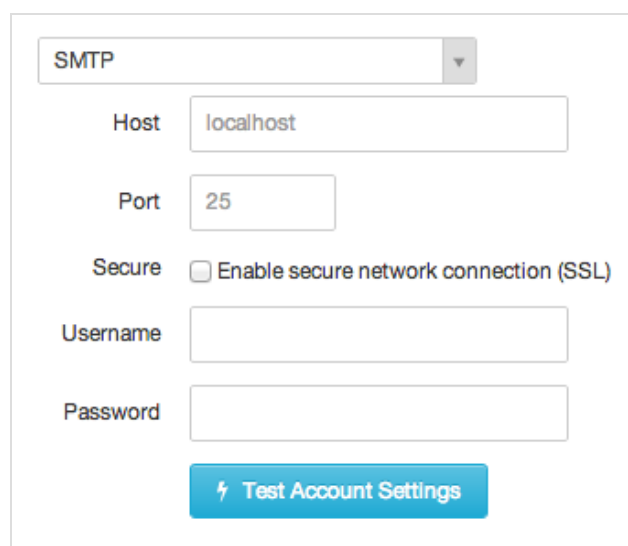
Email Address * @a1goods.deskpro.com
Enter the main DeskPRO email address for this account.

☒ Use a custom email address

- 2 Configure your email system to forward all mail sent to the custom address to the DeskPRO Cloud account: e.g. forward from to . Consult the documentation for the email system you use (e.g. Outlook, Gmail) to find out how to do this.
- 3 Set up how outgoing email will be sent; i.e. mail *from* the custom address. There are three options:

- **Send mail through DeskPRO:** sends email from our cloud servers; you will need to make some DNS changes to ensure email isn't marked as spam. See the section [Sending email using DeskPRO Cloud email servers](#) for details.
- **SMTP** sends email using your SMTP server.

You will need to provide some SMTP settings:



SMTP
Host
Port
Secure ☐ Enable secure network connection (SSL)
Username
Password

If you don't know these, you will probably be able to find them by looking at the settings of your email client.

- **Gmail or Google Apps** just enter the account password. If you have 2-step verification enabled on the Google account, will you need to create an [application-specific password](#) and enter that instead.

Sending email using DeskPRO Cloud email servers

If you use a custom email address and you want to send outgoing email from the DeskPRO servers, it's important that you take some additional steps to avoid your helpdesk email messages being wrongly flagged as spam.

Internet providers use anti-spam systems called SPF and DKIM, which compare the server that sends a message to the From: address. You need to modify your DNS to indicate that DeskPRO's email delivery provider (SendGrid) is authorised to send email on your behalf.

Make the following changes to the DNS record of your domain, replacing `yourcompany.com` with your actual domain:

- 1 Create a CNAME for `dpmail.yourcompany.com` to `sendgrid.net`, for example:
`dpmail.yourcompany.com CNAME sendgrid.net.`
- 2 Add a DNS [TXT record](#) for SPF, or modify your existing SPF TXT record, to whitelist SendGrid as a server allowed to send mail from your domain. Consult this [SPF Record Syntax guide](#) for full details. Here are some examples:
 - Basic example: `v=spf1 a mx include:sendgrid.net ~all` - doesn't whitelist a particular server, just means all servers are considered neutral (neither spam nor not spam)
 - If you use Google Apps for email:
`v=spf1 a mx include:_spf.google.com include:sendgrid.net ~all`
 - To whitelist an SMTP server:
`v=spf1 a mx include:smtp.yourcompany.com include:sendgrid.net ~all`
- 3 Create the following CNAME records for DKIM:
 - `smtpapi._domainkey.example.com CNAME dkim.sendgrid.net.`
 - `smtpapi._domainkey.dpmail.example.com CNAME dkim.sendgrid.net.`

If you don't know how to change your DNS configuration or don't have the right access to do so, consider using a different Outgoing Email setting.

If your company doesn't have an SMTP server, an easy alternative is to set up a Gmail or Google Apps email account that is only for helpdesk messages.

DeskPRO Download email configuration

Here's how to add a ticket email account in DeskPRO Download:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Email Accounts** and click **New Email Account**.

The screenshot shows the 'Email Accounts' configuration page in DeskPRO. It is divided into several sections: 'Email Address *' with a text input field and a note to enter the main email address; a checkbox for 'This account has additional email addresses associated with it (aliases)'; an 'Enabled' section with a checked checkbox 'Enable this email account' and a note about email processing; a 'Type' dropdown menu set to 'Ticket Email Account' with a descriptive note; an 'Account Details *' section with a 'POP3' dropdown, 'Host' (localhost), 'Port' (110), 'Secure' checkbox (unchecked), 'Username', and 'Password' fields, followed by a 'Test Account Settings' button; an 'Outgoing Email *' section with a 'Send mail using PHP mail()' dropdown, a note about the PHP Mail function, and another 'Test Account Settings' button; and a 'New Ticket Trigger' section with a header 'When a user submits a new ticket by emailing this address:', checkboxes for 'Set Department' (checked) and 'Send User Email' (unchecked), a 'Support' dropdown, and an 'Action' button. At the bottom are 'Save' and 'Reset' buttons.

Email Address *

Enter the main email address for this account.

☐ This account has additional email addresses associated with it (aliases)

Enabled

☒ Enable this email account

When enabled, new emails will be processed from this account and outgoing emails may be sent out from this address.

Type

Ticket Email Account

Ticket accounts are email accounts that DeskPRO will download emails from and process into tickets and replies.

Account Details *

POP3

Host localhost

Port 110

Secure ☐ Enable secure network connection

Username

Password

Test Account Settings

Outgoing Email *

Send mail using PHP mail()

PHP Mail Send mail through the server `mail()` function.

Test Account Settings

New Ticket Trigger

When a user submits a new ticket by emailing this address:

☒ Set Department Support

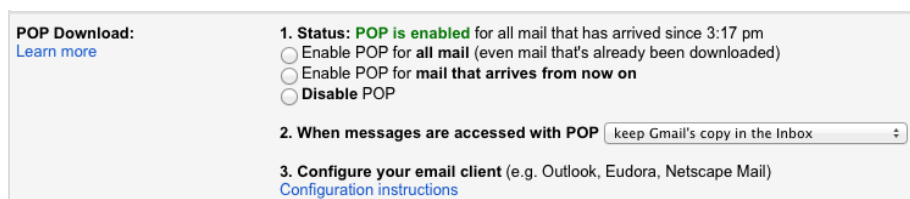
☐ Send User Email

Action

Save Reset

- 2 **Email Address** is simply the user-facing email address you want to use for support e.g. `support@yourcompany.com`
- 3 Leave **Type** as **Ticket Email Account**
- 4 Select the type of email account you are using, and enter the details.

- For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, enter the server details requested. You can find these in the settings of your email program or mail provider. **Host** means the address of the IMAP or POP3 (incoming mail) server.
- If you use a Gmail or Google Apps account, you must ensure that **POP Download** is enabled in the **Settings** page.



The screenshot shows the 'POP Download' settings interface. On the left, it says 'POP Download:' with a 'Learn more' link. The main area contains three sections: 1. Status: 'POP is enabled' for all mail that has arrived since 3:17 pm, with three radio button options: 'Enable POP for all mail (even mail that's already been downloaded)', 'Enable POP for mail that arrives from now on', and 'Disable POP'. 2. When messages are accessed with POP: A dropdown menu currently set to 'keep Gmail's copy in the Inbox'. 3. Configure your email client (e.g. Outlook, Eudora, Netscape Mail) with a 'Configuration instructions' link.

Enable POP for **all mail** if you want DeskPRO to import all email messages in the account inbox as tickets. Enable POP for **mail that arrives from now on** if you just want DeskPRO to process new emails.

5

For **IMAP** and **POP3** accounts, you must specify how DeskPRO sends outgoing email.

- The default **Send mail using PHP mail()** option sends emails directly from your DeskPRO installation with a PHP function - this should work without extra configuration in Linux environments, but you may need to configure PHP further.
- For more reliability, we recommend sending email via a separate SMTP server. You must ensure that your server is configured to relay mail from your DeskPRO installation: consult the documentation for the SMTP server on how to do this.
- You can also use a Gmail or Google Apps account to send mail.

6

Click **Test Account Settings** to try sending an email to yourself and confirm that DeskPRO can send email. If you get a connection error, you may need to change your network configuration to open up the port mentioned in the error.

6.2. Email account New Ticket triggers

Every email account you create has two simple **New Ticket triggers**. These specify what happens automatically when a new ticket is created from an email sent to the account.

The **Set Department** trigger sets the department of the newly-created ticket. Selecting a department for this trigger is compulsory, since tickets must always have a department. See [linking a department to an email account](#) for more details.

The **Send User Email** trigger enables you to send an email to the user who is associated with the ticket. You can use the **New Ticket Auto-Response** template for a simple acknowledgement email.

You could also use a custom template, for example if you wanted to have a different auto-response for each department. See the section [Customizing the email templates](#) for more details.

You can choose whether to **Include CC's**: if selected, this takes any non-agents who were cc'd in to the original email message, and adds them as CCs to the ticket. This means they will receive copies of any emails sent by DeskPRO about this ticket, even though they are not the ticket owner.

The **From Name** setting sets the name the user will see the email as coming from:

- **Helpdesk Name** is the helpdesk name you have set in **Setup > Settings**
- Alternatively you can set a **custom name** that you define.

The **From Email** controls which email address the response email comes from. You can either choose:

- **The account set on the ticket**.g. if the user emailed help@yourcompany.com to create the ticket, the reply is sent from `help@`.
- A **specific account** - for example, you might prefer to have auto-responses sent from `info@` or `noreply@`.

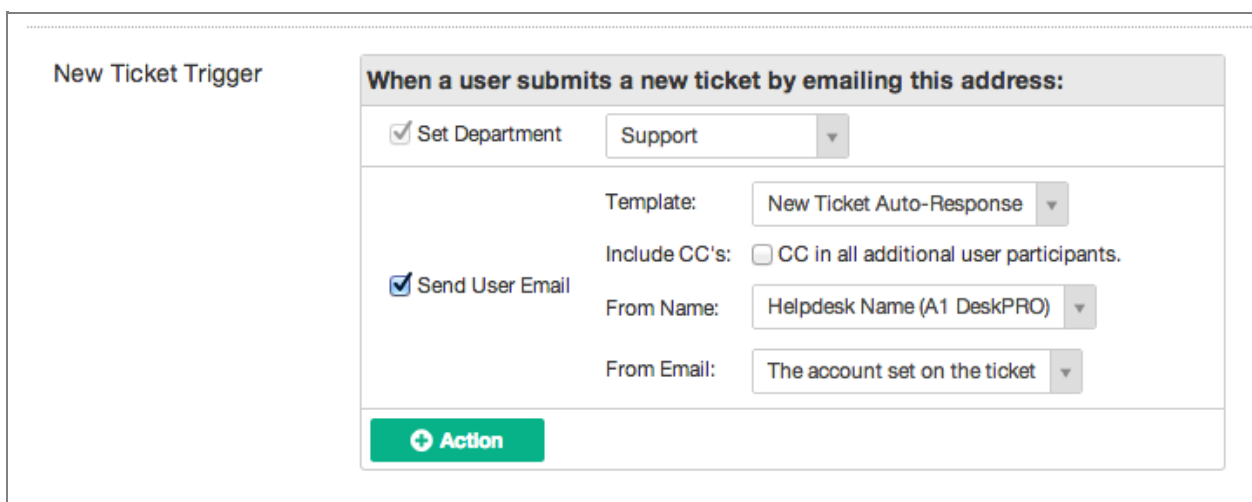
6.3. Linking a department to an email account

The link between a department and an email account is made using built-in [triggers](#).

Linking email accounts to departments

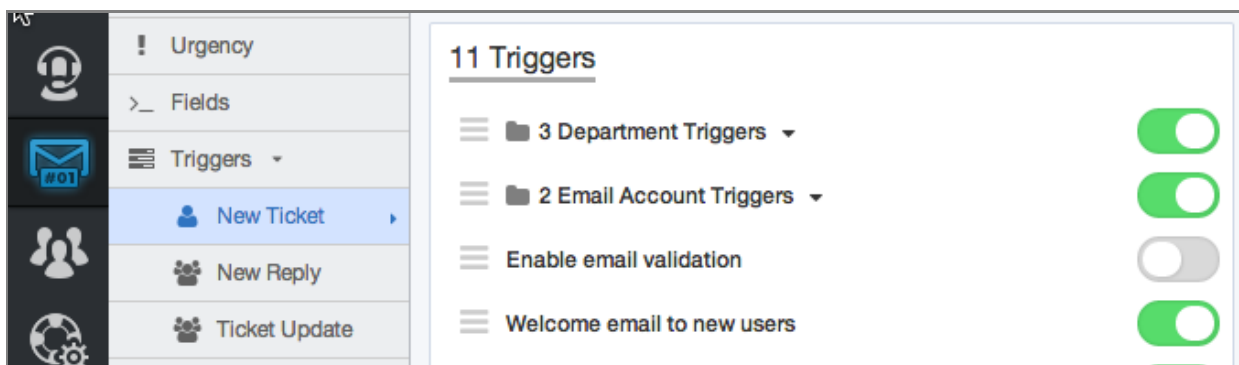
Each email account has a **New Ticket** trigger which assigns tickets submitted to that email account to a specified department. For example, you could have all tickets created by emailing `support@yourcompany.com` assigned to the Support department.

You can view and edit the trigger by going to **Tickets > Email Accounts** and selecting the relevant email account.



The screenshot shows the 'New Ticket Trigger' configuration form. It has a title 'New Ticket Trigger' on the left. The main form area is titled 'When a user submits a new ticket by emailing this address:'. It contains several settings: a checked checkbox for 'Set Department' with a dropdown menu set to 'Support'; a 'Template' dropdown set to 'New Ticket Auto-Response'; a checked checkbox for 'Send User Email'; an 'Include CC's' checkbox with the text 'CC in all additional user participants.'; a 'From Name' dropdown set to 'Helpdesk Name (A1 DeskPRO)'; and a 'From Email' dropdown set to 'The account set on the ticket'. At the bottom is a green 'Action' button with a plus icon.

You can also view and edit these triggers for each email account in **Email Account Triggers** under **Tickets > Triggers > New Ticket**.



Linking non-email tickets to email accounts

The **New Ticket** trigger in a department's properties screen sets the email account to use for tickets not submitted through email - for example, via the portal an embedded form, or the API - in that department. The selected account will be used to send messages related to the ticket. For example, a ticket submitted to the Support department via the web would have its emails sent from `support@yourcompany.com`.

New Ticket Trigger	When a new ticket is submitted through the portal in this department: ☒ Set Email Account helpdeska766@gmail.com Template: New Ticket Auto-Response Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants. ☒ Send User Email From Name: Helpdesk Name (A1 DeskPRO) From Email: The account set on the ticket + Action
Ticket Changed Trigger	When a ticket department is changed to this department: ☐ Set Email Account + Action

You can also view and edit these triggers for each department in **Department Triggers** under **Tickets > Triggers > New Ticket** and **Tickets > Triggers > Ticket Update**

! Urgency >_ Fields ≡ Triggers ▾ 👤 New Ticket ▶ 👥 New Reply 👥 Ticket Update 📄 Macros 🔍 Filters	11 Triggers ☰ 3 Department Triggers ▲ ☒ Use these triggers if you want to perform actions based on the department a user selects when submitting a ticket from the web interface. Support Sales Delivery
--	--

The **Ticket Changed** trigger sets the email account when an existing ticket is changed to the department.

6.4. Running an email-only helpdesk

You may want to offer support by email only, without users being aware of the web portal.

To set this up:

- 1 Make sure users don't have to validate their accounts. In **CRM > Registration**, select **Enable Registration** and disable all the registration and validation requirements. Enable the **Everyone** group.
- 2 Optionally, completely disable the portal from **Portal > Portal Editor** using the **Disable Portal** button.
- 3 If you want to leave the portal enabled (perhaps because you want it to be available to a certain group of users), you can remove links to the portal from email notifications by editing the templates in **Tickets > Email Templates**
 - **Layout > Footer**- remove

```
{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}<a href="{{ deskpro_url }}">{{ deskpro_url }}</a>{% endif %}
```
 - **User Email Templates > Ticket Emails**- in "New Ticket Confirmation" template, remove the section referencing `ticket.link` and save the template:

```
{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}  
<br /><br />  
  
View and manage this ticket online:  
<a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>  
{% endif %}
```
 - Repeat above step for "New Ticket Created by Agent", "New Agent Reply" and "User Reply Auto-Response".

6.5. Email handling options

Adding agents as followers with cc:

By default, if the user cc's an agent into a ticket email, the agent will be added as a follower of the ticket.

You may not want users to be able to set agents as followers; bear in mind that adding an agent as a follower means they can always see a ticket, overriding other permissions.

You can disable this feature from **Tickets > Settings**:

Email Settings

☒ Process agents that are in the CC line of incoming emails

When enabled, any agent email addresses that are in the CC line of incoming emails will be added as followers on tickets. This means, for example, an end-user could add an agent to their ticket by CC'ing them.

Ticket forwarding: inbound

Agents may sometimes receive an email to their individual address that would be better handled through your helpdesk. For example, the agent the user has emailed may not be the best person to address the issue, may not be available to respond, or just doesn't want support correspondence cluttering up their inbox.

Inbound ticket forwarding lets agents forward an email to one of the helpdesk's ticket email accounts, and have DeskPRO process it as a ticket from the original user, not the agent.

For example, `user@example.com` emails `carol.smith@yourcompany.com`, who forwards the message to `help@yourcompany.com`. If inbound ticket forwarding is enabled, your helpdesk will create a ticket with the user `user@domain.com`.

Agents can add a reply to the top of the message they forward, and DeskPRO will deliver it to the user.

To enable or disable this function, go to **Tickets > Forward Settings** and use the **Enable smart-parsing of emails forwarded into the helpdesk by agents** checkbox. It is enabled by default.

This is the process DeskPRO uses to determine if an email has been forwarded:

- 1 **Subject match:** The helpdesk looks for 'FW:' in the email subject line of an email from an agent's email account. It takes this to mean that the agent is trying to create a ticket for a user. (Emails forwarded by non-agents will be treated as normal tickets).
- 2 **Sender match:** The helpdesk will then try and find the details for the user who originally sent the email. Different email programs will include this information in different ways; this is a typical example:

-----Original Message-----

From: Victoria Johnson [mailto:user@domain.com]

Sent: 05 November 2012 14:38

To: agent_email@yourcompany.com

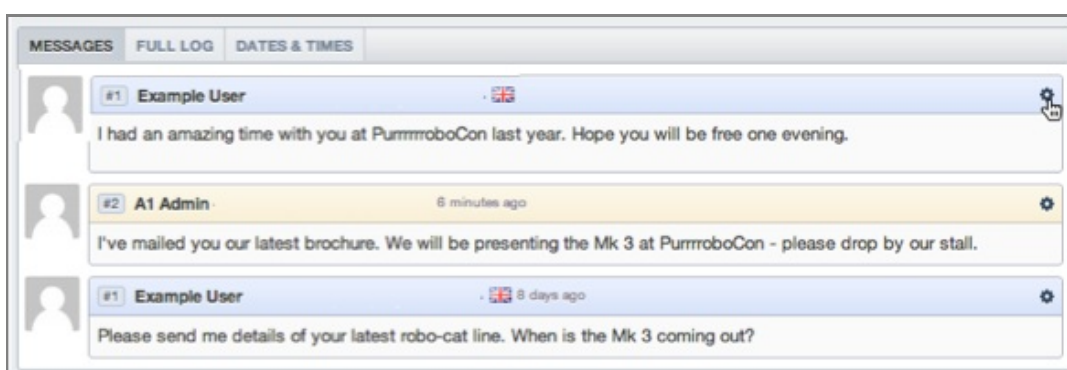
Subject: Support Request

In this case, the helpdesk would match the user as Victoria Johnson, with the user email being `user@domain.com`.

In some cases, DeskPRO will not be able to find the user's details. This is typically because the format from your mail client is unknown to DeskPRO, you are using an unsupported language, or your email system has modified the headers in a way that prevents DeskPRO determining the original sender. In this case an error message will be sent to back to the agent, including the original email.
- 3 **Reply match:** DeskPRO will now look to see if the agent added a reply. If a reply is found, this response will be emailed to the end-user.
- 4 **Processing:** DeskPRO will now process the relevant triggers and create the ticket.

Ticket forwarding: outbound

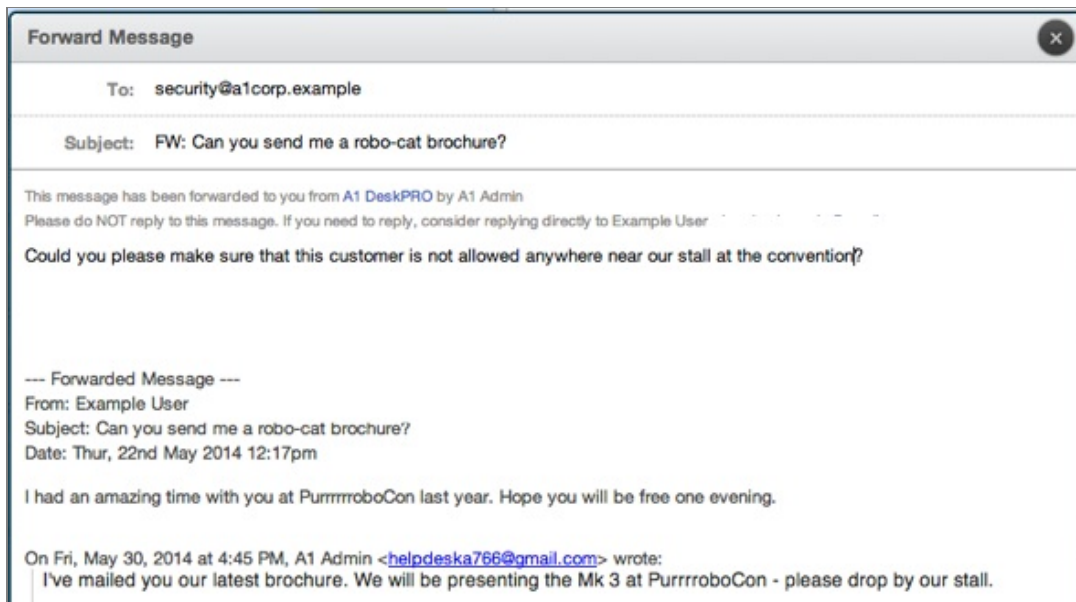
Agents can forward individual ticket messages via email, using the **Forward message** option accessible from the gear icon to the right of each message.



This is useful for forwarding messages outside of the helpdesk if they would better be dealt with as a private email conversation.

Under **Tickets > Forward Settings** under **Ticket Forwarding - Outbound** you can change which email account is used to send the emails.

By default, the forwarded email will appear to come from ticket email account's address, but you can choose to use the agent's address in the From: field instead. For this to work, you may need to configure your email server to accept messages with any From: address.



7. Ticket Fields

You can add to the information stored on a ticket using optional built-in fields and custom fields.

[Categories](#) are a general-purpose field, often used to handle grouping tickets within a department.

[Priorities](#) are used to describe how important a ticket is. Priority values are a ranked series of text values e.g. "Minor"/"Routine"/"Urgent"/"Critical".

[Workflows](#) are used to record the ticket's progress through your support process - for example "Triage"/"Troubleshooting"/"Follow-Up".

[Products](#) usually denote a product or service that your helpdesk supports. If enabled, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and articles.

[Custom fields](#) are the most flexible way to add extra information to tickets. You define the name of the field as well as the possible values (text string, multiple choice, etc.).

For any of these fields, you can set a default value. You can also use **validation** rules to require users and/or agents to select a value for the field.

Note that for these fields to be visible, they must be included in the relevant ticket form layout under **Tickets > Departments**.

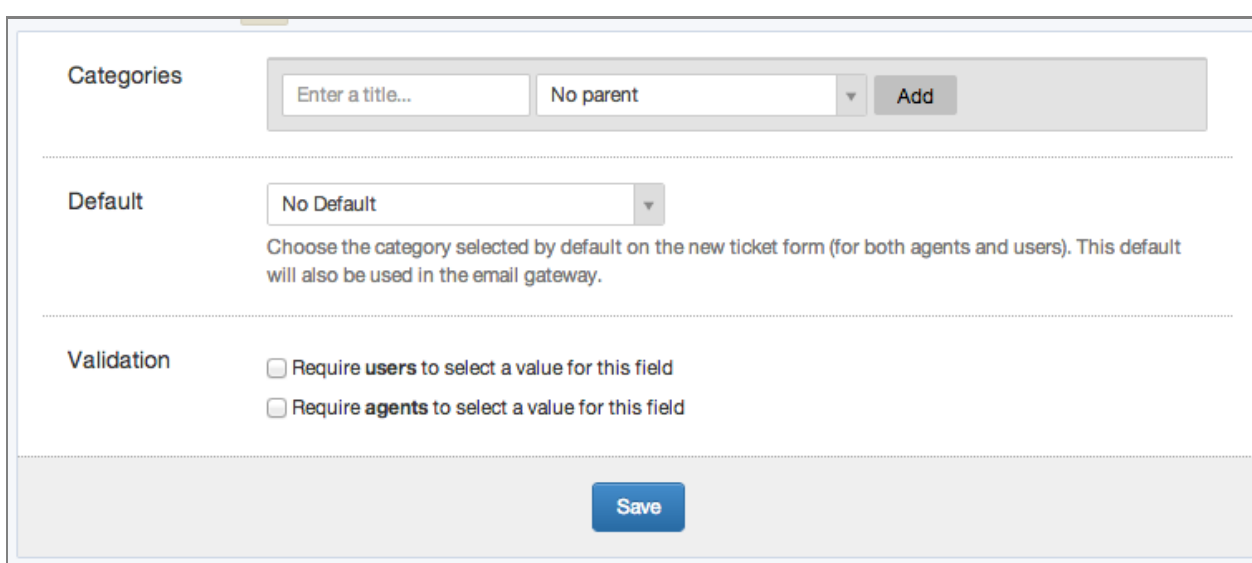
7.1. Categories

Categories are a general-purpose field, often used to group similar tickets.

Categories can be used to break down types of tickets within departments. For example, you could use categories to classify tickets as 'Product Defect'/'Other'; that would then enable you to compare the number of tickets about product defects between different departments.

To create categories:

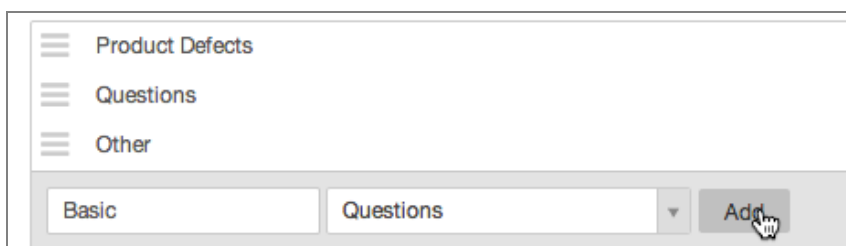
- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Categories** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Categories**, fill in the name of the category you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Enter your desired categories, then click **Save**.



The screenshot shows the 'Categories' configuration page. It has three main sections: 'Categories', 'Default', and 'Validation'. The 'Categories' section has a text input 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu 'No parent', and an 'Add' button. The 'Default' section has a dropdown menu 'No Default' and a description: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' The 'Validation' section has two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom is a blue 'Save' button.

Categories can have subcategories one layer deep. For example, you could divide the 'Questions' category into 'Basic' and 'Advanced'.

To create a 'child' category, enter a new category as normal, then change the drop-down menu to the right from **No parent** to the desired parent category. For example, this would create the subcategory 'Basic' within 'Questions':



The screenshot shows the category creation form. At the top, there is a list of existing categories: 'Product Defects', 'Questions', and 'Other'. Below this, there is a text input with 'Basic', a dropdown menu with 'Questions' selected, and an 'Add' button with a mouse cursor hovering over it.

If categories are enabled, users and agents can select a category when they create a ticket, through the portal Contact Us form or the agent interface, respectively.

Setting a **Default** category prefills that category in the user and agent forms. The user/agent can change the category; they can clear it unless validation is enabled. Tickets submitted via email will be assigned to the default category.

Under **Validation** you can require users and/or agents to select a category when they submit a ticket through the web. This does not apply to tickets submitted via email; so if it is important that all tickets are assigned a category, you should set a default category.

7.2. Priorities

Priorities are an alternative way to record how important it is to answer a certain ticket.

Priorities differ from urgency in the following ways:

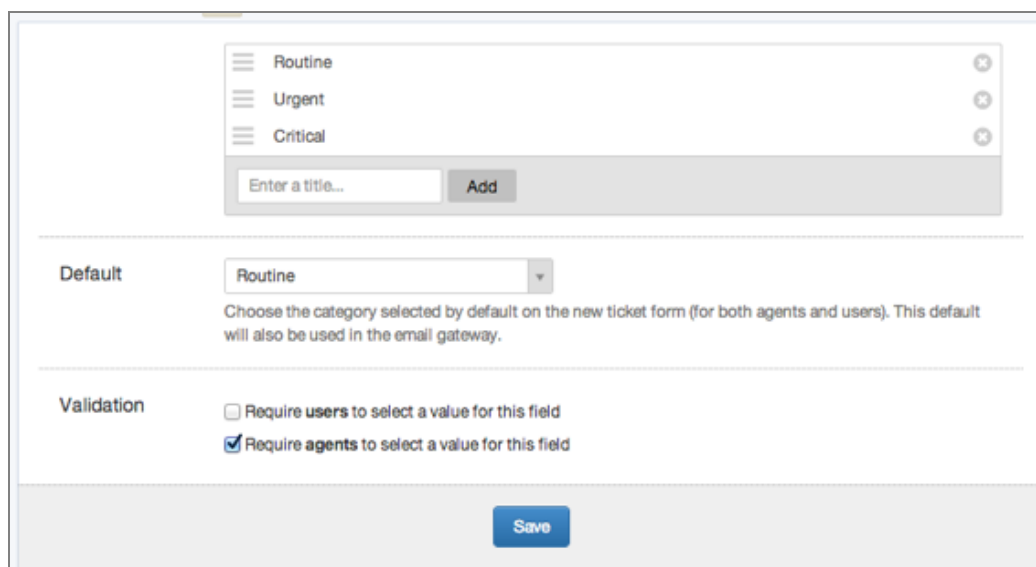
- Priorities are an ordered set of named values defined by you, e.g. 'Routine', 'Urgent', 'Critical', whereas urgency is a numerical score from 1 to 10.
- Actions from triggers, SLAs, macros and escalations cannot *increase* or *decrease* priority; they can only set a particular priority value. In contrast, you can have an action that increases or decreases urgency by a set amount.
- Priority can be seen and set by users, whereas urgency is only ever visible to agents.

Priorities can be useful when the service you offer has different tiers. For example, suppose you offer a service plan where you allow users to declare a certain number of 'Critical' tickets, which you guarantee to answer faster than normal tickets.

You could implement this in DeskPRO by setting 'Critical' as a priority, allowing users to select it when they submit a ticket, and then defining an SLA that is applied to tickets with 'Critical' priority.

To create priorities:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Priorities** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Priorities**, fill in the name of the priority you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the priorities you want.
- 4 Drag priorities by the handles at left to order them, from the least important at the top to the most important at the bottom.



The screenshot shows the 'Priorities' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing priorities: 'Routine', 'Urgent', and 'Critical', each with a handle icon on the left and a delete icon on the right. Below this list is a form to add a new priority, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. Underneath the add form, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu currently set to 'Routine'. A note below the dropdown states: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' At the bottom, there is a 'Validation' section with two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' (unchecked) and 'Require agents to select a value for this field' (checked). A 'Save' button is located at the very bottom of the form.

The order of priorities is used:

- when displaying them to users/agents
- to enable agents to order tickets by ascending or descending priority in the list pane

Setting defaults and validation for priorities works just as with categories.

7.3. Workflows

DeskPRO admins often want to be able to add extra ticket statuses; for example, to record that a ticket is brand new and needs to be assigned to the right team, or that it is ready to be resolved and should be reviewed by quality control.

However, the core function of ticket status is to record whether an agent or user is due to reply to a ticket. Allowing extra custom status values would disrupt this, so we don't allow it.

Instead, we provide **workflows** as a way to record the stage of your support process that a ticket has reached.

For example, you could have workflow values of 'Triage', 'Support' and 'Quality Control', then use a trigger to set all new, unassigned tickets to 'Triage'.

To create workflows:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Workflows** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Workflows**, fill in the name of the workflow value you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the workflow values you want.

The screenshot shows the 'Workflows' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing workflows: 'Triage', 'Support', and 'QC'. Each item has a three-line handle on the left for dragging and a close button (an 'x' in a circle) on the right. Below the list is a form to add a new workflow, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...' and an 'Add' button. The page is divided into sections by dashed lines. The 'Default' section contains a dropdown menu currently set to 'Triage' and a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' The 'Validation' section contains two checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

You can drag workflows by the handles at left to order them. This only affects the order of display to agents.

7.4. Products

Products are a way to link tickets to products or services that your helpdesk supports. For example, a company which makes software might use products to track different versions and platforms.

Note that, unlike the other built-in fields, products can apply to items other than tickets, such as feedback and Knowledgebase articles.

Products can be nested into sub-products. These work in the same way as nested categories.

To create products:

- 1 Go to **Tickets > Fields** and make sure that the **Products** switch control is on.
- 2 Click **Products**, fill in the name of the product you want to create in the **Enter a title...** box, and click **Add**.
- 3 Repeat until you have made all the products you want.

The screenshot shows the 'Products' configuration page in DeskPRO. At the top, there is a list of existing products with drag handles on the left and delete icons on the right. The products listed are 'Robo-cat', 'Robo-cat Mk 1', 'Robo-cat Mk 2', 'Drivers', 'Windows', and 'Mac'. Below this list is a form to add a new product, consisting of a text input field labeled 'Enter a title...', a dropdown menu currently showing 'Drivers', and an 'Add' button. Underneath the form, there is a 'Default' section with a dropdown menu set to 'No Default' and a descriptive text: 'Choose the category selected by default on the new ticket form (for both agents and users). This default will also be used in the email gateway.' Below that is a 'Validation' section with two checked checkboxes: 'Require users to select a value for this field' and 'Require agents to select a value for this field'. At the bottom of the form is a blue 'Save' button.

You can drag products by the handles at the left to order them. This only affects the order of display to users/agents.

Setting defaults and validation for product works as with categories.

7.5. Custom fields

Custom ticket fields are the most flexible way to add extra information to a ticket. You choose both the name of the field, and the type of values it can store.

You can also add custom fields to users, organizations, and chats. These are all separate systems; even if you have a custom ticket field and a custom user field with the same name, you'll need to set their properties separately.

Note that you can include both custom ticket fields and custom *user* fields in the ticket form. See [Ticket Form Layouts](#) for details.

To create a custom field, go to **Tickets > Fields**, then click the **+ Add** button in the Custom Field section.

Select the type of field you want. There are a number of different types you can use, depending on the kind of data you want to store.

Enter a **Title** and **Description**. Both of these can be displayed if the field is included in a form: make sure they explain the purpose of the field in a way that will make sense to the people who will be using it.

Remember that a custom field must be added to a form layout under **Tickets > Departments** for it be visible to users/agents.

Custom field types

- Text inputs, with an optional default value (pre-filled text):
 - **Text**: a single-line text input box that users/agents can type into; accepts up to 136 characters

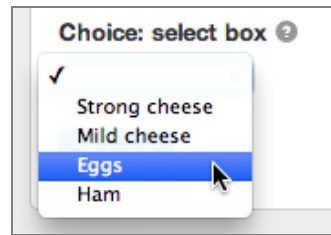


- **Textarea**: a larger multi-line text input area that users/agents can type into



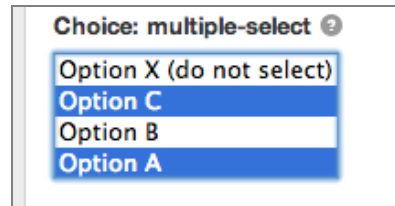
- **Choice**: a set of options you define for users/agents to pick from, with the option to set pre-selected default(s). Can be presented in the following ways:

- **Select box**



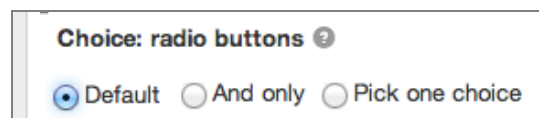
Only one can be selected at a time

- **Multiple-select box**



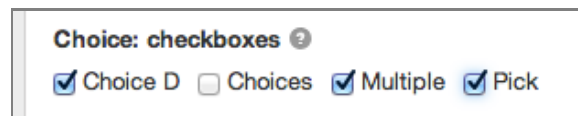
Allows multiple selections

- **Radio buttons**



Only one can be selected at a time

- **Checkboxes**

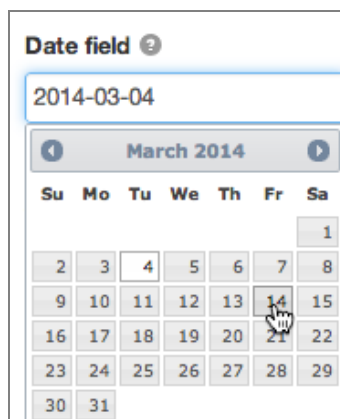


Allows multiple selections

- **Toggle:** a simple checkbox; can either be on or off by default; can require user or agent to check it (for example, to confirm they accept your terms and conditions)



- **Date:** stores a calendar date; users/agents can select from a calendar, or enter a date in text in YYYY-MM-DD format.



- **Display:** this type of field is just used to display HTML, and cannot take input; you could use it for warnings or disclaimers or design customization.



- **Hidden:** a special field that's never visible to users, which can take information from cookies or parameters in the URL; you can use this to capture information about the user's browsing session which agents can then see as part of the ticket.

7.6. Field data validation

You can set **validation** requirements for field types which take input: this enables you enforce rules when users/agents enter data.

For example, all input field types let you specify if entering a value is required for users and for agents:

User Validation	☐ No user validation
	☒ Require the user to provide a value
Agent Validation	☒ No agent validation
	☐ Require the agent to provide a value

With the setting above, the user won't be able to submit a ticket until they've entered a value for the field.

If you enable a new field and require a value, agents will be prompted to select or enter a value for the missing field before replying to the ticket.

You can control when a field is *displayed* and *editable* from the ticket form layout editor in the **Departments Layout** tab. The validation rules you set will only apply to tickets where the field is being displayed. See the [Ticket form layouts](#) section for details.

Options

☒ Show this field during ticket creation

☒ Show the field to agents when viewing the ticket
☒ Only show when there is a value

☒ Allow agents to edit the field

☐ Only show this field based on custom criteria

Done

Text validation with regular expressions

The **text** and **textarea** custom field types allow validation of the content using **regular expressions**; instead of just requiring a value, you can require the user/agent to enter a value that matches a certain pattern.

For example, suppose you need to know users' account numbers to help them. When a user submits a ticket via the web, you could use a regular expression to make sure they have entered an account number in the correct format.

Here are some examples:

```
/^[d]{8}$/ - require an 8 digit account number
```

```
/^[a-zA-Z0-9]{6,32}$/ - require an alphanumeric username 6 to 32 characters long
```

```
/(\d{5}-\d{4})|(\d{5})/ - require a valid US zip code
```

The regular expression system DeskPRO uses is [PHP Perl Compatible Regular Expressions](http://www.php.net/manual/en/regexp.reference.pcre.php). We suggest using <http://www.regexr.com/> to write and test regular expressions.

Date validation options

You can also specify additional **date validation** options:

Default value	☒ Use date at time of submission ☐ Specific date
Valid week days	☒ Monday ☒ Tuesday ☒ Wednesday ☒ Thursday ☒ Friday ☐ Saturday ☐ Sunday
Valid dates	☐ Any date is valid ☐ Date range ☒ Days before/after Date selected must be between 1 and 365 days from the time of submission

8. Automating the Helpdesk

DeskPRO provides a number of ways to automatically process tickets. You can use these to have the helpdesk carry out routine procedures, leaving your agents with more time to focus on helping users. You can also set automatic rules to bring tickets to the attention of agents and help them identify urgent tickets.

- **Triggers** run actions when a ticket is created, replied to or updated. DeskPRO's built-in processes, such as sending out agent notifications and validating user email addresses, are controlled by triggers, and you can edit them to change how they behave.
- **Escalations** run actions on tickets based on the elapsed time the ticket has been in a certain state.
- **SLAs** track your helpdesk's response time goals, highlight tickets to agents when a goal is failed or close to failing, and can run actions.
- **Macros** carry out a series of actions on a ticket when applied by an agent, automating repetitive tasks. Agents can create their own macros without admin access (unlike SLAs, triggers and escalations).

8.1. Ticket triggers

Triggers are automatic processes that can perform **actions** in response to ticket **events**. A given trigger can respond to one of these three event types:

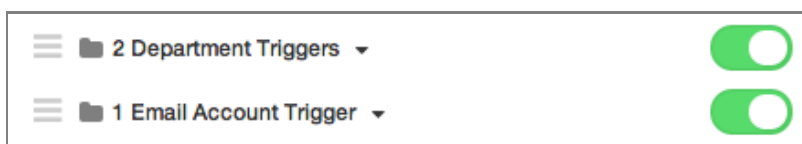
- **New Ticket** - a new ticket is created
- **New Reply** - an agent/user replies to a ticket
- **Ticket Update** - a ticket property changes

Before a trigger runs, it checks its **criteria**. The trigger's actions will only run *if* the criteria are met. For example, you can have a trigger which runs when a new ticket is created (the event), if it was created by any user from a particular organization on a weekend (the criteria).

Many of the built-in features that the helpdesk carries out by default, such as sending out emails, are run by triggers.

Simple triggers

DeskPRO has built-in **simple triggers**.



These have fixed **criteria**, which you can't edit.

- **Department Triggers:** each department on your helpdesk has a simple trigger which runs when a ticket is created through any means *except* email: either through the agent interface, the web portal, or an embedded form or widget.

These triggers link tickets submitted through the web to an email account; for example, tickets submitted to your Sales department have their messages sent from your `sales@` account because of a department trigger.

Department triggers can be used to send an auto-response email to the user, as with Email Account triggers.

You can view and edit the simple Department triggers from **Tickets > Departments** as well as **Tickets > Triggers**.

- **Email Account triggers:** each account you have configured to receive tickets has a simple trigger which runs when a new ticket is created via email.

These triggers link your email accounts to departments by automatically assigning all new tickets created via an email account to a specified department. For example, emails sent to your `sales@` account create tickets in the Sales department because of an email trigger.

Email Account triggers can also be used to send an auto-response email to the user using the **Send User Email** action. The default New Ticket Auto-Response email template sends the user a simple acknowledgement message.

"helpdeska766@gmail.com" Email Account Trigger

This is a email account trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket by sending an email to this email address.

Criteria

when The following conditions are met:

if The user created a new ticket by emailing "helpdeska766@gmail.com"

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Department: Support

☒ Send User Email

Template: New Ticket Auto-Response

Include CC's: ☒ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name: Helpdesk Name (A1 DeskPRO)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

Action

You can view and edit the simple Email Account triggers from **Tickets > Email Accounts** as well as **Tickets > Triggers**.

Setup the email accounts that DeskPRO checks for tickets and replies.
DeskPRO can automatically turn incoming emails to a support address like `support@yourcompany.com` or `sales@yourcompany.com` into tickets.

1 Email Account

helpdeska766@gmail.com

[+ New Email Account](#)

Incoming Email Log

Outgoing Email Log

Email Address *

helpdeska766@gmail.com

Enter the main email address for this account.

☐ This account has additional email addresses associated with it (aliases)

Type

Ticket Email Account

Ticket accounts are email accounts that DeskPRO will download emails from and process into tickets and replies.

Account Details *

GMail or Google Apps

Email Address: helpdeska766@gmail.com

Password: *****

[+ Test Account Settings](#)

New Ticket Trigger

When a user submits a new ticket by emailing this address:

☒ Set Department: Support

☒ Send User Email

Template: New Ticket Auto-Response

Include CC's: ☒ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name: Helpdesk Name (A1 DeskPRO)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

Action

Advanced triggers

Advanced triggers are more powerful than simple triggers, since you can customize their criteria as well as filtering which events they respond to.

If you want a more complicated configuration than the straightforward cases that simple triggers are designed for, you'll need to use advanced triggers.

When you set up an advanced trigger, don't forget to change any simple triggers that do the same thing. For example, suppose you set up an advanced new ticket trigger for your `sales@` account which sends different auto-replies based on whether the user is new or registered. If you leave the simple **Email Account Trigger** for `sales@` unchanged, users will get two sets of auto-reply emails.

To create a new trigger, go to **Tickets > Triggers** then either **> New Ticket**, **> New Reply** or **> Ticket Update**, depending on the type of trigger you want to make.

- 1 Specify a **Title** for the trigger that describes what it does.
- 2 You can further refine when a trigger runs using the **Event** section. You can choose to have the trigger checked only in response to changes by users or agents, and only in response to changes from some of the possible interfaces - web, email or API ("API" means created automatically by other software that's been integrated with DeskPRO).

For example, you have a "new ticket" trigger that is checked only when the ticket was created by a user via email:

Click the gear icon next to **By a user > via the web** to further refine which web interfaces cause the trigger to be checked.

- **Portal** means the user web portal
- **Widget** means the Feedback and Support Tab widget (see under **Portal > Embed**)
- **Ticket form** means the embeddable Contact Form (see under **Portal > Embed**)

- 3 Set **criteria** which a ticket must meet before the trigger runs. These can be properties of the email, ticket, attachments, user, user's organization or the current time.

4

Criteria

The criteria section is a list of terms that must match before the actions are applied to the ticket.

or The following conditions are met:

User is new

Criteria

or The following conditions are met:

Department is Sales

Criteria

Set the **actions** which the trigger will run. Actions can be used to notify agents and users, or change the state of a ticket, or even trigger an API call to a web-based service.

Actions

These actions will apply when all of the criteria pass.

then The followings actions will run:

then Set Assigned Agent A-1 Sales Exec

Action

See the [Actions guide](#) section for full details of the available actions.

Trigger order

The triggers are checked in the order they are listed, with the top trigger first. You can drag triggers by the handles at the left to change the order.

6 Triggers

- Enable email validation
- Check email validation
- Check agent validation
- Send agent notifications
- Send auto-reply confirmation to user
- Send user new ticket by agent

+ Add

In the example above, the **Enable email validation** trigger would run, then **Check email validation**, then **Check agent validation**, and so on.

Note that triggers can use the **Trigger control** actions to affect triggers lower down the list for the current event.

For example, the **Check email validation** trigger runs the **Stop processing triggers** action if the user's email hasn't been validated, and this stops any triggers lower down from running.

The **Trigger control actions** available are:

- **Stop processing triggers**
- **Prevent emails to user**
- **Prevent emails to agents**
- **Set trigger variable**

Triggers with a **stop processing triggers** action are marked with a 'broken chain' icon, to remind you they can break the usual trigger order.



Bear in mind that the trigger control actions only apply to the current event. For example, suppose a ticket is updated, and the first **Ticket Update** trigger which runs applies a **Prevent emails to user** action; no emails will be sent as a result of that particular ticket update event, but this does not prevent emails to the user in future.

Triggers example: assigning out-of-hours tickets to a special team

Suppose you want to treat incoming tickets differently outside working hours. For example, assigning them to a night shift team who you know will be checking their email.

This is easy to accomplish with triggers:

Title *

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user ☒ By an agent

— ☒ via the web — ☒ via the agent interface

— ☒ via email — ☒ via email

— ☒ via the API — ☒ via the API

Criteria ?

when The following conditions are met:

☒ Default working hours ☐ Set custom working hours

or The following conditions are met:

Actions ?

then The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Team

Note that the working hours here are taken from the **Default Working Hours** in **Tickets > Settings** - but you could specify custom hours just for this trigger.

You'd probably want to send out-of-hours replies from users to the same team:

The screenshot shows the configuration for a trigger in DeskPRO. The **Title** is set to "Out-of-hours replies". Below this, the **Event** is configured as "When a new reply is submitted", with options for "By a user" (checked) and "By an agent" (unchecked). Under "By a user", there are three sub-options: "via the web" (checked), "via email" (checked), and "via the API" (checked). The **Criteria** section has two parts: the first part is labeled "when" and "The following conditions are met:", with a dropdown set to "Is outside of working hours" and radio buttons for "Default working hours" (selected) and "Set custom working hours"; the second part is labeled "or" and "The following conditions are met:", with a "Criteria" button. The **Actions** section is labeled "then" and "The followings actions will run:", with a dropdown set to "Set Assigned Team" and an "Action" button.

Triggers example: filtering bounce messages

Suppose one of your ticket email accounts is used as the reply address when you send out your company newsletter. As a result, incoming notifications about undelivered emails are turned into tickets.

You could create a filter to match these tickets and delete them instantly.

Title *

Filter email bounces

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user

☐ By an agent

☐ via the web

☒ via email

☐ via the API

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Email Subject

contains

Undelivered Mail Returned To Sender

Criteria

or

The following conditions are met:

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Set Status

Delete

Action

Triggers example: tickets from organization managers are more urgent

If your agents are using the CRM app to record which users are managers of their organizations, you could use this information to increase the urgency of managers' tickets:

Title *

RHIP

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user

☒ By an agent

☒ via the web

☒ via the agent interface

☒ via email

☒ via email

☒ via the API

☒ via the API

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Is manager of organization

Criteria

or

The following conditions are met:

Usergroup is VIPs

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Set Priority Urgent

Set Urgency Increase urgency by 5

Action

Save

Triggers example: automatically assign a ticket to agents who reply by email

If your agents reply to tickets from their mail client, they will not be assigned to the tickets they answer. You can automatically assign each ticket to whoever is answering it with this trigger:

Title *

Assign agent to ticket if replies via email

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new reply is submitted

☐ By a user

☒ By an agent

☐ via the agent interface

☒ via email

☐ via the API

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Agent

is

✕ Unassigned

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Agent

Current Agent

Action

Triggers example: emailing users when their ticket is assigned

You can use triggers to send an email to the user when their ticket is assigned (e.g. to reassure them that their problem has come to the attention of a real person).

Here's how you could implement this:

8. Automating the Helpdesk

83

- 1 Create a new trigger, and set the event to be **When a property on a ticket is changed/By an agent**.
- 2 You probably don't want the user to get a notification if their ticket was assigned and replied to at the same time, so deselect **Also run when properties have changed during a reply**.
- 3 Add the Criteria: **Agent / changed from/ Unassigned**.
- 4 Add the Action: **Send User Email > Create new template** An editor opens where you define the email template.
Here's an example template:
Subject:

RE: {{ ticket.subject }}

Body:

{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}

Your ticket has been assigned to {{ ticket.agent.display_name }}.

{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}
{{ ticket.link }}
- 5 Save the template and trigger. Make the trigger active with the toggle control next to its name.

Title *

Email user when ticket assigned

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a property on a ticket is changed

☐ By a user

☒ By an agent

☒ via the agent interface
 ☒ via email
 ☒ via the API

Options

☐ Also run when properties have changed during a reply

When this option is enabled, this trigger will run if an agent has made updates at the same time as replying. ?

Criteria ?

when

The following conditions are met:

Agent

changed from

× Unassigned

Has been assigned

is not

Yes

Criteria

Actions ?

then

The followings actions will run:

Send User Email

Template:

ticket-assigned-user-notification.html

Include CC's:

☐ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name:

Helpdesk Name (A1 DeskPRO)

From Email:

helpdeska766@gmail.com

Has been assigned

Yes

Action

Note that this trigger doesn't run when the assigned agent changes, only when the ticket moves from unassigned to assigned. So in most cases, the user would only get the custom email once. But there is a flaw in the trigger: it will also run if the ticket is moved back to unassigned, then assigned to an agent again.

You could refine this trigger so that it only runs the first time the ticket is assigned. One way to implement this would be by using a custom "Has been assigned" agent-only toggle field, which starts out as unchecked. Add an action to set the field as checked when the trigger runs. Then add to the criteria of the trigger a check that 'Has been assigned' is false. This ensures that the trigger can only run once (unless agents edit the custom field.).

Triggers example: sending a different auto-reply to new users

Suppose the sales team want to customize the email auto-response when tickets are submitted to the Sales department. They want to send existing users the normal response, but they want new users to get a more elaborate welcome email explaining your product range.

We'll assume you start out with your `sales@` account linked to the Sales department with simple **new ticket** triggers, configured to send the the default auto-response.

This **Email Account Trigger** sets tickets sent via the `sales@` account to the Sales department, then sends the auto-response.

6 Triggers

- Enable email validation ☒
- Check email validation ☒
- Check agent validation ☒
- 1 Email Account Trigger ☒

Use these triggers if you want to perform actions based on the email address a user sends a new ticket to.

sales@a1corp.example

2 Department Triggers ☒

Send agent notifications ☒

Send user new ticket by agent ☒

Assign self when replying by email ☒

+ Add

"sales@a1corp.example" Email Account Trigger

This is a email account trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket by sending an email to this email address.

Criteria

when The following conditions are met:

if The user created a new ticket by emailing "sales@a1corp.example"

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Department Sales

Template: New Ticket Auto-Response

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

☒ Send User Email

From Name: Site Name (A1 Inc)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

+ Action

This **Department Trigger** sets tickets submitted via the web where the user has selected the Sales department to the sales@ email account, then sends the auto-response.

6 Triggers

- Enable email validation ☒
- Check email validation ☒
- Check agent validation ☒
- 2 Department Triggers ☒

Use these triggers if you want to perform actions based on the department a user selects when submitting a ticket from the web interface.

Support

Sales

1 Email Account Trigger ☒

Send agent notifications ☒

Send user new ticket by agent ☒

Assign self when replying by email ☒

+ Add

"Sales" Department Trigger

This is a department trigger. It will apply when a user submits a new ticket from the web interface and selects

Criteria

when The following conditions are met:

if Department is "Sales"

and Ticket is created by a user from the web interface

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Email Account sales@a1corp.example

Template: New Ticket Auto-Response

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

☒ Send User Email

From Name: Site Name (A1 Inc)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

+ Action

The simple triggers can't do what the sales team wants, because their criteria are fixed, so there's no way to specify that you only want to do something to new users.

Instead, you would create a new trigger:

Title *

Welcome email to new users

This title will be used throughout the admin interface to refer to this trigger.

Event

When a new ticket is created

☒ By a user ☐ By an agent

☒ via the web ☐ via email ☐ via the API

This trigger is checked when a user or agent submits a ticket via email or web. (We'll assume that you don't want to send acknowledgements for tickets created using the API).

The criteria you would use are:

Criteria ?

when The following conditions are met:

Department is Sales

User is new

+ Criteria

That means the new trigger will only run its actions when the department is Sales, and the user is new. We're going to rely on the **Email Account Trigger** to set the department to Sales. Make sure the new trigger is below the simple triggers.

The action you want to run is sending a custom email. You would create a custom email template (see the chapter on [Editing Templates](#) for details), then run it like this:

Actions ?

then The followings actions will run:

Send User Email

Template: new-user-sales-welcome.html

Include CC's: ☐ CC in all additional user participants.

From Name: Site Name (A1 Inc)

From Email: The account set on the ticket

+ Action

You don't want users receiving more than one auto-response email when they submit a new ticket. So you would disable the **Send User Email** action for the simple triggers:

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Email Account sales@a1corp.example

☐ Send User Email

+ Action

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

☒ Set Department Sales

☐ Send User Email

+ Action

We're almost done. But we want users who don't receive the custom email to receive the default auto-response email. Since the simple triggers aren't sending that any more, we need another new trigger to do the job.

We could try to set up a complicated set of Criteria so that the new trigger runs if the user is not new and the department is Sales, or the department is anything else, but there's a simpler way. We can just put in a check to see if the custom email has already been sent, and make sure the default auto-response trigger is below the one that sends the custom response.

Criteria ?

when The following conditions are met:

The user has NOT been emailed ☒ a specific email template new-user-sales-welcome.html

+ Criteria

Actions

These actions will apply when all of the criteria pass.

then The followings actions will run:

Send User Email	Template:	New Ticket Auto-Response
	Include CC's:	☐ CC in all additional user participants.
	From Name:	Site Name (A1 Inc)
	From Email:	The account set on the ticket

+ Action

Here's the completed triggers in the right order:

2 Department Triggers	☒
1 Email Account Trigger	☒
Welcome email to new users	☒
Send default auto-response	☒

Triggers for built-in processes

Many of the built-in processes of the helpdesk, such as sending email notifications to agents or user email validation, are controlled by triggers you can edit.

The triggers which control these built-in processes are:

New ticket:

- Enable/check email validation
- Check agent validation
- Replying by email assigns to that agent
- Agent notifications
- Auto-reply confirmation
- Notify user about new ticket by agent

New reply:

- Send agent notifications
- Send auto-reply confirmation to user
- Send user new reply from agent

Ticket update:

- Send agent notifications

You can edit these triggers to customize your helpdesk's behavior. For example, you could edit the **Send auto-reply confirmation to user** so that auto-replies are only sent for tickets in a certain department.

8.2. Ticket escalations

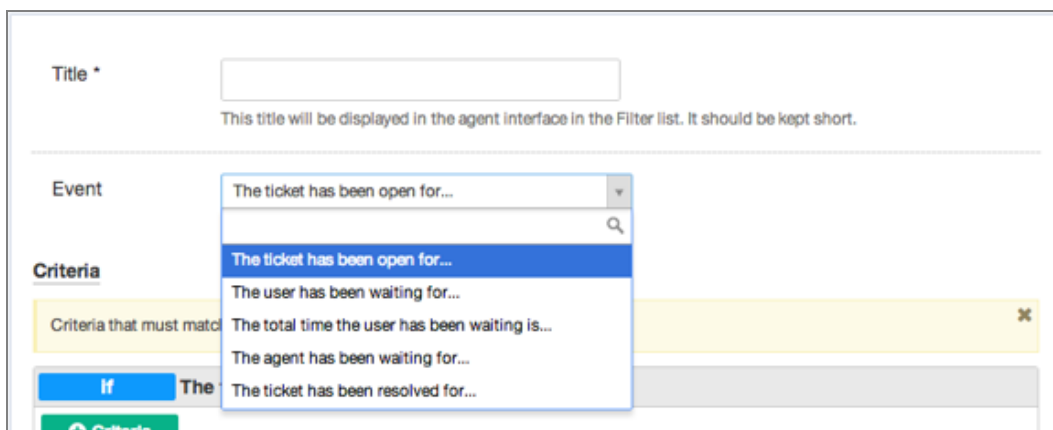
Ticket escalations run actions once a ticket has spent a set amount of time in a certain state.

They are useful to ensure that tickets don't spend too long without attention from agents. For example, you could use an escalation to increase the urgency of older tickets, or to automatically assign tickets that have gone unresolved for too long to a manager.

Creating an escalation

Create a new escalation by going to **Tickets > Escalations** and clicking **Add**.

When you create an escalation, you define what state a ticket must be in for elapsed time to count:



- **The ticket has been open for** total time the ticket has existed without being resolved.
- **The user has been waiting** total time the ticket has been *awaiting agent*, continuously since the most recent status change; for example, if the status is changed from *awaiting agent* and then back again, the clock resets.
- **The total time the user has been waiting** cumulative time the ticket has been *awaiting agent* over its whole life.
- **The agent has been waiting for** how long the ticket has been awaiting user, resets if the status changes; useful to detect tickets where the user stopped replying before the problem was resolved.
- **The ticket has been resolved for** time elapsed since the ticket was resolved.

You also define how long the ticket must spend in that state for the escalation to apply.

You can also set extra **criteria** that the ticket must meet for the escalation to run. For example, if you specify a department, the escalation will apply only to tickets in that department.

Criteria

Criteria that must match for the escalation to apply to a ticket.

if The following conditions are met:

Ticket Criteria

Status

Department

Agent

Agent Team

Product

Category

Priority

You then define the actions that run when the ticket has run up the correct elapsed time and meets any criteria.

Actions

then The followings actions will run:

Set Assigned Agent A-1 IT Boss

then Set Priority Urgent

then Set Flag Red

+ Action

Save

8.3. SLAs

SLAs (Service Level Agreements) enable you to set goals for ticket response time. These goals might represent an actual SLA with a client who is paying for support, or just an internal quality standard.

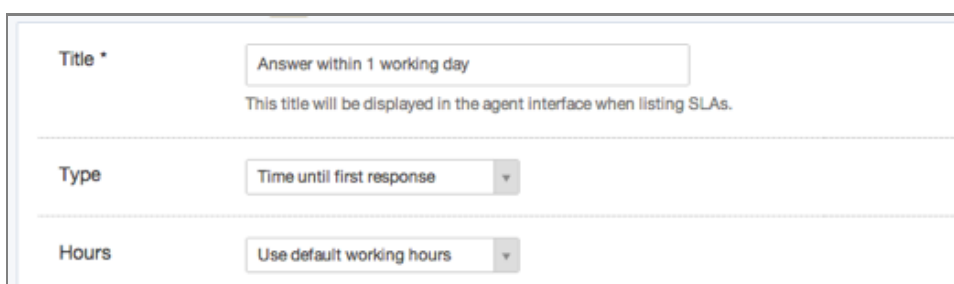
Tickets that are close to failing the goal (you define what is considered 'close') enter a **warning** condition, and tickets that exceed the goal have **failed**.

There are two effects of SLAs:

- Tickets close to or failing an SLA are highlighted to agents: tickets on warning are edged amber, tickets that have failed are edged red.
- SLAs can run automatic **actions** to modify the ticket on warning or failure.

Creating an SLA

Create a new SLA by going to **Tickets > SLAs** and clicking **Add**.



Title *	Answer within 1 working day
This title will be displayed in the agent interface when listing SLAs.	
Type	Time until first response
Hours	Use default working hours

Set **Type** to decide whether the SLA tracks:

- time until first response
- time until ticket is resolved
- user waiting time until ticket resolution (total)

You can use **Hours** to set whether time should be counted **24x7** (continuously), during default working hours (as defined in **Tickets > Settings > Default Working Hours**), or during custom hours that you define.

For example, suppose your helpdesk's default working hours are set as 9am to 6pm Monday to Friday, and you have an SLA that requires you to make a first response within 8 hours. A ticket arrives at 5pm on Monday and doesn't get answered. If you have set **Hours** as **24x7**, the elapsed time will be counted all night, and the ticket will fail the SLA 8 hours later at 1am. But if you set the SLA to count **Default Working Hours**, elapsed time will only be counted until 6pm. Then the clock will stop until 9am the next day, when the remaining 7 hours will start counting down again.

The screenshot shows two configuration sections: **SLA Warning** and **SLA Failure**.

SLA Warning: A dropdown menu is set to '6' hours. Below it, a box labeled 'then' contains the text 'The followings actions will run:'. Inside this box, there are two actions: 'Set Urgency' with a sub-action 'Increase urgency by' set to '4', and 'Set Assigned Team' set to '2nd Level Support'. A green '+ Action' button is at the bottom of this section.

SLA Failure: A dropdown menu is set to '8' hours. Below it, a box labeled 'then' contains the text 'The followings actions will run:'. Inside this box, there are two actions: 'Set Urgency' with a sub-action 'Set urgency to' set to '9' and a checked checkbox 'Only set if urgency is lower', and 'Set Assigned Team' set to 'Support Managers'. A green '+ Action' button is at the bottom of this section.

Define an **SLA Warning** time (when the ticket is considered close to failing) and a **SLA Failure** time.

Note the value you enter in SLA Failure is the total time elapsed on the ticket, *not* the time since warning.

You can define actions that run automatically at warning and at failure. For example, you might want to increase the **urgency** of a ticket that is about to fail an SLA, or assign the ticket to a more experienced team.

Click the + **Action** button under **SLA Warning** or **SLA Failure** to add **actions** that will run on warning.

The screenshot shows the **SLA Application** configuration. It features a dropdown menu with the text 'Apply to all tickets'. At the bottom right, there is a blue 'Save' button.

Use **SLA Application** to set which tickets are affected by the SLA:

- **Apply to all tickets:** this applies the SLA to all tickets created *from now on* (not existing tickets)
- **Agents manually apply the SLA:** agents apply the SLA from the **SLAS** tab of the ticket
- **Apply to new tickets that match certain criteria:** you can enter conditions that tickets must meet for the SLA to apply.

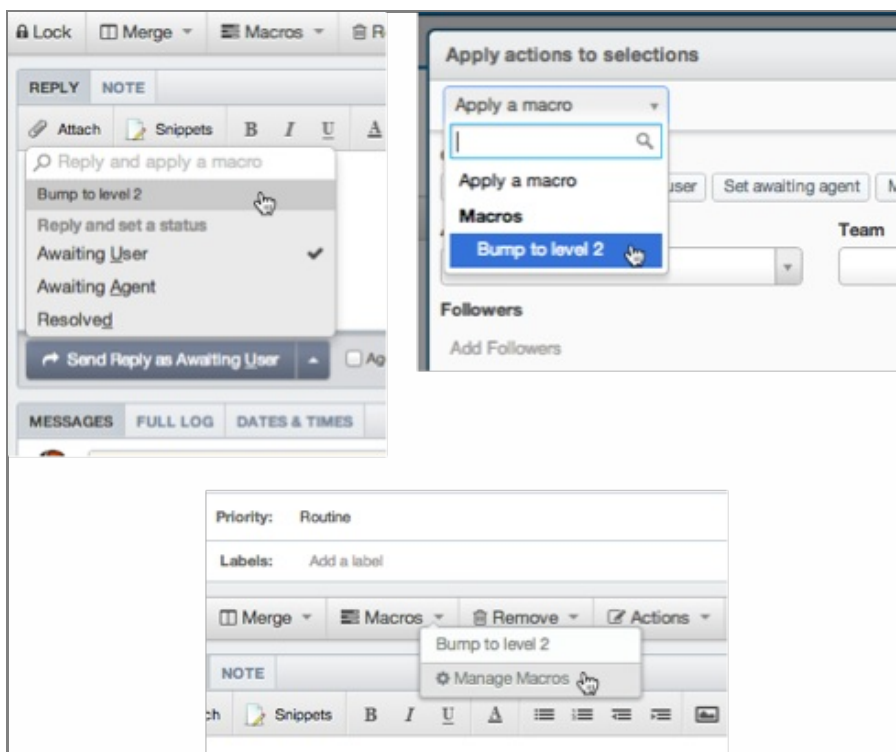
Click **Save** to store the SLA.

8.4. Macros

Macros are stored sequences of actions which agents can apply from the agent interface. Macros are designed to automate sequences of steps that agents often have to repeat. An agent can apply a macro to a ticket with a couple of clicks. Using macros to perform commonly-repeated sequences of actions helps agents work more efficiently.

When a macro runs, the actions it contains are applied to the ticket it is run on.

Agents can apply macros from the content pane using the **Macros** button or the **Send Reply** control. They can also apply macros as a mass action from the list pane.



Macros can be shared (available to everyone), or limited to a specific agent. Note that if an agent tries to run a shared macro but lacks the permissions to run all its actions, the macro will not run.

Creating a macro

Agents can create macros in the **Preferences** area of the agent interface. You can create macros from **Tickets > Macros**, where you can also edit agent macros.

To create a macro:

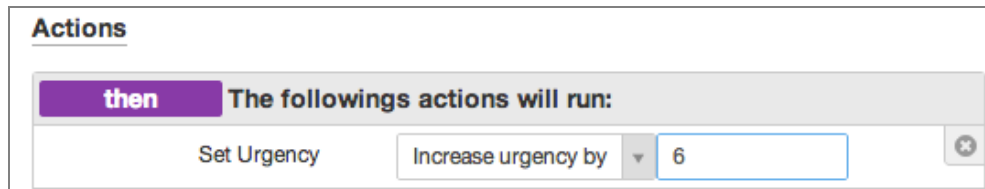
- 1 Enter a descriptive **Title** that makes clear to agents what the macro does.
- 2 Select a **Permission** level; the macro can either be shared or limited to a specific agent.
- 3 Click the **+ Action** button and select an action.
- 4 Keep adding actions until the macro is complete.
- 5 Click **Save**.

8.5. Using urgency to prioritize tickets

A common use of automation is to set the **urgency** score on tickets, to help agents decide which ones to deal with first.

Urgency is a score from 1 to 10. For a newly created ticket, it defaults to 1.

Actions can be used to increase or decrease urgency by a certain amount, instead of setting it to a particular value. This allows a number of different automated rules to be applied to a ticket, giving a combined urgency which reflects competing considerations.



For example, suppose your company want to encourage agents to prioritize tickets from the VIP usergroup, and to prioritize support department tickets over sales department tickets.

You could set a trigger to increase the urgency for new tickets from the "VIP" usergroup by 6, and a second trigger to decrease the urgency for new tickets in the "Sales" department by 3.

A new "Support" ticket from a VIP would start with urgency 1, get +6 urgency from the first trigger, for an overall urgency of 7.

A new "Sales" ticket from a VIP user would start with urgency 1, get +6 from the first trigger, then -3 from the second trigger, for an overall urgency of 4.

Urgency can never go below 1 or above 10. If an action would decrease a ticket's urgency to below 1 or above 10, it will be set to 1 or 10 respectively.

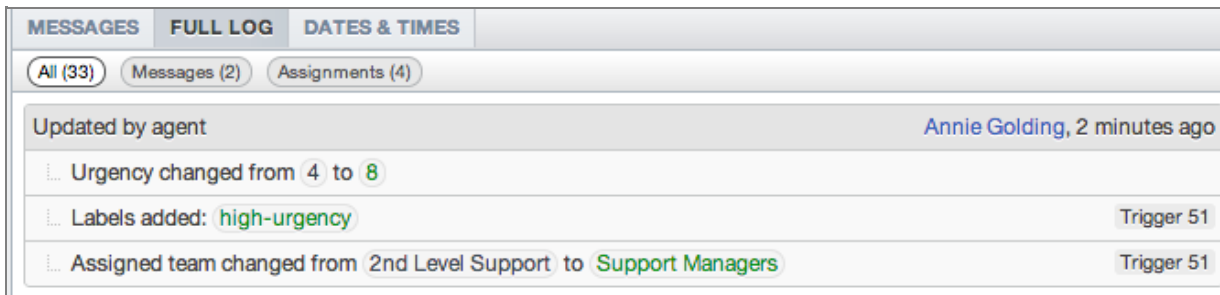
You can view the distribution of **urgency** values for your current unresolved tickets under **Tickets > Urgency**.



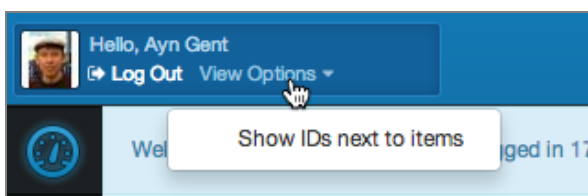
8.6. Displaying IDs for items

Every item within DeskPRO has an ID number. The most familiar example is the ticket ID, but there are IDs for most items you can create as an admin: triggers, SLAs, apps, custom fields, etc.

Knowing these IDs is useful when checking or troubleshooting your helpdesk automation by viewing the **full log** of a ticket. You can see which actions and processes have changed the ticket properties, but they are referred to by ID number.

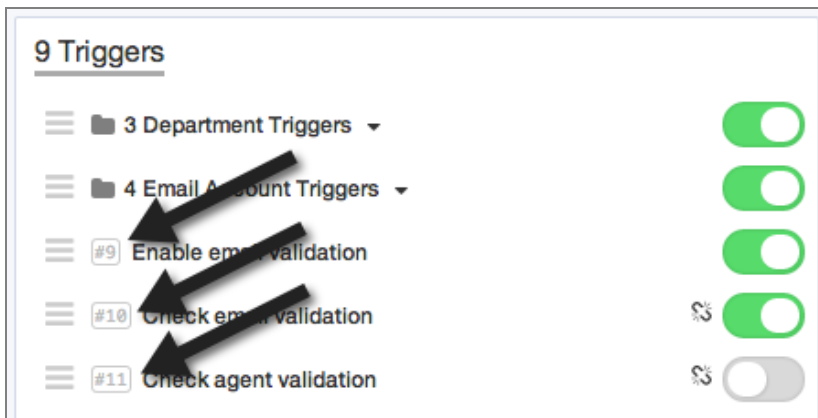


At the very top left of the admin interface, the **View Options** control enables you to toggle the display of item IDs.



Click **Show IDs next to items** to display ID numbers.

This is an example of how item IDs are displayed when the **Show IDs next to items** option is enabled:



You will also need these IDs when you are referring to a particular item using a variable: for example, within a snippet (in the agent interface), when editing templates, or when you are creating a custom report in the Reports interface.

8.7. Actions guide

This section contains a complete list of the built-in actions you can use in triggers, SLAs, escalations and macros.

Note that installing an app can provide you with extra actions: for example, installing the [Hipchat app](#) gives you an "Announce to HipChat" action.

Ticket Assignment

- **Set Assigned Agent:**
 - assign the ticket to an agent you specify, or
 - **Unassign** the ticket, or
 - assign to **Current agent** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Assigned Team:**
 - assign the ticket to a team you specify, or
 - assign the ticket to **No Team**, or
 - assign to the **the Current Agent's Team** (the agent who activated the trigger - if the trigger was activated by a user, this action will be ignored)
 - **Set Agent Followers:**
 - add an agent you specify as a follower

Ticket Properties

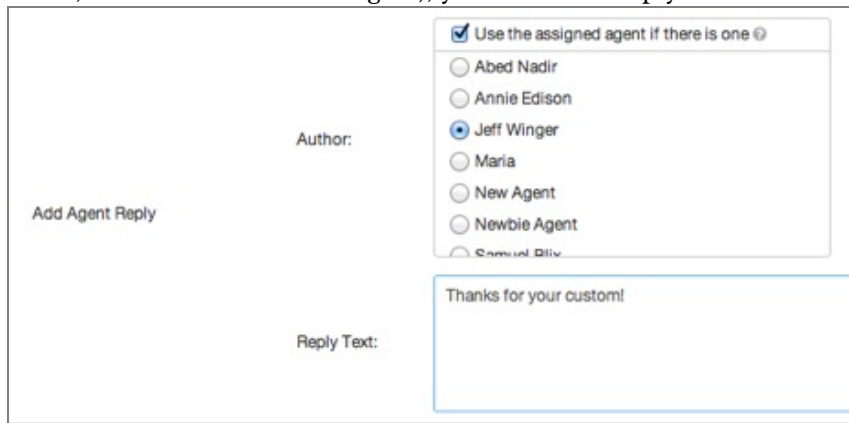
- **Set Status:** set the ticket status from the built-in statuses
- **Set Department:** set the ticket's department
- **Set Product:** set the ticket's product
- **Set Category:** set the ticket's category
- **Set Priority:** set the ticket's priority
- **Set Workflow:** set the ticket's workflow
- **Set Urgency:**
 - **increase urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **decrease urgency** by an amount you specify
 - **set urgency** to a specified value
- **Set Subject:** set the ticket title to the specified value
- **Set Labels:** apply the specified labels to the ticket (specify them in a comma-separated list)
- **Set Flag:** apply the specified flag color to the ticket
- **Set Email Account:** set which ticket email account will send messages related to this ticket
- **Set CC'd Users:** enter user email addresses to CC:

Ticket SLAs

- **Set SLAs:** specify SLAs to apply or remove from the ticket
- **Set SLA Condition Status:** set whether the ticket is passing or failing any SLAs applied (regardless of elapsed time)
- **Set SLA State:** set whether the ticket is waiting or finished on any SLAs applied

Ticket Actions

- **Set Ticket User:** set the user associated with the ticket
- **Delete Ticket:** delete the ticket
- **Add Agent Reply:** send a reply from the selected agent (or, optionally, the assigned agent if there is one, otherwise the selected agent); you define the reply text



- **Require User Email Validation:** set the ticket status to "awaiting validation" and send the user a link to confirm their email address
- **Call Web Hook:** send an HTTP request to a web service; see the section on [Calling web hooks from actions](#)

Trigger Control

- **Stop Processing Triggers:** don't run actions from future triggers (and SLAs/escalations) for this ticket; note that any actions below this one in the current trigger/SLA/escalation/macro will still run
- **Prevent Emails to User:** future actions which would result in sending an email to users about this ticket are ignored
- **Prevent Emails to Agents:** future actions which would result in sending an email to agents about this ticket are ignored

Custom Ticket Fields

- set values for any custom fields you have created

Custom Person (user) Fields

- set values for any custom user fields you have created

9. CRM

Usergroups control the [permissions](#) users have to view and interact with your helpdesk.

You can also set a [registration](#) policy which determines how users create an account on your helpdesk, and what they can do without registering.

You can configure the helpdesk so that can authenticate with credentials from outside DeskPRO, for example from a separate database, your network or using a social media account.

You can also set a password policy for users.

9.1. User permissions

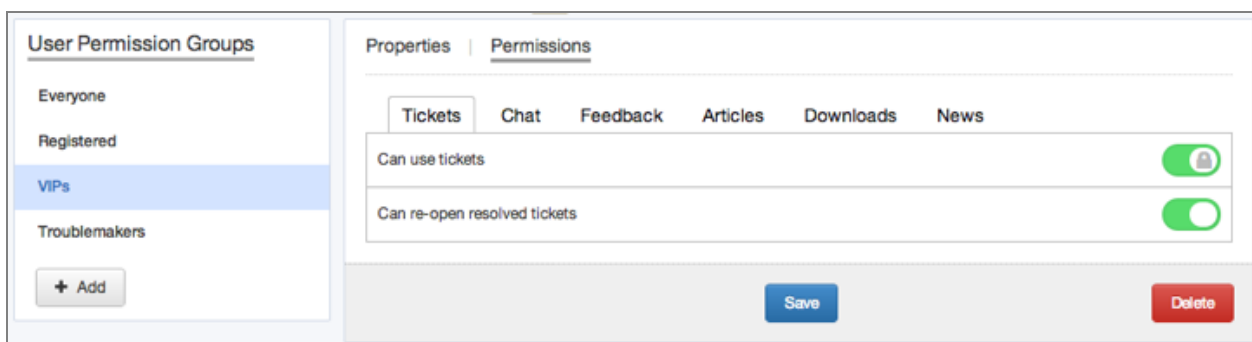
Usergroups determine what permissions users have. Usergroup membership grants user permissions, much like belonging to an agent permission group does for agents. Unlike with agents, there is no way to set permissions for an individual user.

Users can belong to multiple usergroups, and, as with agent permissions, the effect is additive; a user has all permissions that are granted by any of their usergroups.

Everyone usergroup

You may want users who aren't logged in (**guests**) to be able to access some portal content. There is a special **Everyone** usergroup which grants permissions to guests. All the permissions you grant to **Everyone** will be available to every other usergroup.

You can edit usergroups from **Users > Permission Groups**



Registered usergroup

The special **Registered** usergroup grants permissions to all registered users. Every usergroup (apart from **Everyone**) will have the permissions you grant to **Registered**.

Another way to think about this is that **Registered** inherits all the permissions from **Everyone**, and your custom groups inherit all permissions from **Registered**. Permissions that are inherited are marked with a padlock, and can't be changed.

You can grant extra permissions on top of inherited permissions, but you can't take permissions away. For example, suppose you want to make a "Basic Users" usergroup which can't access chat. You must remove chat access from **Everyone** and **Registered**, and make sure that users in "Basic Users" aren't members of other usergroups which grant chat access.

Portal access and usergroups

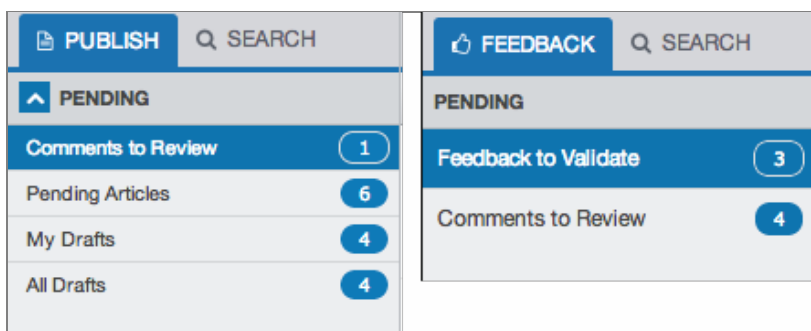
For each portal section, you can enable/disable access for the usergroup entirely.

Note that this is distinct from using the Portal Editor to enable/disable sections altogether. If you disable access to a portal section for the **Everyone** usergroup, it won't be seen by any users, but it will still be visible to agents.

For each section, you can enable/disable a usergroup's ability to rate content and submit content visible to other users, such as comments and feedback items.

For permissions that involve user-visible content, you can also choose whether or not to require agent validation. This means that agents have to approve content to check it is not abusive, spam etc.

Incoming comments and feedback in need of approval will be shown under **Comments to Review** and **Feedback** in the agent interface:



User permission details

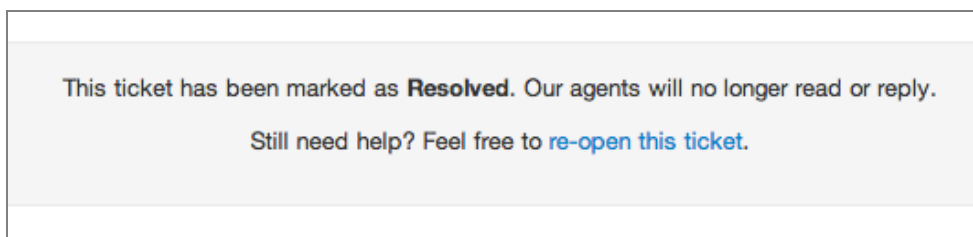
The user permission settings available are:

Tickets

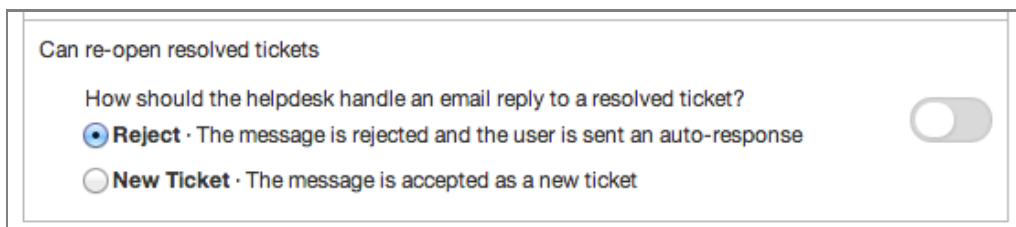
- Can use tickets (disabling this means the user can't see the Contact Us section)
- Can re-open resolved tickets

Enabling the "Can re-open resolved tickets" setting means that users can re-open a resolved ticket in the **Contact Us** section of the user portal, and by replying to an email about the ticket.

If re-opening tickets is enabled, users will see this option on the portal:



If you disable the option, you must select how your helpdesk deals with emails about resolved tickets:



You can choose whether to reject the message and inform the user with an automatic email response, or accept it as a new ticket.

Chat

- Can use chat (disabling this means the user can't see chat widgets)

Feedback

- Can use feedback (disabling this means the user can't see the Feedback section)
- Can submit new feedback
 - Do not require agent validation - this means feedback items from these users don't need to be approved from 'Feedback to Validate'
- Can vote on feedback
- Submit comments on feedback
 - Do not require agent validation - this means comments from these users don't need to be approved from 'Comments to Review'

Articles

- Can use knowledgebase (disabling this means the user can't see the Knowledgebase section)
- Can rate articles
- Submit comments on articles
 - Do not require agent validation

Downloads

- Can use downloads
- Can rate downloads
- Submit comments on downloads
 - Do not require agent validation

News

- News
- Can rate news posts
- Submit comments on news posts
 - Do not require agent validation

Users with the **Do not require agent validation** permission can post comments in the relevant portal section and have them go live immediately, without agent approval via the Publish/Feedback apps.

User file attachments

Under **Settings > Setup** you can specify the file types users can upload to the helpdesk. This applies to email attachments, files sent via chat or added to a ticket via the portal.

You can either allow all files, specify a list of allowed file extensions, or specify a list of banned file extensions.

You can also set the maximum file size users can upload. If you are using DeskPRO Download, you will receive a warning if you set a maximum that is higher than your DeskPRO server can handle. You may be able to change your server configuration to allow bigger files. See the section [Storing binary data](#) for details.

9.2. User registration and authentication

User registration settings govern how users create new accounts. This includes details like how the helpdesk checks that the supplied email address really belongs to the user, and your user password policy.

These settings interact with the user permissions system which determine what users (and unregistered guests) can do. Some of the registration settings override certain aspects of the permission system.

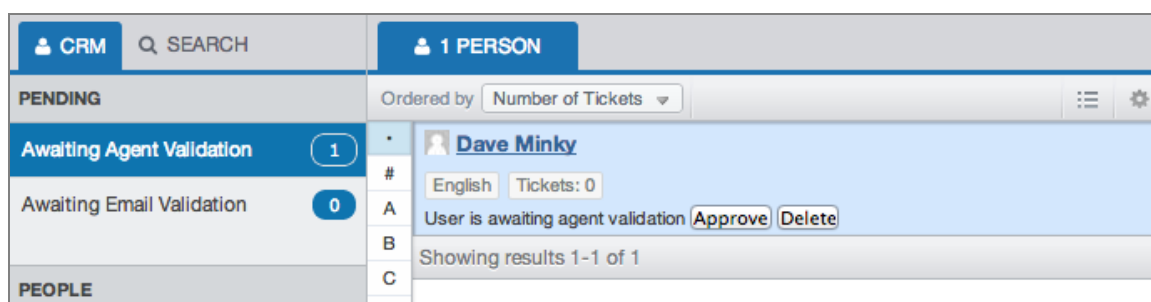
You can install **authentication apps** to let users or agents log in with credentials other than a DeskPRO account.

User registration settings

Go to **CRM > Registration** to change the helpdesk's settings for user registration and email validation.

The **Enable/Disable Registration** setting controls the ability for users to sign up for an account via the web portal. If you **disable registration**, agents must manually create an account for every user. Tickets submitted by email will only be accepted if the email From: address is already registered as a user's email address. Disabling registration gives you more control over who can access the helpdesk, at the expense of more time spent creating user accounts.

- **Require registration** hides any forms that a user can use to submit content: **Contact Us**, feedback and comments. If you enable this, even if the **Everyone** usergroup has the right permissions to submit content, the portal will not allow it.
- **Enable email validation for new registrations from the web portal** means that users who sign up for an account on your helpdesk must prove they own the associated email address before their account will work. This is done by sending a validation email with a special link that the user must click.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from web** if this is not enabled, users can submit a ticket and provide any email address, even if it is not one they control; if it is enabled, the user must prove they own the email address by clicking a link in a validation email. Until the address is validated, the ticket is held in the **Awaiting Validation** filter in the agent interface. This option is useful if bots are submitting spam messages to your contact form. It also makes sure users have not made a mistake when entering their address.
- **Enable email validation for new users submitting tickets from email** it is easy for spammers to send email with a fake From: address. If this option is enabled, the user must prove their From: address is valid by clicking a link in a validation email. This option can help to prevent incoming spam email being turned into tickets.
- **Enable manual agent validation** means that your agents must approve every new account. Accounts that need approval will show up in the agent interface CRM app in the **Awaiting Agent Validation** filter:



While users are awaiting validation, they can still submit content, but it won't be shown on the portal until they are validated.

Restricting access to part of the portal

The registration and email validation settings apply to *every* part of the helpdesk.

You may instead want some sections of the helpdesk to be public while others have limited access. For example, suppose you want ticket submission to be locked down so it's available to approved users only, but you want to accept feedback from anyone without making them log in.

You can't apply the **Enable manual agent validation** setting just to Tickets, but the same effect can be implemented with the right combination of registration settings and [usergroups](#).

To implement this example, you'd check **Enable Registration** and uncheck **Require Registration**. You would need to keep the Everyone usergroup enabled, since it is required to accept feedback from users who aren't logged in.

Then in **CRM > Permission Groups** you would set the Everyone group to have permission to use Feedback, but not Tickets. You don't want *every* registered user to be able to submit tickets, just ones you approve, so you would also remove Tickets permission from Registered and any other existing usergroups.

You would then create a new "Ticket Approved" usergroup with permission to use tickets. Users added to "Approved" could then use the ticket system as normal, while other users wouldn't see the **Contact Us** section of the portal at all.

CAPTCHAs

You can enable CAPTCHA tests on the portal. These require users to recognize text or audio to check that you are receiving input from a human user and not an automatic spam-posting program.

DeskPRO uses the [reCAPTCHA](#) system.

Go to **Portal > Settings** to enable CAPTHCAs. You can have CAPTHCAs:

- for user registration
- for new feedback items and comments

If you require CAPTHCAs for feedback and comments, you can choose whether even registered users need to pass a test for each comment.

Authentication apps

You can install **authentication apps** to enable users and agents to sign on with credentials from outside DeskPRO, instead of needing to create a DeskPRO account.

For example, you can allow agents to use their existing login information on your network, or allow users to sign in with their Facebook accounts.

See the section on [Extending DeskPRO](#) for more details.

9.3. Managing user passwords

Go to **CRM > Password Settings** to set the requirements for creating account passwords. You can set separate requirements for agents and users.

Agent Password Policy

☐ Standard Password Policy

☒ Custom Password Policy

Specify custom password requirements.

Password Policy

Minimum password length: characters

The minimum number of characters the password has to be.

Maximum password age: days

How many days a password can remain unchanged until DeskPRO requires the agent to change it.

☐ Forbid password reuse

When enabled, agents will not be able to change their password to a password they have used in the past.

Require this many lower-case characters:

Define the minimum number of lower-case (a-z) characters that must be used in the password.

Require this many upper-case characters:

Define the minimum number of upper-case (A-Z) characters that must be used in the password.

Require this many numbers:

Define the minimum number of numbers (0-9) that must be used in the password.

Require this many symbols:

Define the minimum number of symbols (!, @, \$, % etc) that must be used in the password.

You can reset user passwords from the agent interface by going to the user's records, and from the pull-down, selecting **Reset Password**. Enter a password, which will be emailed to the user. **More**

10. Portal

The portal is the web-based interface to your helpdesk for users. They can use it to submit new tickets, view their previous tickets, access the help content created by agents within the agent interface **Publish** app, and submit feedback.

In addition, you can integrate portal functions within your existing website by [embedding](#) the following:

- The **Feedback & Support** tab widget enables users to interact with the helpdesk from an overlay without leaving your site
- The chat widget offers access to DeskPRO real-time chat from your website
- You can embed a contact form to submit a ticket on any web page.
- You can embed the entire portal within another site

10.1. Basic portal customization

Click on the portal icon to configure it with the **Portal Editor**.

▪

If you prefer not to use the portal, you can turn it off with the **Disable Portal** button.

▪

If you do want to use the portal, you should replace the default Welcome message. Mouse over the **Welcome** section of the portal, and click the edit control.

▪

You should change the welcome message to greet your users, and explain that this portal is the official way to get help from your organization. You can also mouse over and edit the words "Support Center".

10.2. Portal branding

You can customize the look of the portal to make it closer to the design of your enterprise's website and other user-facing materials. You can make simple changes to the portal design through **Portal > Portal Editor**, or use the portal templates system to carry out more advanced customization.

The design options available through the editor are:

Color chooser:

▪

You can pick custom colors for most of the elements of the portal.

Change favicon:

▪

The favicon is the icon displayed by browsers to denote your site when the user bookmarks it, opens it in a tab, etc. This option lets you replace the default DeskPRO icon with your own logo.

▪

Add custom HTML: You can insert a custom header and footer which will be displayed on all the pages of the web interface. You need to enter this as HTML code.

You can also enter code that will be inserted into the `<head>` element of the portal's HTML: this allows you to insert CSS or Javascript into the portal.

▪

▪

Add logo:

▪

You can add a custom logo to the portal. Mouse over the title area and click the gear icon, then click **Choose file** to upload a logo image.

▪

Note that uploading a logo replaces any title and tagline you have entered.

10.3. Changing portal design and content with templates

If you want to customize the portal more fully, you can edit the HTML and CSS directly using **Portal > Templates**.

This lets you dramatically alter the design of the portal to make it look like part of your website.

You can also use the template system in combination with custom **phrases** to customize the text content of the portal.

See the [Editing Templates](#) section for more details.

10.4. Customizing portal content

Most of the content displayed on the portal (Knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads, and glossary terms) is created and managed from the **Publish** app in the agent interface. Feedback is managed from the agent **Feedback** app.

There are some aspects of portal content that can be customized from the admin interface.

Rearranging portal sections

You can change the order that the portal section tabs are displayed in.

Just click and drag a section (keeping the mouse button held down) to move it.

■

Note that the section at the very left will be the one that's displayed to users when they arrive at the portal.

Hiding and displaying portal sections

If you don't want to use a certain portal content type, such as news posts, you can disable the relevant section of the portal from **Portal > Portal Editor**. This avoids users seeing an empty area of the portal.

Mouse over a portal section, then click the **ON** control, to toggle the section off.

■

You can also drag the section tabs to reorder them.

Note that turning off a section in this way only prevents it from being displayed on the portal; any content isn't deleted, and remains accessible through **Publish/Feedback** in the agent interface. You can continue to create content even if the section isn't being displayed. So you could, for example, disable your Knowledgebase section while it's empty, write an initial set of articles, then enable it again.

In the individual settings for each portal section, you also have the option to disable display of the tab, while leaving the section active. This means the section is still available for users who know the correct web address, but users who come to the portal homepage won't be able to navigate to it.

■

For example, suppose you have drivers in your Downloads section that should only be installed on the advice of an agent. You could disable the Downloads tab, so users can't find the section and experiment with drivers, but you could still easily send links to the drivers when needed.

Permissions will also affect the display of portal sections.

Sections are not shown if the user does not have:

- the correct *usergroup* permissions (set in **CRM > Permission Groups**)
- for Contact Us, sufficient *department* permissions to use at least one department available on the form (set in **Tickets > Departments** in the **Permissions** tab)

Note that the **Everyone** and **Registered** usergroups can affect what agents see on the portal. For example, suppose you have a single department, with **Everyone** and **Registered** permissions disabled. Your agents will not be able to see the **Contact Us** section on the portal, even if they have *agent* permissions to use that department in the agent interface.

■

Ticket deflection

Ticket deflection directs users who are about to submit a ticket to knowledgebase articles that might solve their problem.

If you enable this option from **Tickets > Settings**, when users start typing into the **Contact Us** ticket submission form on the portal, matching articles will be suggested automatically.

■

Portal contact form layout

You can edit the layout of the contact (ticket submission) form, including having different layouts for each department. See the section [Ticket form layouts](#) for details.

Showing your Twitter account on the portal

You can show recent tweets from a Twitter account you control in the portal sidebar with the Twitter block.

Mouse over the block and then click on the  control to configure it.

Enter the Twitter account you wish to include, and how many recent tweets you want to show.

You must authenticate with Twitter by clicking the link and authorizing the portal to access the account.

Custom portal sidebars

You can add custom sidebar blocks to the portal.

If you want to include a simple sidebar that is the same for all users, click **Add sidebar block** and enter the block title, then its contents (marked up as HTML).

The **Add sidebar HTML** option is more powerful, because it allows you to use variables and conditional logic from the template system.

The following variables are useful for creating blocks:

<code>{{ app.user.id }}</code>	User ID - useful for conditional tests to see if user is logged in
<code>{{ app.user.name }}</code>	User's name
<code>{{ app.user.primary_email_address }}</code>	User email address
<code>{{ app.user.organization.name }}</code>	User organization name

Here's an example sidebar. It checks to see if the user is logged in (using `app.user.id`) and greets them by name. It then checks to see if they belong to an organization (using `app.user.organization.name`). If so, it displays a custom message about the organization.

```
{% if app.user.id %}

<p>Hello, {{ app.user.name }}!</p>

{% if app.user.organization.name %}

<p>A1 Corp especially values the custom of your employer,
{{ app.user.organization.name }}.</p>

{% endif %}

{% endif %}
```

This would display the following message for a user who was in the Ace Tomato organization.

■

See the section on [Editing Templates](#) for more about using the template system.

Custom ticket form

You can customize the layout of the Contact Us section ticket submission form from **Tickets > Departments**, using the **Layout** tab. See the section on [Ticket form layouts](#) for details.

10.5. Website integration

You can embed some DeskPRO functions, or your entire portal, into your existing website. This means that users don't have to navigate to your portal before using the helpdesk.

The available options for embedding are:

- a **Feedback & Support** tab at the left or right hand side of your site, giving users access to ticket submission, feedback, chat and the ability to search knowledgebase articles and news posts
- a **chat widget** at the bottom of your site
- a **contact form** for ticket submission, which can be set to submit to a particular department or allow the user to choose
- **embedding the whole portal** into a page on your site

Embedding any of these requires adding some Javascript code (which you can copy from the admin interface) to your website. It's simple, as long as you know how to edit the code of your website directly. Some "easy website builder" hosting services may not allow you to add the required code.

Embedding the Feedback & Support tab

When clicked, the Feedback & Support shows the following pop-up window over your website content:

The **Email Us** option displays a ticket submission form using your default layout from **Tickets > Departments**.

The **Submit Feedback** option enables the user to submit a feedback item, and the **Chat With Us** option enables the user to start a chat.

The search bar at the left searches through knowledgebase articles and news posts. You can also choose some articles or news items to display by default (see below).

To embed the Feedback & Support tab:

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Feedback and Support Tab** section, set the options you want for your tab:
 - Edit the **Tab title** to change the text displayed on the tab.
 - Choose the **Tab position** (left or right edge of your site).
 - Set the **Language** displayed in the tab (note that unlike on the portal, the language cannot be changed by users).
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code into the HTML of the page on your website where you want the tab to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag, i.e. after all the other page content.

Note that the settings for the above tab options are stored in the embed code. If you want to change them, you will need to copy and paste the Javascript again.

You can select the articles and news posts to display by default on the left of the overlay. Click the **Select content to show** button:

You can change this setting and the content displayed will update without you needing to re-paste the Javascript.

Embedding the chat widget

When clicked, the chat widget expands into a chat window.

Note that, depending on the chat permissions settings for the **Everyone** usergroup, users may have to log in before starting a chat.

To embed the chat widget:

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**
- 2 In the **Chat** section, set the options you want for the widget:
 - Edit the **Tab title** (text displayed on the minimized chat tab)
 - Choose the **Tab position** (bottom left or bottom right)
 - Choose the chat language.
- 3 By default, the chat widget is not shown if chat is disabled or there are no agents logged in. Check **Show button even when chat is offline** to change this; you can provide alternative text and a link where the tab will direct users when chat is offline (by default, this is to your contact form).
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code on the page on your website where you want the chat widget to appear. We recommend putting it just before the `</body>` tag.

Using a custom button with the chat widget

If you want to use your own custom HTML element/button to launch the chat widget on a page, add the special classname `dp-chat-trigger` to it. For example:

```
<button class="dp-chat-trigger">Start chatting</button>
```

You can use custom CSS on your page to hide the default button, and make sure your button is hidden when agents are offline:

```
<style type="text/css">
#dpchat_wrap {
    display: none !important;
    visibility: hidden !important;
}

.dp-chat-trigger {
    display: none !important;
}

.dp-chat-enabled .dp-chat-trigger {
    display: block !important;
}
</style>
```

Embedding a contact form

You can embed a contact form to allow users to submit tickets from your website.

▪
To embed a form:

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**.
- 2 In the **Contact Form** section, select the language for the form.
- 3 Choose whether to let the user select a department, or to make this form submit to a specific department only.
- 4 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 5 Insert the code where you want the form to appear.

You can use the ability to specify a department to put the most relevant forms on each area of your site. For example, you could put a form for your Sales department on a page about an upcoming product.

Embedding the whole portal

You can embed the whole portal within a page on your website.

▪

- 1 Go to **Portal > Embed**.
- 2 Under **Embed your entire helpdesk**, set the embedding options.
 - **Hide the sidebar and border**(on by default)
 - Select which helpdesk section is displayed initially.
 - Select the initial language to display
- 3 Copy all the code in the text box.
- 4 Insert the code where you want the portal to appear.

To make the embedded portal look more like a part of your site, you could use the Portal Editor **color chooser** or edit the portal template.

10.6. Ticket ref codes

By default, a ticket's ID number is displayed to users in email notifications and the portal, and acts as the user's reference for that ticket.

However, ticket ID numbers are assigned in sequence. That means they will reveal the total number of tickets you have had to your helpdesk, and let repeat users work out how many tickets you deal with. In addition, once you have a lot of tickets in your helpdesk, you will end up with long ID numbers that aren't readable or user-friendly.

You can choose to show **ref codes** to users instead of the ticket ID. A ref code is a string of numbers and letters that uniquely identifies a ticket, but isn't assigned sequentially, avoiding the problems mentioned above.

You can customize the ref code format to include information about the time the ticket was created; ticket reference `2014-01-26-AB379` is more meaningful than ticket ID `74983`.

To enable ref codes, go to **Tickets > Settings** and then the **Ticket Ref Codes** section, and check **Use ref codes**.

By default, ref codes are in the format `ABCD-1234-EFGH`.

If you check **Use a custom ref code**, you can enter the format you want as a string of tokens, surrounded by angle brackets. For example, `<YEAR>-<MONTH>-<A><A><A><#><#>` would give you codes such as `2014-05-QZD45`.

Anything you enter that isn't in angle brackets will be the same in every code.

Here are the available tokens:

Token	Result
<A>	A random letter
<#>	A random number
<?>	A random letter or number
<YEAR>	Year as a four-digit number (e.g. 2013)
<MONTH>	Month as a two-digit number (01-12)
<DAY>	Day as a two-digit number (01-31)
<HOUR>	Hour in 24-hour time (00-24)
<MIN>	Minute as a two-digit number (00-59)
<SEC>	Second as a two-digit number (00-59)

You can also choose to have up to 8 digits added onto the end of the code. These are added sequentially.

Here are some examples:

Format	Example codes
<YEAR>-<MONTH>-<DAY>- and append 3 digits	2014-10-02-001, 2014-10-02-002 (counting upwards)
<?><?><?><?><?><?>	1A45QR, 6BB73S

<YEAR>-<A><A><?><?><?>	2013-AB34Q, 2013-HXR81
ACME-<A><A><#><#><#><#>	ACME-AB2952, ACME-FV4541

11. Editing Templates

The most powerful way to customize the user-facing content of your helpdesk is to use DeskPRO's **template** system.

You can edit templates to change:

- the content of automatic notification emails
- the portal design and interface text

You can also add custom email templates.

Templates can include **phrases**: short, re-usable pieces of text, used to store something like the user greeting at the beginning of an email, or the name of a section of the portal.

A major advantage of storing text using phrases is that you can include the same phrase in many templates. DeskPRO's multi-language support is also based around phrases.

You can also access **variables** from a template, enabling you to retrieve information about the user who is logged in, the ticket they're currently viewing, etc., and display that back to the user.

You'll need a basic understanding of HTML to edit templates. If you want to customize the portal design, you'll need a more advanced knowledge of HTML/CSS.

11.1. Introducing templates

Here's an example of how to customize helpdesk content by editing a template and using phrases and variables.

Suppose you decide you want to edit the content of the automatic email users receive when they register an account. By default the email looks something like this:

As you'd expect, "Example User" is automatically replaced with the name of the user who's receiving the email. We'll see how this happens later.

Go to **Tickets > Email Templates** to find the corresponding template. Look under **User Email Templates** and you will see the **Welcome Email** template.

Click on the template to open the template editor window.

You'll see that the template contains code for the **Email Subject** and **Email Body**.

Let's look at the **Email Body**:

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
{{ phrase('user.emails.register-welcome') }}<br />  
<a href="{{ url_full('user') }}">{{ url_full('user') }}</a>  
  
{% if not person.is_agent_confirmed %}  
    <br /><br />  
    {{ phrase('user.emails.register-agent-validation') }}  
{% endif %}
```

You probably recognize that some of this is HTML markup: `<br />` for line breaks and `<a href=` to make a link.

The other parts, such as `{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}` and `{% if not person.is_agent_confirmed %} ... {% endif %}`, are the template syntax.

`{{ phrase('X') }}` is the syntax to include a phrase in the email.

You can look up phrases by going to **Settings > Languages** Under **Installed Languages**, click on your default language, then **Edit Phrases**.

Under **User Interface Phrases**, click on **Emails** to see email phrases. The default content for `user.emails.greeting` is:

```
Dear {{to_name}},
```

When the email is sent, the content of the phrase is inserted into the email. Since the phrase contains the `{{to_name}}` **variable**, when the email is sent, the template system replaces this with the variable content, which is the name of the user.

If the email is being sent in another language, the translated version of `user.emails.greeting` from the corresponding language pack gets inserted instead. For example, here's the Spanish translation:

Let's suppose your marketing department has decided that user emails should start with "Hello ..." rather than "Dear ..."

You could replace `{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}` with `Hello {{to_name}}`, but that would only change the greeting for this email type, and it wouldn't be translated into other languages.

A better solution is to go to **Setup > Languages** and use **Edit Phrases** to enter and save a custom version of the phrase.

▪

All the other email templates which use the phrase will now use the custom version. You can also use **Edit Phrases** to enter a custom translation for any other languages you have installed.

▪

11.2. Twig syntax basics

The templating system DeskPRO uses is called [Twig](#).

Below are the features you'll need to know to do the most common forms of customization.

Variables

You insert a variable into a template with double curly braces:

```
{{ }}
```

There are dozens of variables available for DeskPRO.

Here are some examples:

```
{{ ticket.subject }}      - the subject line of the current ticket
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }} - the user-facing display name of the
                                agent assigned to the current ticket
```

You'll find a listing of common variables below.

Tags

Twig also includes **tags** which control the logic of the template.

For example, the `{% if %}` tag lets you have a section of your template that only displays *if* a certain condition is met.

This code on a portal page:

```
{% if app.user.id %}
  <p>You are logged in.</p>
{% endif %}
```

would display the text "You are logged in" if the template could retrieve a user ID - i.e. if the user is logged in.

Other useful tags you will see in templates:

- `{% else %}` - used in conjunction with `{% if %}` to display content if its condition is *not* met
- `{% for %}` - creates a loop while a certain condition is met; you'll see this used in portal templates for displaying a list of items
- `{% include %}` - includes the content of one template within another

See the official Twig documentation at <http://twig.sensiolabs.org/doc/templates.html> for more information about what tags can do.

Comments

You can leave comments to explain what your custom templates do. Comments will not affect how the template works; they are just for human reference.

```
{# this is a comment #}
```

When you're troubleshooting a template, or trying to understand how the built-in templates work, it's useful to comment out a section of code to quickly disable it, and see how the template behaves without it. For example, here's

```
{# this comment wraps the code below  
{% for item in navigation %}  
    <li><a href="{{ item.href }}">  
        {{ item.caption }}</a></li>  
{% endfor %}  
#}
```

Don't use HTML comments within templates. If there are comments in a piece of inserted HTML, the two sets of comments can interact and cause mangled HTML display.

11.3. Customizing the email templates

You can access the email templates from **Tickets > Templates**.

The **Layout** templates affect the look of all emails by changing the HTML header/footer and CSS styling.

You can edit the built-in templates for the emails DeskPRO sends automatically.

If you're using a custom trigger to send an email for a particular situation, none of the default email templates may not be suitable. In that case, you can create a new **Custom Email Template**. Look at similar default templates to find variables and existing [phrases](#) you can use.

When creating a custom template, it's always best to store the user-facing text as phrases, rather than entering it directly into the template. Even if you only use one language in your helpdesk, using phrases can make it easier to maintain your templates.

For example, say your company slogan is "Simply the Best!" and your brand guidelines say you should use it in all outgoing email. You should store it as a phrase or add it to the email header/footer. Then, when the slogan changes, you can change it in one place instead of having to update all your templates.

Templates example: custom email auto-response by department

Suppose your helpdesk is configured to send the default automatic email response when a user submits a new ticket.

The marketing department comes to you with another great idea: users who submit new tickets to the sales department should get a custom acknowledgement email, with a 10% discount code, to reward their interest in your company.

How can you implement this?

- 1 Got to **Tickets > Email Templates**, then click **Custom Email Templates**
- 2 Click **Create a New Email Template**
- 3 In the window that opens, enter a descriptive file name for the new template, e.g. `marketing-auto-response.html`. Save the new blank template.
- 4 You can use the template for the regular auto-response email as the basis for the new template. Under **User Email Templates**, click **Ticket Emails**, then **New Ticket Auto-Response**. Copy the code for the subject and body into a text editor.

Email Subject: `{{ phrase('user.email_subjects.tickets_re') }}`

Email Body:

```

{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}

<br /><br />

{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}

<br /><br />

<dp:ticket-messages />

{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}
    <br /><br />

    {{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}
    <a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>
{% endif %}

```

This is an example of the output of the default template:

- 5 To change the user message, you can remove `{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}` and replace it with a reference to a suitable custom phrase.
- 6 Go to **Setup > Languages**, click **All Custom Phrases** then **+ Add Custom Phrase**. Enter a suitable custom phrase, then save it as something descriptive, e.g. `custom.sales-auto-response` :
- 7 Back in **Tickets > Email Templates**, edit the custom `marketing-auto-response.html` and add the code from the default response.
- 8 Replace the default `{{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_received') }}` with `{{ phrase('custom.sales-auto-response') }}` :

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
{{ phrase('custom.sales-auto-response') }}  
  
<br /><br />  
  
<dp:ticket-messages />  
  
{% if app.isPortalEnabled() %}  
  <br /><br />  
  
  {{ phrase('user.emails.ticket_access_ticket_online') }}  
  <a href="{{ ticket.link }}">{{ ticket.link }}</a>  
{% endif %}
```

9

Now set your helpdesk so that it sends an email using the new template when a user submits a ticket to the sales department via email or the portal.

11.4. Customizing the portal templates

Editing portal and widget templates works along the same principles as editing email templates, but the templates tend to be more complicated.

If you are interested in redesigning the style of the portal, you will need HTML/CSS design skills. You can edit the **custom.css** template to override the default portal CSS.

11.5. Useful template variables

You may recognize that many variables used in templates are the same ones you use for snippets in the agent interface.

They're also used in the DeskPRO Query Language you use when writing custom reports.

Logged-in user information

These variables will only work in contexts where the user is logged: portal or widget, but not email.

```
{{ app.user.name }} user's name
{{ app.user.email_address }} user's email address
{{ app.user.organization.name }} the name of users organization
{{ app.language.id }} - ID of user's language
```

Language

```
{{ lang.id }}
{{ lang.flag_image }}
{{ lang.title }}
```

Search results

```
{{ res.type }}
{{ res.object.id }} .title
```

Agent

```
{{ agent.display_name_user }}
```

Tickets

```

{{ ticket.subject }}
{{ ticket.department.title }} & {{ ticket.department.full_title }}

{{ ticket.fieldX }} (for custom fields; replace X with the field id)

{{ ticket.product.title }} current product of ticket
{{ ticket.category.title }} current category of ticket
{{ ticket.workflow.title }} current workflow stage of ticket
{{ ticket.priority.title }} current priority of ticket
{{ ticket.id }} ticket ID number
{{ ticket.ref }} ticket ref code
{{ ticket.fieldX }} display a custom ticket field; replace X with field ID
{{ ticket.date_created }} time and date ticket was created e.g. 2014-03-14 11:38:17
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }} name of currently assigned agent (override name if set)
{{ ticket.person.display_name }} user's name
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }} display a custom user field; replace X with field ID

<dp:ticket-messages /> list of ticket messages - note this doesn't need to be surrounded with {{ }}

```

Ticket user information

```

{{ ticket.person.display_name }} name of user associated with ticket
{{ ticket.person.primary_email }} ticket's user's email
{{ ticket.person.organization.name }} ticket's user's organization
{{ ticket.person.organization_position }} ticket's user's position in organization
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }} for custom ticket fields; replace X with the field id

```

Ticket agent

```

{{ ticket.agent.display_name }}
{{ ticket.agent.primary_email }}
{{ ticket.agent_team.name }}

```

Ticket form

```

{{ f.title }}
{{ f.field_def.description }}

```

Article

```

{{ article.person.display_name_user }} (author)
{{ article.title }} title

```

Message

```
{{ message.person.display_name_user }}
```

News

```
{{ news.person.display_name_user }}  
{{ news.category.title }}  
{{ news.content }}  
{{ news.link }}
```

Download

```
{{ download.title }}  
{{ download.content_desc }}  
{{ download.filename }}  
{{ download.readable_filesize }}  
{{ download.person.display_name_user }} - author of download  
{{ download.date_created|date('full') }} - piping
```

Feedback

```
{{ feedback.status }}  
{{ feedback.person.display_name_user }}  
{{ feedback.message }}  
{{ feedback.rating }}
```

Category

```
{{ category.title }}  
{{ subcat.title }}
```

Participant

"Participant" means a CC'd user.

```
{{ part.person.id }}  
{{ part.person.email_address }}
```

For a complete listing of DeskPRO variables, see the [DPQL Field Reference](#) article on the DeskPRO Knowledgebase. Note that not all of these variables will be available from every template; the available variables depend on context. The best way to work out what variables are available is to look at the default templates.

12. Localization

We're committed to making DeskPRO suitable for international use.

There is currently support for 19 languages, with the ability to option to enter your own custom phrase translations, or to contribute new translations into languages you need.

You can also fully customize the date format.

12.1. Date & time settings

You can customize the format that DeskPRO uses to display dates and times in the **Dates and Times** section of **Settings**.

The formatting will apply to the agent interface and the user web portal.

Use the format characters from the table below to specify how DeskPRO should display dates.

For example, the date format `M j Y` means that when the interface needs to display a date, it will display something like "Jan 1 2015". If you wanted it to display "1st January 15", you would edit the Date format field to read `"jS F y"`.

Format character	Description	Example output
Day		
d	Day of the month, 2 digits with leading zeros	01 to 31
D	A textual representation of a day, three letters	Mon through Sun
j	Day of the month without leading zeros	1 to 31
l (lowercase 'L')	A full textual representation of the day of the week	Sunday through Saturday
S	English ordinal suffix for the day of the month, 2 characters	st, nd, rd or th. Works well with j
z	The day of the year (starting from 0)	0 through 365
Week		
W	ISO-8601 week number of year, weeks starting on Monday	Example: 42 (the 42nd week in the year)
Month		
F	A full textual representation of a month, such as January or March	January through December
m	Numeric representation of a month, with leading zeros	01 through 12
M	A short textual representation of a month, three letters	Jan through Dec
n	Numeric representation of a month, without leading zeros	1 through 12
Year		
Y	A full numeric representation of a year, 4 digits	Examples: 1999 or 2003
y	A two digit representation of a year	Examples: 99 or 03
Time		
a	Lowercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	am or pm

A	Uppercase Ante meridiem and Post meridiem	AM or PM
g	12-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	1 through 12
G	24-hour format of an hour without leading zeros	0 through 23
h	12-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	01 through 12
H	24-hour format of an hour with leading zeros	00 through 23
i	Minutes with leading zeros	00 to 59
s	Seconds, with leading zeros	00 through 59
Timezone		
e	Timezone identifier	UTC, GMT, Atlantic/Azores
I (capital i)	Whether or not the date is in daylight saving time	1 if Daylight Saving Time, 0 otherwise
O	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) in hours	+0200
P	Difference to Greenwich time (GMT) with colon between hours and minutes	+02:00
T	Timezone abbreviation	EST, MDT
Full Date/Time		
c	ISO 8601 date	2004-02-12T15:19:21+00:00
r	RFC 2822 formatted date	Thu, 21 Dec 2000 16:01:07 +0200

12.2. Languages

DeskPRO has support for many international languages.

At **Setup > Languages** you can see:

- the default language of your helpdesk
- installed languages
- other installable languages

■

The level of translation support varies, as indicated by the blue labels on the right: most language packs currently have translations for **user** text (portal and emails) only. Some additionally translate the **agent** interface (and agent notification emails).

DeskPRO records the language of both tickets and users.

The language of a ticket is determined based on text character set. Users can pick their preferred language (from those you have installed) when they are logged in to the web portal, using the language selection control at the upper right.

■

Agents can change a user's language from within the agent interface, using the **Properties** section of the user record.

■

Changing a user's language will change the language in which they view the web portal, as well as the language of their notification emails. When a user's language changes, their tickets are switched to that language.

If the language for a ticket/user cannot be determined (e.g. the user has not yet logged in), the helpdesk default will be used.

Installing new languages

Installing a supported language is easy. Just go to the **Other Installable Languages** section, click on the language you want to install, then click **Install Language**.

After you've installed the language, you can click on it to view its settings.

■

If you want to make sure you support as many languages as possible, install every language pack, then click **Settings & Tools** at the bottom of the page and select **Automatically install new languages**.

You can select which flag to display for each language. This is useful if the language you've installed is used in multiple countries, but your customers who speak that language will mainly come from a particular country.

■

Translating names of custom values

For a full translation, you will need to provide the translated terms for any custom values you have entered:

- Department names (ticket & chat)
- Products
- Ticket priorities
- Feedback statuses
- Feedback types
- Knowledgebase categories
- Ticket fields
- Person (user) fields

For example, if you have enabled French, DeskPRO won't know the correct French name for your 'Returns' department, so you have to enter it.

- 1 Click on your newly-installed language to view detailed settings.
- 2 Click the **Edit Phrases** button, and on the following page, click on the first entry under **Resources**.
- 3 In each **Resources** section, click on each item in the **Translated** column, and enter a translation into the new language, then click **Save**.
▪
- 4 Repeat until you have translated all your custom values.

Editing user interface phrases

Almost all of DeskPRO's interface text (including text used in notification emails) is stored as **phrases** which are editable through **Setup > Languages**. This applies even if you only have one language installed.

You can enter a custom version of any phrase to change the user-facing text. You can use this to fix translation problems, or to rewrite user-facing text in your organization's style.

To change a phrase in any of our language packs:

- 1 Select the relevant language and click **Edit Phrases**.
- 2 Find the phrase you want to change in **User Interface Phrases**.
- 3 Enter a new version of the phrase in the **Custom** column.
- 4 Make sure you scroll down and click **Save**.

The **template** system, used to define the portal and notification emails, determines where each phrase is shown.

For example, look at **Tickets > Email Templates**. In all the templates, the body of the email begins:

```
{{ phrase('user.emails.greeting') }}
```

This tells DeskPRO to insert the `user.emails.greeting` phrase automatically at the beginning of every email.

If you wanted to change how you greet your users, you could enter a custom version of `user.emails.greeting` :

▪

See the chapter on [Editing Templates](#) for more information.

Changing default language

Simply select an installed language from the **Default Language** pulldown to change the default language.

From **Settings & Tools**, you can apply mass updates to tickets or users. This is useful if you want to apply a new language to users who have not explicitly picked a language.

For example, suppose you know that most of your users speak Russian and you have been evaluating DeskPRO with only English installed, during which time many users have registered.

Once you install Russian, instead of changing users one by one, you could just update all 'no language' users to Russian:

■

Any users who haven't explicitly selected English as their language now have their language set to Russian.

Agent interface language setting

If a language has **agent** support, agents can select which language they wish to use from their **Preferences** in the agent interface.

You can't change an agent's language from the admin interface, except by logging in as the agent.

Crowdsourced translation

If the language you want is not available, or doesn't support all the interfaces you require, you can contribute a translation via our crowdsourcing system at <http://languages.deskpro.com>. You can use this system to fix any translation errors you find, so they will be corrected in future DeskPRO updates.

You will need to create an account or login via Facebook to contribute.

If you have other translation requirements, please contact us at support@deskpro.com.

13. Extending DeskPRO

You can extend DeskPRO with **apps** to integrate your helpdesk with other services, or add new functions.

We have provided a number of ready-made apps. Some of these are **authentication apps** which enable agents or users to log in using credentials from other services, rather than a DeskPRO account. Others provide more extensive integration with other services.

There are several ways for you to create your own custom integrations and extensions:

- **Widgets** are a simple way to customize the agent interface using HTML and Javascript.
- **Full apps** require more development skills, but are more powerful.
- We offer a comprehensive [REST API](#) so that your code can access helpdesk data and run actions.
- [Web hook actions](#) enable DeskPRO automations (triggers, escalations, SLAs, macros) to make HTTP requests to external services.

13.1. Installing the ready-made apps

We have provided a variety of ready-made DeskPRO apps to provide new functionality and integration with other services.

Go to the **Apps** section of the admin interface to see the list of installed and available apps.

▪

The [authentication apps](#) lower down the list allow users or agents to log in to DeskPRO with credentials from an external service (e.g. their Facebook account, a database you maintain, their network login at your company, etc).

Click on any app to install and configure it.

Most apps that operate with third-party services require you to provide an **API token** or some other authentication code from your account with the third-party service: if it is not clear where to get this from, consult the documentation for the service.

Gravatar

This app shows image avatars from the [Gravatar](#) service for any user or agent who has signed up for one.

The Gravatar app does not require any configuration. Simply select the app and click **Install** to add it to your helpdesk.

Gravatar is a shared profile service used on WordPress blogs and across many other sites. If a user or agent has a Gravatar image linked to their email address, it will be displayed next to their name in the agent interface and on the portal.

▪

If the user or agent has already uploaded a profile picture, their Gravatar is not shown.

Share Widget

The share widget enables you to show buttons on the portal which let users quickly share selected categories of your portal content on social media sites (Facebook, Twitter, Google Plus and LinkedIn).

The only configuration the app requires is selecting which services you want to show buttons for.

▪

The share buttons are shown on Knowledgebase articles, news posts and feedback items.

▪

Clicking one of the buttons takes the user to a screen where they can confirm that they want to Tweet/share/+1 a link to the item (if they are signed in to the relevant service - otherwise they will be prompted to sign in first).

Google Analytics

This app lets you use [Google Analytics](#) to understand traffic on your helpdesk portal.

- 1 Go to <https://www.google.com/analytics/> and sign in to your existing Analytics account or sign up for a new account.
- 2 Create a new Analytics property for your helpdesk within Analytics: **Admin > Property pull-down > Create New Property**.
- 3 Enter the requested information and click **Get Tracking ID**.
- 4 The Tracking ID is shown on the following page. It's a code of the format UA-12345678-9. It's also shown next to the property e.g. **Admin > Property Settings**
 -
- 5 In the DeskPRO admin interface, go to **Apps**, select Google Analytics and click **Install App**.
 -
- 6 The Google Analytics tracking code will now be added to the portal. To confirm it is installed, go to the Analytics interface, then in **Admin** select the property and go to **Tracking Info > Tracking Code**
 -

Once installed, you will be able to view traffic to the portal within Google Analytics.

Highrise

This app integrates information from the [Highrise](#) contacts tracking service into your agent interface.

- 1 Go to **Apps** and click Highrise, then click **Install**.
- 2 Enter the Highrise **API URL**: this is just the web address of your Highrise account, e.g. <https://acmel25.highrisehq.com>.
- 3 Enter the Highrise **API Token** from **Account & Settings > My Info > API Token**
 -
- 4 Select which of the two Highrise widgets you want to enable:
 - The ticket widget adds a Highrise tab on tickets, providing a quick link to Highrise information.
 -
 - The profile widget adds a Highrise section when viewing a user's profile from the agent interface.
 -

HipChat

Installing this app gives you a new [trigger](#) action which can send messages to a rooms on the [HipChat](#) IM service.

This enables you to set up useful IM alerts, for example, notification of important tickets.

You must sign up for a HipChat account first.

- 1 Log in to the HipChat web interface and go to **Group admin > API** or <https://www.hipchat.com/admin/api>*
- 2 Under **Create new token**, make sure **Admin** is selected and enter a label so you can remember what the token is for.
 -
- 3 Copy the API token.
- 4 In the DeskPRO admin interface, go to **Apps**, select **HipChat** and click **Install**.
 -
- 5 Paste the **API Token** into the field. Check **Notify** if you want HipChat users who have joined the room to get an audio/pop-up notification when a new message is sent.
- 6 You can now use the **Announce to HipChat Room** action in triggers.
 -

Make sure that you have entered the name of the HipChat room exactly as it appears in HipChat.

* Note, you must use an API token from the HipChat "Group admin" settings. The API access token for your individual account will not work. You may need to consult your HipChat admin.

Microsoft Translator

Installing the Microsoft Translator app adds automatic message translation features to the agent interface.

To install this app, you first need to sign up with the Microsoft Translator service and get the needed credentials.

- 1 Sign up for a [Microsoft account](#), or log in to your existing Microsoft account.
- 2 Sign up for [Windows Azure Marketplace](#), or log in to your existing account.
- 3 Subscribe to the [Microsoft Translator API](#). You can select a free subscription which offers 2 million characters of translation per month.
- 4 In the lower navigation area of the [Windows Azure Marketplace](#), go to **Develop > Register Your Application**.
- 5 Enter the **Client ID** and **Name**. Copy the **Client Secret**. Under **Redirect URI**, put a valid web address such as the URL for your helpdesk or website.
 -
- 6 You can now install the app by going to **Apps** in the DeskPRO admin interface, selecting Microsoft Translator and clicking **Install**.
- 7 Enter the **Client ID** and **Client Secret** and click **Save**.

The Translator functions are now available from the agent interface. Agents can translate outgoing messages they are entering into the reply box, or translate messages from a ticket's history.

-

Remember that the Translator app can be useful to help agents understand messages in a language they don't speak, but they should be cautious about sending translated messages since machine translation is often far from perfect.

JIRA Integration

The JIRA Integration app enables your agents to export tickets to issues in an installation of the [Atlassian JIRA](#) issue tracker software.

The integration works with either the Download or OnDemand (hosted) versions of JIRA.

To install this app:

- 1 Go to **Apps** within the DeskPRO admin interface and click **JIRA Integration**.
- 2 Enter the requested information.
- 3 Click **Install App**.

The app adds an **Export to JIRA** button in the agent interface when you open a ticket in the content pane.

Click the button to create a linked issue within JIRA based on the ticket details.

You can select the JIRA project, type and priority, as well as which JIRA user should be assigned the issue. The DeskPRO ID or ref code is added to the JIRA issue title. The issue description is prefilled with the ticket's full message history, which you can edit.

Once you've created a linked issue, you can view it in the ticket's JIRA tab.

The speech bubble icon in the **Actions** section of the tab adds a comment to the linked JIRA issue. Any comments added to the issue in JIRA are imported into DeskPRO as ticket notes.

The X icon unlinks the ticket from the JIRA issue.

Salesforce

The Salesforce app provides quick access to Salesforce customer profiles from the agent interface.

Note that your Salesforce account must include API access for this app to work. This is available to Enterprise or Performance accounts, and to Professional accounts for an extra fee; access may not be enabled for a trial account.

To install this app:

- 1 Go to **Apps** within the DeskPRO admin interface and select the Salesforce app.
- 2 Enter your Salesforce username (usually an email address), password and API security token*.
- 3 Select whether you want a Salesforce widget to be displayed on tickets, user profiles, or both.

* The only way to get your API token from Salesforce is via email. If you don't have a token, go to **Your Name > My Settings > Personal > Reset My Security Token** from the Salesforce Web interface. Doing this will invalidate any previous tokens, so you will need to enter the new token for any other apps or services which use the API. Changing your Salesforce password also resets the token.

Once the app is installed, you will be able to see links to Salesforce customer profiles that match the DeskPRO user on tickets and user profiles (depending on which widgets you enabled).

Authentication apps

There are authentication apps for the following services:

- Microsoft's **Active Directory** network sign-on and the similar open **LDAP** standard
- **Database** - use credentials stored in an existing database: MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, MsSQL and Oracle are supported
- **eZ Publish** and **Joomla** content management systems
- **Facebook**, **Google** and **Twitter**
- **phpBB**, **vBulletin** and **Xenforo** forum software

13.2. Using web hook actions

DeskPRO can use a **web hook action** (as part of a trigger, escalation, SLA or macro) to interact with external services that accept commands using the web's [HTTP](#) protocol.

Many services offer HTTP APIs, so this provides a relatively simple way to have DeskPRO interact with other software you use (or custom software your organization has developed). For example, if a suitable API is available, you could post a warning on your intranet when a ticket fails an SLA.

When the action runs, it sends an HTTP request using the HTTP method you specify from POST, GET, PUT and DELETE. A POST, PUT or DELETE request includes a representation of the relevant ticket in [JSON](#) format. This enables the external service to use the information about the ticket. A GET request has an empty body.

See the Knowledgebase article [Web hook action JSON format](#) for an example of the JSON format.

Note that this option can only send data *from* DeskPRO *to* an external service. If you want an external service to change data within your helpdesk, you will need to use the DeskPRO API.

To create a web hook:

- 1 Select the **Call Web Hook** action type within a trigger, escalation, SLA or macro.
 -
- 2 Fill in the requested settings:
 -
 - **URL** means the URL where the external service accepts requests
 - **username and password** to authenticate with the external service (if required)
 - **custom headers and data** that will be included in the request (consult the documentation for the API/service you are using to select appropriate values for these)
 - **timeout** specifies how long in seconds DeskPRO will wait for the HTTP request to be acknowledged by the external service before giving up.
- 3 Click **Save**.

Whenever the action runs, DeskPRO will make the specified HTTP request.

To help with debugging, you can view the HTTP requests that an action is sending by using [RequestBin](#), a tool that collects and displays requests in a readable way. You will need to temporarily change the URL for the action to the address provided by RequestBin.

13.3. Managing DeskPRO API keys

Third-party apps which use the DeskPRO API (including your own apps) will need a DeskPRO **API key** to gain access to your helpdesk.

Bear in mind that anyone with access to one of your API keys can change data in your helpdesk, so you should be very careful about sharing or publishing them.

■

To generate a key:

- 1 Go to **Apps > API Keys**.
- 2 Click **+ New API Key**.
- 3 Enter a brief **Description** which explains what the key will be used for.
- 4 Set if you want the API Key to have super user privileges (it can act as any agent, specified in the request), or the same access as a specific agent; in the later case, you must also select the agent.

Click **Save**. Click on the key in the list at the left to view the API key.

It's a good idea to make a separate key for each app you use.

If you think a key has become known to somebody you don't trust, you can **Delete** or **Regenerate** it. Regenerating a key means its description is kept, but the key code is changed and the old one will no longer work.

■

13.4. Creating your own widgets and apps

See the [Apps Developer Guide](#) on the DeskPRO Knowledgebase for how to develop widgets. You will need a basic understanding of HTML and Javascript.

The guide will shortly be expanded to explain how to create and upload full DeskPRO apps.

14. Satisfaction Survey

To help measure agent performance, you can enable a **satisfaction survey**.

This offers users the option to submit a brief rating and comment when marking a ticket resolved through the user portal, or when viewing a ticket they have previously resolved.

-

Go to **Tickets > Satisfaction** to enable the survey.

-

You can choose whether agents can view the satisfaction ratings and comments on their own tickets:

-

You can access satisfaction data through the **Reports** interface:

-

The **Feed** view shows you details of recent ratings, while the **Summary** view shows you the total of each agent's positive, neutral and negative ratings for the current month.

15. Chat

DeskPRO offers IM-style live chat to allow users to message your agents. Users can access chat from your portal or from a chat widget which you can embed into your website.

Use **Chat > Setup** to enable or disable the chat system altogether. This page also provides the code for embedding the chat widget - see the section on [Website integration](#) for details.

Note that by default, the chat widget (either on the portal or embedded) won't appear unless there is at least one agent signed into chat from the agent interface.

You can customize the information stored for a chat session using custom chat **fields**, under **Chat > Fields**. These work much like custom ticket fields.

You can also manage the [labels](#) that agents have applied to chats under **Chat > Labels**.

15.1. Chat departments

Chat departments are used to control access to chats in conjunction with usergroups and agent permission groups. See the section on [Department permissions](#) for more details.

Chat departments are a separate system from ticket departments - creating a ticket department will not create the corresponding chat department. Manage them under **Chat > Departments**

16. Labels

Agents can apply **labels** from the agent interface. A label is a text tag that can be applied to the following helpdesk content:

- Tickets
- Users
- Organizations
- Downloads
- News posts
- Feedback

Labels are not shared between different content types, but agents can see each others' labels.

Labels have the following benefits:

- 1 Searches from the agent interface **Quick Search** bar match labels. This means that a ticket labelled "engine" would show up in a search for "engine" even if the word "engine" isn't mentioned in the ticket messages.
- 2 Agents can use labels to filter tickets from the agent interface filter pane.
- 3 Labels applied to Publish content can help users navigate the portal.

You can apply labels with automatic actions. For example, you might want to set up a **Ticket Update** trigger so that when a ticket is assigned to a certain **Product**, a label of the product name is applied. That way agents can quick search for the product to find matching tickets, even if they don't mention the full product name directly.

Editing labels

To view and edit labels, go to the **Labels** section for the relevant type of content:

- **Labels > Tickets**
- **CRM > Labels > Users**
- **CRM > Labels > Organizations**
- **Portal > Knowledgebase > Labels**
- **Portal > Downloads > Labels**
- **Portal > News > Labels**
- **Portal > Feedback > Labels**

Each Labels section shows a list of labels that admins or agents have created.

Agents can add any label they want from the agent interface, but they will be prompted to choose from the list of pre-existing labels. Therefore, if you wish to guide agents to use certain labels, you should add them from the admin interface so they show up on the list of choices. Simply click the **+Add** button to add a new label.

You can **delete** a label by selecting it and clicking the **Delete** button. This removes it from all items to which it has been applied.

Merging labels

An alternative to deleting is to **merge** two labels. For example, suppose your helpdesk has two versions of a label, one correct and one misspelled.

▪

Deleting the misspelled version would lose the information about which tickets it had been applied to. A better alternative is to merge both versions.

Click on the misspelled version, edit the label text so it's exactly the same as the correct version, then click **Save**.

▪

All the tickets with either label are now labelled with the correct version:

▪

17. Agent Interface Options

These options affect how agents work with tickets in the agent interface.

17.1. Automatic ticket locking

Confusion about who is working on a ticket is usually prevented by:

- agent assignment
- the ability for agents to see each other's draft messages

If an agent needs to prevent other agents changing a ticket, they can use the DeskPRO **locking** feature to manually lock it.

You can also enable **automatic locking** of tickets from **Tickets > Settings**, based on which agent has opened the ticket:

▪

Automatic locking might be useful if you find your agents are duplicating work, or getting into disagreements about who is replying to a ticket.

The **lock timeout** is the period of time before the lock is automatically removed. It applies to both automatic and manual locks. This is necessary to prevent locks being left on too long (for example, if an agent locks a ticket and then forgets about it).

17.2. Setting ticket defaults for agents

Under **Tickets > Settings > Ticket Defaults** you can configure the default values for the agent interface when the agent is creating or replying to a ticket.

■

You can change these to reflect how your agents use DeskPRO. Pick defaults which reflect what agents do most often to increase their productivity.

For example, when an agent is replying to an unassigned ticket, the default is to assign it to that agent when the reply is sent, unless the **Agent** checkbox is cleared. If this default does not reflect how your agents use DeskPRO, you can change it.

The options available are:

- New Ticket defaults
 - Set status - choose the default status when creating a new ticket
 - Set agent (when ticket is unassigned) - choose whether to assign to self or leave ticket unassigned
 - Set team (when ticket has no team)
 - User notification - choose whether to check the "send user email notification" checkbox by default; if you disable this, agents must manually select for the user to receive an email notification of the new ticket
 - Ticket Reply defaults
 - Set status - choose the default status when replying
 - Set agent (when ticket is unassigned)
 - Set agent (when ticket is already assigned)
 - Set team (when ticket has no team)
 - Set team (when ticket is already assigned to a team)
 - User notification - choose whether to check the "send user email notification" checkbox by default; if you disable this, agents must manually select if the user receives their reply by email (not recommended unless users regularly check the portal)
 - Automatically set status - when changing the assigned agent from the reply box, choose whether to automatically change the status to **Awaiting Agent** (since normally if an agent is assigning the ticket to another agent, that agent is likely to be the next person to reply)
 - Automatically enable "close tab" - when changing the status to Resolved from the reply box, choose whether to automatically check the "close tab after reply" option.
- Note that these settings only affect defaults when agents reply via the agent interface, not if they reply via email. You may want to automatically assign tickets to the agents who reply to them by email. You can do this with triggers. See [this worked example](#).
- Ticket View
 - Reverse message order - choose whether to show newest messages first with the reply box at the top.

This lets you select the default order that agents see the messages on a ticket, newest at top or oldest at top:

■

Agents can change this for themselves using the agent interface Preferences. The agent Preferences setting overrides the default you select here.

17.3. Time log & billing

If your agents need to bill users based on the support they provide, you can enable the **time log** and **ticket billing** features.

The time log lets agents record the amount of time they spend on a ticket, while ticket billing lets them specify an amount of money to charge for support.

This is not to be confused with the **Billing & Licensing interface** where you pay for your DeskPRO license, accessible through the  icon at the lower left.

You can enable time logging and billing separately. If either option is enabled, tickets in the agent interface have a **Billing** tab.

▪

Go to **Tickets > Time Log & Billing** to change the settings.

The **Time Log** section lets you enable the time log, and choose whether to **Automatically start timer** as soon as the ticket is opened by an agent. Note that the agent still has to press the **Add Charge** button to save the elapsed time.

▪

The **Ticket Billing** section lets you enable or disable monetary billing. You can edit the currency name.

▪

Users are not notified of times and charges recorded by agents - you will need to bill users outside of DeskPRO. To facilitate this process, you can use the **Reports** interface to see summaries of all charges; note that you can generate reports by organization as well as by user.

▪

17.4. Custom filters

Ticket filters enable agents to view a list of all the tickets which meet a set of conditions. Agents can create their own filters from the agent interface; these are visible only to the agent who made them.

You can define custom filters for your helpdesk to be shown to all agents, to supplement the built-in filters like **My Tickets**. Filters make it easy for agents to track specific groups of tickets without repeated searching.

Create filters from **Tickets > Filters**.

■

Each filter has its own set of criteria and will only show tickets that match them all. Filters are shown in the agent interface filter pane. Filters you create from the admin interface can be visible to a specific agent, to a specific team, or to everyone.

17.5. Ticket archiving

Once a ticket has been marked resolved, most helpdesks can leave it that way. There is no need to delete resolved tickets.

However, if your helpdesk has a very large number of old tickets (over a million), you can greatly improve agent interface performance by enabling **ticket archiving**.

Archiving automatically moves resolved tickets to a special **archived** status which means they don't show up in the main filters.

Agents can still view archived tickets using the **Archived** filter, and find them from the Quick Search bar or by carrying out an advanced search and including archived status.

Agents can change archived tickets back to another status if they have the correct permission.

To enable archiving, go to **Tickets > Statuses > Archived** and check **Enabled**.

■

The **Auto-Archive** setting controls how long DeskPRO leaves a ticket as 'resolved' before setting it to 'archived'.

The **Reset Search Index** button is used to resolve certain very rare errors and database issues that can happen when archiving is enabled. There is no need to use it unless you are directed to do so by a DeskPRO technical support agent.

17.6. Ticket purging

When agents delete a ticket or mark it as spam, it is kept in the Recycle Bin/Spam for a set period of time before being permanently deleted by an automatic cleanup process. This gives your agents some time to retrieve tickets that are mistakenly deleted or marked as spam.

You can set the period until purging by going to **Tickets > Statuses > Hidden Statuses** and then clicking **Deleted** or **Spam**.

The default period until automatic cleanup is **1 month**.

You can use the **Run cleanup now** button to instantly delete all the tickets in the Recycle Bin or Spam. You might want to do this to purge your helpdesk of test tickets before you go into production. Bear in mind this cannot be undone.

18. Importing User Data

If you have data on users from another system, and you want to quickly create DeskPRO accounts for them, you can import data as a CSV (*Comma-Separated Values*) file. CSV is a simple comma-separated text format that can be exported from spreadsheet programs (e.g. Excel) and databases.

The exact format of the CSV file containing user data doesn't matter. The DeskPRO import function lets you select which column from the CSV file corresponds to which field in DeskPRO.

If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can use a more flexible data importer which can import all the data from [legacy helpdesk systems](#).

An alternative to importing account data is to enable users or agents to log in using credentials from a different system (for example, from an existing database, or their network login) by installing [authentication apps](#).

If you have other data import requirements, please contact us at support@deskpro.com.

18.1. Importing user data in CSV format

Here's an example of how a simple user data CSV file might look in your spreadsheet program:

and in a text editor:

```
Brian Wolf,coyote1@example.com,Aardvark Inc.,enter
Maria User,maria1961@example.com,DreadCo,rando
Davey,daveyh2@example.com,,extra
Sue Cheam,suey333@example.com,Alpha,junk
```

Some programs may output CSV files with the fields quoted, e.g.:

```
"Maria User","maria1961@example.com","DreadCo","rando"
```

DeskPRO will ignore the quotation marks when importing the data.

Note that some programs may output "CSV" files where the fields are separated by semicolons or tabs, instead of commas. Importing these formats is not supported; consult the documentation for the software you're exporting from to find out how to output a comma-separated file.

In **CRM > CSV import**, click **Select CSV File**, select the CSV file with your data, then **Click here to upload file**.

Once the file is uploaded, you can use the next screen to map the CSV columns to DeskPRO fields.

By default, the importer assumes that the first row of your data consists of labels like "Name", "Email" etc. If that is *not* the case (as in this example) you should select the **Import the first row** option.

All users must have at least one email address, so you must select a mapping to the "primary email" field.

- Users without a valid email address will not be imported.
- If an account already exists with a user's primary email address, the user will not be imported.

You can map columns from the CSV file to these DeskPRO fields:

- Basic Information
 - First Name
 - Last Name
 - Name
 - Title (Mr., Mrs., etc)
 - Primary Email (required)
 - Secondary Email
 - Password
 - Organization
 - Organization Position
- Contact Details
 - Phone Number
 - Website URL
 - IM
 - Twitter account
 - LinkedIn profile URL
 - Facebook profile URL
 - Address Line 1
 - Address Line 2
 - City
 - State
 - Post Code
 - Country
- Custom Fields
 - either existing custom user fields, or a new one you define (see below)

If you do not map a password field, a random password will be generated automatically for each user.

Once you have the configuration you want, you can start the import. The import will be automatically scheduled and done for you in the background. You do not need to keep your browser on the page except to get status updates as the import happens.

Importing into custom fields

If your data set has fields that you can't map to standard DeskPRO fields, you can import them into custom fields. If you haven't created the fields ahead of time, you can create them when configuring the import by selecting the **New Custom Field** mapping option.

If you create a new choice-based field, new choices will be automatically created as new values are found for the field. If you import into an existing choice-based custom field, you can control whether new choices will be automatically created.

To import into a date-based custom field, the data you are importing must either be a UNIX timestamp or in the format YYYY-MM-DD (for example, 2012-10-24).

Importing contact data

The CSV importer supports importing contact data such as phone numbers and addresses and assigning a "label" to them. This label can be used to indicate, for example, a business phone versus a home phone. The label is optional in most cases.

However, when importing addresses, the label field is used to group related address parts together (such as the street with the city with the postal code). Therefore, if your data set has two or more sets of addresses, you must enter a distinct label for each "set" of address fields.

For example, if your data has "Business Street", "Business City", "Home Street" and "Home City", then you would need to enter one label (e.g.) for "Business Street" and "Business City", and a different label (e.g.) for "Home Street" and "Home City".

18.2. Importing data from legacy systems

DeskPRO Download offers a flexible data importer for transferring information from other systems into your helpdesk. It can read data in CSV and osTicket formats, and with PHP programming skills, you can extend it to handle other formats, e.g. data from your own internal systems.

See the [DeskPRO Importer Manual](#) for details.

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, please contact us at support@deskpro.com to discuss data import.

Importing data from Zendesk

If you are using DeskPRO Download, you can import the data from a Zendesk helpdesk using the Zendesk API. Please refer to the knowledgebase article [Importing from Zendesk](#) for details.

If you are using DeskPRO Cloud, please contact us at support@deskpro.com to discuss importing Zendesk data.

Importing data with the DeskPRO API

You can also use the DeskPRO API to move data between an external source and your helpdesk. This is the most flexible method, but requires software development knowledge. See the Knowledgebase article [API Basics](#) for an introduction to the API.

19. Managing DeskPRO Download

DeskPRO Download gives you more flexibility and control than the Cloud version, but requires some administration.

This chapter contains advice on maintaining and optimizing a DeskPRO Download installation.

19.1. Securing DeskPRO

The standard security precautions for any web app software apply to DeskPRO. Here are some specific suggestions.

- 1 Make DeskPRO application files non-writable by the web server. This is good practice in general, so DeskPRO is no different.
- 2 You can go a step further and make DeskPRO files non-writable by anyone. Updating to a new version using the admin interface requires write-access to files, so if you do this, you will need to install updates manually.

The `data/` directory must always be writable by both the cron user and the web server. It's where log info and temp files are stored.

- 1 Move your `data/` directory outside of the web root. You must specify the new path in `config.php` using the `$DP_CONFIG['dir_data']` variable.
- 2 Configure the web server not to execute or serve files in the `data/` directory. This ensures that even if a malicious PHP file was written to `data/`, it cannot execute.
- 3 Regularly monitor the PHP and MySQL error logs from **Server > Error Logs** and the `data/logs/error.log` file that DeskPRO writes.

19.2. Resetting passwords from the command line

Note that if you are using DeskPRO Download, admins need to use a command-line tool to reset their passwords for security reasons.

To view a list of the admins and agents currently in your helpdesk:

```
php /path_to_deskpro/cmd.php dp:agents
```

replacing `path_to_deskpro` with the path to the directory where DeskPRO was installed.

Then execute this command, replacing 'XX' with the ID of the account which needs a password reset:

```
php /path_to_deskpro/cmd.php dp:agents --reset-password=XX
```

19.3. DeskPRO Download performance tuning

For most helpdesks, DeskPRO is fast and reliable when properly configured, even on relatively modest hardware or budget virtual private server hosting.

If you are experiencing slow performance, consider the following:

- 1 Check **Server > Error Logs** for any repeated errors that are impacting performance. Note that while the DeskPRO Error Log is specific to DeskPRO, the PHP error logs will include PHP errors from any other PHP applications you are running on the server.
- 2 Make sure you have switched from storing binary files in the MySQL database to either filesystem storage or Amazon S3 cloud hosting. See the sections on [DeskPRO Download file storage](#) and [Using Amazon S3 for storing files](#).
- 3 Install a supported **PHP accelerator** (software which caches compiled PHP code to improve performance):
 - [APC](#) (Alternative PHP Cache) for Apache and Nginx
 - [Windows Cache Extension](#) for IIS
- 4 If you have a very large number of resolved tickets (over a million) and the agent interface is slow, enable [ticket archiving](#).
- 5 If you are running DeskPRO on a virtual machine, give the VM the same number of processors that the physical machine actually has.

19.4. Proxy servers and load-balancing

You can run DeskPRO with proxy servers. You may also choose to run it using multiple load-balanced nodes to increase availability. In these scenarios, you should enable proxy mode so that DeskPRO will trust IP addresses forwarded in HTTP headers.

To enable proxy mode, in the DeskPRO `config.php` edit the following line:

```
$DP_CONFIG['trust_proxy_data'] = false;
```

You must specify the IP addresses or address ranges of trusted proxies using [CIDR notation](#):

```
$DP_CONFIG['trust_proxy_data'] = array(  
    '192.168.1.83',      // whitelist this specific IP  
    '192.168.0.0/24'     // whitelist this range (192.168.0.0 - 255)  
    '@etc/proxy_list.php', // read addresses from file (as PHP array)  
);
```

If this is not configured correctly, it may appear that all users have the same IP address (the address of the proxy server).

For DeskPRO to function properly, the servers it interacts with must be sending proper headers with each request:

- **X-Forwarded-For:** The IP address of the user
- **X-Forwarded-Host:** The real hostname the user requested
- **X-Forwarded-Port:** The real port the user requested (usually 80 or 443 for SSL)
- **X-Forwarded-Proto:** The protocol (http or https) of the user request

19.5. Updating DeskPRO

If you're using the Cloud version of DeskPRO, updating is automatic; you don't have to do anything to make sure that you have the latest version.

To update DeskPRO Download, you can use our automatic upgrader tools. They handle all the details of transitioning between versions, such as database schema changes.

When an update for DeskPRO Download is available, you will be notified on the Home page. The best way to update for most installations is to use the automatic updater by clicking **Update DeskPRO Now**.

■

The automatic updater uses the cron/Scheduled Task system. This means the cron/Scheduled Task user must have write permissions on all DeskPRO files for the update to work. If the updater gets stuck at an early stage of the process, as shown in the screenshot below, that probably indicates a permissions problem. To work round this, you can use the command-line updater instead.

■

The automatic updater gives you the option to back up the database and/or the DeskPRO source files, so you can revert to them in the unlikely event there's a problem.

You can also choose to set a time delay before the update begins. This option will show an alert to any agents who are using your helpdesk, so they know to finish their work. You can use this to schedule the update for a time when there will be little usage of the helpdesk.

While the update happens, the helpdesk will be unavailable for a few minutes (depending on the size of your database). Under **User Offline Message** you can customize the notice that users will see on the portal during the update.

Command-line updater

If updating your configuration does not work from the admin interface, you can use an interactive command-line update utility.

From the directory where you installed DeskPRO, run:

```
php upgrade.php
```

■

The utility will guide you through the process of updating.

Manually installing updates

If the command-line updater does not work, you can manually update using the following steps:

- 1 Download the latest version of DeskPRO from <https://www.deskpro.com/downloads/deskpro.zip>.
- 2 Make a backup of the current DeskPRO files before you install updates in case you need to revert back.
- 3 Move the existing `data/` directory outside of the original DeskPRO install folder.
- 4 Copy your existing `config.php` to a safe place.
- 5 Extract the contents of `deskpro.zip` you downloaded in step 1, overwriting all existing files.
- 6 From inside the DeskPRO install directory, run the command-line upgrade tool:

```
php cmd.php dp:upgrade
```

The upgrade tool will ask if you want to produce a database backup before applying updates. We highly recommend you answer 'yes', in case you need to revert the upgrade.
- 7 The `data/` directory created in the install process may contain important log information, so copy it. Move the original `data/` directory from step 3 back into the DeskPRO install directory.
- 8 Move the original `config.php` file from step 4 back into the DeskPRO install directory.

Updating multiple servers

If you have multiple webserver (e.g. for load-balancing purposes), bear in mind that you will need to update each one.

19.6. Backing up or moving a DeskPRO server

You should turn off the helpdesk before moving your DeskPRO installation to a new server.

There are only two parts of DeskPRO with data that you need to copy when moving or backing up a server:

- 1 The MySQL database
To copy the MySQL database, use the [mysqldump](#) tool to dump the data (and then restore it if necessary). We recommend using the MySQL tools, not phpmyadmin.
- 2 The files on the filesystem.
Copy or move all the files within the root directory of your web server where you installed DeskPRO originally e.g. `/var/www` if you're using Apache.

When restoring a server, make sure you edit the `config.php` file to update any values that have changed in the new environment: e.g. location of your `/data/` directory. You will also need to recreate the `cron` jobs or Scheduled Tasks.

If you have moved a server and it is acting as if it is a fresh installation, check that the file `is_installed.dat` exists within your data directory.

19.7. Storing binary data

By default, uploaded files (such as email attachments) are stored in the MySQL database. However, databases are not designed to store binary data like this efficiently, so this configuration may reduce performance (for example, when backing up the database) and increase the required storage space.

Apart from using the database, DeskPRO supports two other storage methods:

- Storing files in the **filesystem** of your server
- Storing files using [Amazon's S3 cloud storage service](#)

For better performance, we recommend switching from database storage to either of these two methods.

Switching to filesystem storage

To switch to filesystem storage, go to **Server > File Uploads**. Click **Change Storage Mechanism**. In the pop-up window that opens, select **Filesystem**.

▪

Click **Save new storage mechanism**.

Binary files will begin to be stored in `/data/files` within the directory where you installed DeskPRO. Any files already stored in the database will gradually be transferred to the filesystem in small batches (a few files will be moved each time the once-per-minute cron job/Scheduled Task runs).

Filesystem storage with multiple web servers

If you have multiple web servers, you must ensure that they are all accessing the same shared filesystem (e.g. using Network Attached Storage or a Storage Area Network). If each web server is storing files to its own filesystem, then when web server A stores a file, web server B will not be able to access it, and you will experience errors.

You can set a custom location for filesystem storage by editing the `dir_data` variable in the DeskPRO `config.php` file. Use this to set the location of the shared filesystem.

Another way to deal with the issue of file storage with multiple servers is to use [Amazon S3](#). All the web servers will be storing and retrieving their files from a single S3 'bucket'.

Switching to Amazon S3 storage

Switching to Amazon S3 cloud storage has two main advantages:

- S3 storage is highly available and highly scalable. This reduces your server administration burden, since you don't have to ensure that your servers have disk space for all the files.
- If your DeskPRO installation uses multiple web servers, it's easy to have them share the same S3 storage. Using filesystem storage with multiple web servers requires extra configuration overhead.

To use Amazon S3, you must register with [Amazon Web Services](#) at <http://aws.amazon.com/s3/>.

- 1 Once you've registered, in the top right corner of the AWS site, you will see your name with a pull-down menu control. Use this to access the **AWS Security Credentials** screen.
- 2 Click the + icon next to the **Access Keys** section. Click **Create New Access Key** and save the Access Key ID and Secret Access Key. It's very important to save the Secret Access Key now; you will not be able to retrieve it once you close the window.
 - Note: You may wish to create a separate user with specific permissions instead of using your main AWS user (which has full AWS permission to do everything). Refer to Amazon's [Identity and Access Management Best Practices guide](#) for more information.
- 3 Open the **Services** menu in the top left corner of the screen and click on **S3**
- 4 Click on **Create Bucket** and choose a bucket name; for compatibility the name should:
 - Have 3 to 63 characters.
 - Contain only lower case letters (at least one), numbers, `.` and `-`.
 - Not start with `.` and shouldn't follow or precede `.` with a `-`).
- 5 Select a location that is closest to the location of your DeskPRO Download webserver.
- 6 Select your new bucket in the list and click **Properties** tab in the right pane. Expand the **Permissions** section and click **Add Bucket Policy** and paste the following policy into the box:

```
{
  "Version": "2008-10-17",
  "Statement": [
    {
      "Sid": "AllowPublicRead",
      "Effect": "Allow",
      "Principal": {
        "AWS": "*"
      },
      "Action": [
        "s3:GetObject"
      ],
      "Resource": [
        "arn:aws:s3:::YOUR_BUCKET_NAME/*"
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

(Replace "YOUR_BUCKET_NAME" with the name of the bucket you just created).

This policy makes the bucket public, so DeskPRO can serve binary objects or "blobs" directly from the Amazon S3 servers.

To enable S3 storage within DeskPRO, in the admin interface go to **Server > File Uploads**. Click the **Storage Mechanism Options** button and switch the mechanism to Amazon S3.

Enter the Access Key, Secret Key and S3 Bucket Name you configured above, then click **Save**.

DeskPRO will automatically move existing files to S3. This is done gradually, in small batches, as part of the default once-per-minute scheduled task (the same one that is responsible for processing email).

This process can take a long time, especially if you have a lot of data. If you would like to speed up the process, you can use the dedicated command-line tool:

```
$ cd /path/to/deskpro
$ php cmd.php dp:move-blobs      # Shows an overview
$ php cmd.php dp:move-blobs --run # Actually starts moving files
```

S3 security and reliability

It may seem insecure to have every file within your helpdesk (including email attachments) hosted publicly on S3. However, the URL for each file on S3 includes a very long string of random and unguessable characters that essentially acts as a password and ensures that people or bots browsing the web cannot find the 'public' files.

Only people who are authorized to see the file can get the URL. While a user or agent who is authorized to see the file could copy the URL and pass it to somebody else, they could also copy the file itself and pass it on. So enabling S3 doesn't make your files any more accessible than if you use filesystem or database storage.

Note that in the unlikely event that the S3 service becomes unavailable, links to existing files will not work. For example, if you had an image attachment saved to S3, that image would not load in the browser.

However, your helpdesk as a whole will remain operational. If S3 is unavailable, DeskPRO automatically switches back to database storage.

Server configuration and file size

Your server configuration determines the maximum file size DeskPRO can handle; factors include the amount of memory available to PHP and the values of some settings in your `php.ini` file. This determines the size of file that DeskPRO can handle as an upload from a web interface (agent, portal, chat widget etc) or as an email attachment.

See **Server Settings > File Uploads** for details of which settings affect the file size limit, and how to change it.

Raising the file size settings in **Setup > Settings** (under **User Attachments** and **Agent Attachments**) will not work if it exceeds the maximum file size determined by the server configuration.

20. DeskPRO Terminology

Admin: staff member within your company who has administrator access to configure and customize your helpdesk

Agent: staff member within your company who uses DeskPRO to provide help

Article: in the context of DeskPRO, an article refers to a piece of **knowledgebase** content

Assignment: a ticket can be assigned to an agent or a team to track who is dealing with that ticket

CC: a user who is CCed on a ticket will receive notifications about its progress. The equivalent for agents is **following**

Chat: real-time instant messaging between agents and users; may be available to users from the web portal or integrated into a website

CRM: the app used for managing users and assigning them to **organizations** and **usergroups**; short for *Customer Relationship Management*

Downloads: useful files you provide to users through your web portal; e.g., software drivers or product manuals; maintained in the **Publish** app

Feedback: suggestions from users submitted through your **web portal**; e.g. a feature request or new product idea

Following: an agent added as a follower of a ticket can get notifications and see it in the **Tickets I Follow** filter; useful for keeping track of a ticket without being assigned to it

Glossary: part of the **Publish** app used to maintain definitions of terms which are automatically displayed in **knowledgebase** articles

Knowledgebase: part of the **web portal** which contains rich-text help **articles**

News: part of the **web portal** which displays news posts chronologically; useful for product announcements

Organizations: used to track the company or other enterprise a user belongs to; you can assign users to organizations using the **CRM** app, or DeskPRO can automatically assign organizations based on user email addresses;

Permissions: settings which control what an agent or user can do with DeskPRO; your agent permissions are set by your admins and might, for example, prevent you deleting tickets; a user's permissions depend on their **usergroup**

Publish: the app used to maintain content for the web portal: knowledgebase articles, news posts, downloads and glossary entries

SLAs: short for *Service Level Agreements*; goals for dealing with tickets that your helpdesk aims to meet, e.g. that you must reply to a new ticket within 4 hours; shown in the **Tickets** app.

Snippets: short pieces of text which you can quickly insert into messages to users; useful to save time entering standard greetings, phrases, canned answers etc.

Status: a ticket's status is used to track who needs to act on a ticket next: **awaiting agent** means the helpdesk must do something related to that ticket; **awaiting user** means the helpdesk is waiting for the user to reply; **resolved** means the issue that ticket represents has been resolved

Tasks: an app used to track "to-do" items for agents

Teams: agents are grouped into teams to enable group ticket assignment

Ticket: represents a user question, problem or complaint; can be created automatically from incoming user email, or by a user from the **web portal**, or by an agent on a user's behalf

Ticket email account or just **email account:** an email account that is linked to DeskPRO so that incoming emails are turned into tickets e.g. `support@example.com`

User: one of the people the helpdesk is trying to help

Usergroup: users belong to usergroups which determine what they are allowed to do and see when interacting with DeskPRO; created by admins, assigned with the **CRM** app

Web portal: the user-facing web interface of DeskPRO - can be integrated into your own website; help information on the portal is maintained using the **Publish** app